Raj Publishers (Regd.)

Society In India

Raj Publishers (Regd.)

A Text Book of

SOCIETY IN INDIA

By :

Naveen Sharma

M.A., B.Ed.

RAJ PUBLISHERS (REGD.)

Adda Tanda, Jalandhar

Phone : 0181-5059881, 98142-16628

Email Add. : rajpublishers@yahoo.co.in

Published by :
Raj Kumar Khanna
Raj Publishers (Regd.)
Adda Tanda, Jalandhar - 144 008

Phones Office : 5059881, 5059880
Resi. : 5059883, 5059882

© All rights including subject matter, style & blocks etc. are reserved with the Publisher & the Author. No part of this book can be reproduced in any form without their written permission.

Disclaimer :

While Printing this book we have taken every possible precaution, the Publisher and the Author are not responsible of errors or omissions and/or any loss resulting from them.

New Edition

Price : **Rs. 248/- (Rupees Two Hundred and Forty Eight only)**

Printed at
Swan Printing Press,
Adda Tanda, Jalandhar-144 008

SYLLABUS

SOCIETY IN INDIA

COURSE CONTENTS

1. **Tribal Society :** Meaning, Characteristics- Classification of tribes, The Schedule tribes.
2. **Institutional Features in Tribal Society :** Family, Marriage and Economy, The Changing trend.
3. **Rural Society :** Meaning, Characteristics, Change in Rural Society.
4. **Institutional Features in Rural Society :** Family, Marriage, Economy and Polity (Village Panchayat), Changing Trends.
5. **Urban Society :** Meaning and Characteristics, Concepts of Urbanization and Urbanism.
6. **Institutional Features in Urban Society :** Urban Family, Features and Changes, Economy-Voluntary Associations, Slums.
7. **Under-Privileged Sections :** Women Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and The Disabled Their Disabilities, Measures to Improve Their Status.
8. **Schedule Caste :** Meaning, Origin of Untouchability, Hindu Legal Codes, Consequences of Reservation.
9. **Schedule Tribes :** Meaning, Distribution and Composition of Schedule Tribes, Constitutional Provisions.
10. **Status of Women :** Disabilities, Legislation, Present Status of Women in India.

CONTENT

1.	Tribal Society	1-7
2.	Institutional Features in Tribal Society	8-17
3.	Rural Society	18-24
4.	Institutional Features in Rural Society	25-32
5.	Urban Society	33-48
6.	Marriage and Family	49-66
7.	Origin of Untouchability	67-74
8.	Scheduled Castes	75-83
9.	Scheduled Tribes : Meaning and Disabilities	84-86
10.	Status of Women in India	87-100

******

1-7
8-17
18-24
25-32
33-48
49-66
67-74
75-83
84-86
87-100

CHAPTER – 1
TRIBAL SOCIETY

The persons living in the same house constitute a family and they have blood relation. All these families are jointly known as a Tribe. From the study of Rigveda, we come to know that Aryans came to India in the form of many tribes and one person was the Head of the tribe. Those tribes which used to do dirty/shabby works were considered as untouchable. Even touching those people was considered bad. A person who behaves like animal or person without feelings is called as Mlecchа (Barbarian) in these tribes. In this chapter, we will discuss about tribes, untouchability and Mlecchа etc. A group of persons living under the same roof and having blood relation called 'Family'. Many families constitute a "tribe". A tribe has its own rules and people live as per those rules. People who break these rules are outcasted of the tribe. Every tribe has its own rules of living and marriage. They have their own ways of entertainment. They marry within their tribe only. Aryans came to India as tribe. Every tribe had a head. The Aryans used to have mutual fights within their tribes. There were main five tribes of Aryans. They were named as – Anas, Puru, Yak, Bharat and Tehwas. Rigveda has described the war of ten kings and in this war, Raja Sudam, the king of the tribe, had won over his enemies. Over the time, some foreign tribes came to India and a change in the outline of tribes began. These castes were- Shak, Yawan, Kushan, Parthiya, Sethian and Hun.

Though these tribes entered India as attackers, yet afterwards they settled here and had adopted India's traditions and religions. In the Eighth century, Arabs took over the areas of Sindh and Multan.Thus, Muslims entered India. In the 11th century, Punjab became a part of Gajni Empire and also became the stronghold of various tribes.

DEFINITION OF TRIBE

A tribe is a group of such people who have their own rules and traditions and all the people in the tribe follow those rules. A tribe has its own language and certain area. The tribal people have their own rules regarding marriage and they get married only according to these rules.

1. According to **Dr. D.N. Majumdar,** "A tribe is a collection of families or group of families bearing a common name, members of which occupy the same territory, speak the same language and observe certain taboos regarding marriage, profession or occupation and home developed a well assessed system of reciprocity and mutuality of obligation."

2. According to **Gillin and Gillin,** "Any collection of preliterate local group which occupies a common general territory, speaks a common language and practices a common culture is Tribe".

CHARACTERISTICS OF TRIBE

1. Common Thinking :- The main cause of common thinking is that these people live together for rather a long period. A group of people living in a specific geographical area only, can't be designated as a tribe; rather there should be feeling of unity in them. A tribe should have feeling of integration in them. This mental feeling is an important characteristic of a Tribe. Such people have common thinking. Having a distinct language of people of a tribe is also necessary. In this way, a feeling of unity develops in them.

2. Division of Occupation :- A very low sharing of labor is found in a tribe. But there are special roles in a tribe just like a doctor for treatment of disease.

3. Political Power :- There is a feeling of security amongst the members of a tribe and keeping this feeling in view, political organization is formed. One person is given powers to rule. A tribal Samiti is formed to help and advise the head in governance. The advice of the Samiti is usually accepted by the head of the tribe. A tribe is divided in different small groups and these groups have their own heads. These heads take up and solve the problems of their groups.

4. Religious Approval :- In India, every tribe has its own religious beliefs. The base of a tribe's organization is political and social because political rules cannot be violated after getting religious recognition. In this way, they get recognition and approval. Tribal people have more rigid beliefs towards religious rules.

5. Common Emotions :- People of tribe have common emotions because they have been living in the same area for since long. In the absence of a common terrain, the possibility of common communal feelings, common language etc. is not possible. It is necessary for a tribe to have a common area, where the people of that tribe can live together with brotherly feeling.

6. Collective Families :- A group of many families is known as a Tribe. They produce collectively to fulfill their needs. Thus, unity sustains between these families.

7. Economic Structure :- There are no class distinctions in tribal society. Every member of the tribe has equal right on everything. There is no upper or lower in a tribe. They have their own land to cultivate. They want to fulfill their needs only and therefore, their production is also limited.

8. Common Customs :- People of a tribe are children of the same family. Everybody is satisfied with customs of the tribe. Every tribe has a common name. Common name is also a characteristic of the tribe. Spirit of unity, common language, common religion, and common political organization etc. of a tribe shows a common civilization. Common culture of tribe is also an important characteristic of a tribe.

9. Feeling of Love :- The people of a tribe live together with a feeling of love. They stand by one another through everybody's thick and thin. All the members of the tribe together solve any problem if faced by a member.

DEFINITIONS OF FAMILY

Family is an organization that gives values to a child. The atmosphere in the family has an impact over the child. It is also said that good moral values taught to the children, definitely have positive impact over the society. This will increase number of persons with good moral character in the society. The society will be graded as ideal society. Family is such a stable group, in which husband-wife, or one male and one female live with their children.

Family is that group which is constituted because of marriage, blood relation or adoption. Husband-wife make a small family indulging in a relationship, in which, relations like mother-father, son-daughter, brother-sister develop. Thus, they build a common culture. Parents must give birth to children to form a family. Family starts with such bonds and relations which include mother-father, husband-wife, son-daughter, and brother-sister. This family chain continues increasing after marital relations. This group named 'family' has more than one member in it. Depending upon their situations, the members of the family create a culture by their mutual interaction.

1. According to **MacIver**,"Family is a group defined by sex relationship sufficiently precise and enduring to provide for the procreation and upbringing of children."

Types of Families in Tribal Societies

There are different kinds of tribes living in India. Based on their living style, following kinds are found-

1. Family on the basis of Authority :- In a father headed type of family, the authority of the family is in the hands of father. He has got a special place in the family. He is the head of the family. Every member of the family obeys his orders. Opposite to it, mother is head of a mother-headed family. Her place in the family is very important.

2. Family on the basis of Inheritance :- When the whole authority and property of the family is in the hands of father, then after the death of father, the property and authority comes in the hands of the eldest son. These types of families are known as inherited family. In a family of inheritance, the authority and property is in the hands of female. After her death, either her daughter, brother or the son of mother's sister, becomes the successor.

3. Families on the basis of Residence :- In a female headed family, after marriage, husband leaves the house of his parents and starts living in his wife's house. These types of families are found in many areas. These types of families are found in Khasi, Garo and Nayar tribes. Father headed families are those families, where female lives in the house of her husband after marriage. These families are found mostly in civilized societies. The examples are Khariya, Bheel and Khas tribes. In some societies, husband-wife start their family in some other place. When husband-wife live neither in the house of husband nor in the house of wife after marriage, they are called New-Station families. When the husband-wife don't live together after marriage and they use to live in those families where they were born, they are known as Two-Station families.

4. Families on the basis of Marriage :- When a male marries single female, it is called Monogamy. In today's society, this type is marriage is more common. When a male marries more than one female at the same time or a female marries more than one male at the same time, it is known as Polyandry. Further, these are of two types. In a family where there are two or more husbands of a female, it is known as Polyandry. When a male has two or more wives at the same time, it is known as multi-wife marriage. Muslims have this tradition in their culture.

5. Family on the basis of Nomenclature :- If in a family, the name of the dynasty is on the name of father, it is known as father-named family. If in a family, the name of the dynasty is on the name of mother, it is known as mother-named family. In these families, the dynasty of the children is on the name of mother. In those families, where the name of the dynasty is on the names of both mother and father, it is known as double named families.

6. Family on the basis of Ecology :- In every society or groups of families, a big difference is seen in families on the basis of social conditions. There are two types of families on this basis. Rural families are more close to joint families. But we cannot say that these are exactly same because of cultural differences. In rural families, homogeneity in families is of great importance. Their economy depends on agriculture and their relations are very important for them. They are in favor of strict social and moral values. The religion of traditions can be called as lifeline of rural families. That is why they are stereotype in nature. In addition, in rural families, family cultures and participation has an important place. Industrialization and urbanization has lead to increase in number of urban families. They are those families who live in urban areas, small in size, and are more involved in social and cultural activities. In these families, head of the family is not considered as person with full authority and age is not important in condition of the family.

From the above description it is clear that there are different types of families in a tribal society. If in one society, the base of the family is residing, then in some other case, it may be different. It may also be possible that in one society, the families have different bases.

CLASSIFICATION OF INDIAN TRIBES

Indian tribes are extended to all the directions. There is a lot of difference in their living styles. Indian tribes are divided in various parts. On the basis of race, language, geographical structure, culture and economy, these tribes are divided. These tribes are extended to different directions of India. Their description is as follows:

In the western and north-west areas, tribes of Punjab, Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Gujarat come. In the tribes of Rajasthan, Bheel, Gagsia, Meena, Banjor tribes are famous. In Gujarat, Mahadev, Kauli, Katkari, Bathi and Dubla tribes are famous. In North and North-east areas of Uttranchal, Bhotia, Takhni and Kharu of Kumachal, Kuki in Assam and tribes of Lushai mountain ranges come. In Assam, Naga, Kuki, Khasi, Ambor, Mikir and Gurung are main tribes. Prepcha tribe is found in Sikkim and other nearby areas of India. Many tribes of this area have still maintained their characteristics. For e.g., the Bhotia people are famous for their handicraft. In Tharu tribe,

females are famous for magic. Naga people are famous for their bravery and war expertise. In Garo and Khasi tribes, mother headed families are found. In middle areas, tribes used to live from ancient times. Santhal, Munda, Urave tribes in Jharkhand, Boro, Khed, Saura and Jwang tribes in Odisha, Gonhu, Benga, Kola, Korak, Kumar, Bhumia tribes in Madya Pradesh come under this area. Some tribes of southward areas, like Chechu, Kolam, Koma, Rajgond also come under this area. In Chota Nagpur area, Birhor, Urav, Munda, Ho, Khadiya tribes live.

Some tribes are living in these areas since long. They are earning their livelihood by doing traditional ways. Every person living in a tribe has to abide by the rules and regulations of the tribe.

1. Racial Factors

Many archeologists have given their expert views after studying the factors of race of Indian tribes. These experts include Rizle, Majumdar, Hodan, Guha and Hutton.

They have given six breeds of Indian Tribes. Two breeds are main-Godid community and Meling sub-community, Indeed community and North-Indeed sub-community, Melenid community and Kolid sub-community. In this way, the people of these communities are living in all over India.

Ancient communities of India is related to groups like Kadr, Pulayna, Rajmahal of Kochin, Baghdi of Mountain areas, Angami Naag of Assam, come in this category. They have similarity in blood with Malaysian and West African tribes.

The tribes of middle part of India come under the category of Proto-Australian communities. These tribes are known as Nishad. East and east-western areas are known as Mangol of tribes. Mangolian people have some physical qualities like their skin is of yellow pale color; they have snub nose, straight hair, long head, medium height and big eyes. It is baseless to assume that all the tribes of India have their origin from these three communities, because some archeologists say that the origin of some Indian tribes cannot be related to these three communities.

2. Language Based

In India, some communities have common language. They are recognized with their language. The languages found in India are divided in four parts. Their explanation is as follows:

Under Asto-Asiatic language group, Mudari, Ho, Khadia, and other tribes of Bihar and Assam can be kept. In addition, some communities of Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Koruku of Bagar, Swata of Odisha and Gandaba communities are a part of this category. In some communities, oral literature is very rich and efforts are done to convert it in writing.

Group of people, speaking Dravidian language, is spread in Middle and Southern part of India. Gode, Kandh, Urav, Malto and Toda tribes are related to Dravidian family on the basis of language. The language of Malto tribe is spoken in the areas of Khond in Odisha and Rajmahal areas of Bihar. Other languages of this group are Virula, Kadra, Malsegtata, Mala Kurban etc.

In the tribes of Tibetan and Chinese influence, languages are not important. In the areas of Himalyan ranges and Assam, mostly tribes speak Burmi languages of Tibetan and Chinese influence. From this discussion, it is clear that Indian tribes are related to many languages. The first effort to understand their language was done by Christians, who want to add more and more people in their

religion. The tribal people become aware of other languages because of this contact. In this way, these tribes are forgetting their own language and accepting other urban languages.

3. Cultural basis

Majumdar and Madan have divided the tribes on the basis of culture. The classification is as under:

1. The tribes which are behind urban or rural communities from the point of view of culture.
2. The tribes which are influenced by culture of urban or rural communities. Many problems have erupted in tribes because of these changes.
3. Third types of tribes are those, which are completely influenced by rural or urban culture and they are not facing any kind of problem.

4. Economic based

On the basis of economic development, the tribes can be divided in different stages. Their economy has its own characteristics. Their economy has different phases like agriculture, permanent agriculture and persons working in industries. These tribes are divided in various parts:

1. Gypsy and liberal people
2. Persons who do agriculture on plateau in mountain areas
3. Farmers living in adjoining areas of mountains
4. Tribes which are partially involved in Hindu social system and hold an important place in Hindu society.

In present times, the modes of transportation and communication have much developed and these tribal people have set up contact with other people. They have become capable of indulging in other professions except their traditional professions like teacher, doctor, engineer and other administrative jobs. With their job, they are able to earn more by doing knitting in free time at their place. Bhotia people keep flocks of sheep. They transport things with the help of sheep. They believe in barter system which is their traditional profession. Despite the fact that this tradition is not being followed much today but still they follow it.

SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES IN TRIBES AND CASTES

Tribes and castes have various similarities besides having some differences too, which are as follows:

Similarities :- In tribes and castes, boy and girl of same clan are considered as brother-sister. It means that marriage in same clan is considered illegal. In the ancient times, there was a tradition to marry in same clan but today, marriage is performed even out of clan. The main reason is modernization. The mindset of the people has changed. Boys and girls are adopting foreign culture after getting education. They are performing marriage out of their tribe or caste. The means of communication and transportation have changed the mindset of people. Marriage ceremony is

performed in group in a tribe or caste. People perform all the traditions together. Tribes have their own culture. Both perform their own cultural traditions. In this way, tribes and castes have many similarities.

Differences :-

1. In a caste, usually, people have their fixed profession because in caste system, works are divided. In a tribe, a person can adopt any profession because profession has no relation to tribe.
2. In a caste, names of clan are based on the names of any Rishi but the names of tribes are totemic.
3. The religion of the caste is not political property but the tribe is a political property.
4. In a caste, the discrimination of status is more as compared to a tribe.
5. According to **Max Weber,**" In a caste, everybody has equal status. Therefore is not much difference in that. But in tribe, there is a difference in status and position. But this thinking of Max Weber does not apply to all the castes. Because in many cases, there is a difference in status and position."
6. According to **Rizle,**" In a tribe, there are no hard and fast rule for inter-marriage but in caste, this rule is strictly followed."
7. According to **Max Weber,**" When any Indian tribe loses its importance, then it takes the form of Indian caste. In this way, tribes are a permanent group and caste is a social group."
8. Caste system was started for division of labor according to different professions in Hindu community. Tribe is such a group which developed on the basis of geographical location and communal feeling.

Tribes and castes have similarities but they have differences too.

From the above discussion it is clear that there are many types of tribes in India. They have different basis. In the present times, these tribes have many similarities. The reason behind this is that every person, whether he belongs to a tribe or a caste, is heading towards modernization.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What is a tribe? Examine its characteristics.
2. Describe the types of families in tribal society.
3. Describe the classification of Indian tribes.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 2
INSTITUTIONAL FEATURES IN TRIBAL SOCIETY

Tribal people are found in large number in India. They are spread over geographical areas. Mostly they are found both in uphill areas as well as in plains. In some states and federal areas, tribal people are found in good number. There is a great difference in the size of tribal area.

CLASSIFICATION OF SCHEDULED TRIBES

Those tribes which are registered in the list of scheduled tribes; they are accepted in Indian social discovery. Under section 342 (1) of Indian Constitution, there is a provision that President of India, with the advice of Governors of states, can include any tribe or organization of tribes in the list of tribes of a particular state. There is not specific social base of identifying any caste as tribe. President of India has prepared a list of scheduled tribes of India, in which some backward tribes are also included. No legal or social activist has taken any serious step in the identification of scheduled tribes because myths have changed. There is no exception to any tribe. These tribes have common cultural characteristics. Even today, the identification of tribes is lacking behind. They have no special historical background. Many tribes have fought for their identification, but government has not taken any particular steps.

TRIBAL ECONOMY

In tribal economy, all the persons and both the sexes (male and female) have equal importance and every person, young, females, children remain busy in work for earning their livelihood. In this economy, no one is dependent on others. In tribal economy, they have limited needs and they used to fulfill these needs through environment only. Tribal society has two main phases:

1. Tribal people have partnership in business, feeling of unity and feeling of fulfilling their needs on their own.
2. Tribal economy is not the result of efforts of some people only rather it is a joint effort.
3. The relations of tribal people are based on business.
4. In tribal society, production is done for consumption and there is no sale-purchase of things.
5. Tribal people lay more stress on spending money.

CHANGING TRENDS IN TRIBAL SOCIETIES

Tribal society is considered to be a part of backward society from the very beginning. But this thinking is also changing. Many tribes live in remote areas. But now because of technological developments and economical and political advancements, we can feel that we can use the natural resources of these tribal areas. Mines, farming and other procedures of security have endangered the life of these tribal people. In the name of progress, communal welfare and national security, villages are developed in these tribal population areas. The impotency of these settled people have made easier the entrance of multinational companies and their contractors. They have made their identity in different parts of the world. This area has attracted many non-tribes. This has given rise to the struggle of tribal people. Their activities are crushed. Despite much legislation, their land and forest property has been taken over by many non-tribal people and even government. Their changing behavior is the reason of their success. The example of this is Narmada Dam project.

SOCIAL CHANGES IN TRIBAL PEOPLE

Even in today, there is a lot of difference in living style of the tribal people. We can see a lot of variations in tribal population of India.

They speak different languages and there is a lot of difference in their financial condition. They are related to different racial groups. The society changes continuously and obviously it impacts the people. But there is less variation in tribal people.

In a tribal society, changes came to limelight with internal and external characteristics. The internal force implements change after so many years but external force implements change in short span of time. Physical pressure is a process with which change of less importance can be implemented.

Tribal people consider themselves simple and like others they don't feel happy with the change. Tribal people are different than the people of today's society.

The reason behind this is their negative thinking. They don't mould themselves according to the society while living in it. The non-tribal people also get attracted towards land and sources of income of tribal people. In the past, they were considered separate from society. This difference is not there in most of the areas. They have entered into a civilized society. After independence, in order to open the ways of tribal areas, special attention is given towards building roads so that they can be changed. In this way, the economical and social life of tribal people got affected. Non-tribal people enter into local tribes with new things and ideas and their commutation has become easier. They have started discussing things. In tribal areas, mines, factories and markets have developed. Tribal and non-tribal people meet each other in these mines and factories. They see the lavish industries. In this way, the symptoms of progressiveness are found in them also.

Tribal people feel that the world is not limited to their village and nearby places. Now they see new places, lands and people, which are far from their own village. Their living style and

thoughts does not match with them. They share their views through newspapers. Tribal languages like Santhali of West Bengal take these expectations of tribes to their homes. Their living style has changed a lot with the passage of time. Meeting people in the society and scientific advancements has given a new direction to their lives.

Tribal people are pushing it backward with their illiteracy, myths and poverty. They are getting a new mindset with these changes. They want to prove themselves in the society but still India is lacking behind America and other developed nations of the world. The government is making continuous efforts at centre or state level to bring tribal people at par with the developing people of the nation. The education is made available free of cost to the tribal people. They are given special facilities for employment. The collective impact of all these activities has changed the life of tribal people.

Education has also played an important role in their development. A platform was maintained to preach Christianity. In this platform, not only people from same community were included in it, rather respect was given to people from other religions. Christianity has a great impact on their thinking. It has also given a new identity in society. Christianity has taught them to live with harmony and unity in society. The priest has become important for all. Their attitude towards materialistic, worldly, cultural life has changed. Other changes have also come like change in their dressing style. Education has changed the thinking of the people. Government has made education available to all. Education is compulsory and free for all. People of many tribes don't send their children to school and they don't take advantage of free education. The word education is not that much important for tribal people as it is important for middle and rich high class people. They are the last part of social staircase. They are deprived of these facilities for generations. As a result, they themselves don't feel interested to get education. They don't see positively towards the education for development of their personality. They think that this is a source of getting some work done but the fact is that they can change their life in a positive way by getting education.

ECONOMIC CHANGES

Tribal people have made enormous changes in economic condition too. They have made it business oriented. The production of forests of tribal people like sticks for cleaning teeth, seasonal fruits, tendupatta, etc, are sold by them. These tribes purchase dress material and other required things in their exchange. It can be seen that the economies of tribes are changing. Now the tribal people have started growing crops and selling them in markets.

Tribal people are not limited to their own houses and countries. The educated people in them have started leaving forest based areas. They are searching for new opportunities outside. They are doing their business at far away places. They are selling the things produced by them in markets and expanding their business. They are becoming more aware towards agriculture.

The patrimonial political activities of tribes were limited to the heads of tribes, head of village of gram panchayat of village. Tribe, head of village or area were considered as one group. He used

to get his position as hereditary and all the powers were either with him or his family. After independence, panchayat and panchayati laws were imposed, this reduced the powers of these tribal organizations. It has opened the doors for tribes to take part in local, state or national level activities. Their life style has changed a lot. Thinking about the development of the village, maintaining the culture, maintaining the economy of the village is their responsibility now. Tribal people are now entitled to cast their vote and they can be the contestant in elections also. In addition, communal development programmes have given them the opportunities to be the political leader for the betterment of tribes. The tribal people have started some other work in urban areas. They have developed some other means of livelihood. The tribes, which are earning more money, their standard of living is also rising. These people have also become leaders on political grounds. The rich people are becoming richer and poor are becoming poorer. The difference between rich and poor is increasing.

CULTURAL CHANGES

The dressing sense, style of living and some less important traditions have changed to some extent but the social values have not changed much. They have been successful in reaching tribes and telling them about new inventions and new thinking. In this way they have adopted new ways of development.

Such proofs have been found regarding education, which have a great impact on the style of living of tribes. The educated young males like to live together in house. The families having some land have changed their monetary issues. Many tribes perform marriage in their own tribes only and follow their own traditions of marriage. With the opening of financial and political process of tribes, their economical and political ways have changed. Governmental and non-governmental efforts of education and development have made them enter into the mainstream of Indian social life. Their life has changed a lot. The impact of education is less on other phases of life.

NEW STYLES OF LIFE

The main characteristics of urban life style are as follows:

1. Urban Problems :- In urban areas, there are big industries and factories, which manufacture a lot of things. Urban life is better but it has some problems also. Every person becomes specialized by doing the same work but even then they remain poor. Though cities have developed, yet problem of crowd, messy areas, alcoholism, etc. is affecting human life. This is the reason of increasing crime and crime against children. As the number of cities is increasing, the complexity of life is also on the increase. Because of urbanization, many problems are creeping in.

2. Competition and Jealousy in People :- The urban people have more feeling of competition and jealously. Cities have open policies. Money lenders and financers also live in cities and poor people are also there. On one side, there is luxurious life and on the other side, people are not

having enough food. There is a lot of discrimination in rich and poor. Rich people don't help poor people. City is a place, where people of different castes, races, religions and areas live together. Their cultures are also different. They don't like to participate in religious activities of each other. Urban family has less impact. Because of education and profession, people spend most of their time out of home. Head of the family has no restriction on any family member. The earning members of the family work as per their own wish. Business, profession and education teach a person how to face competition. They are spending their life with a feeling of jealously and competition.

3. Selfish and Spendthrift People :- Urban people don't feel the pain of others rather they are selfish and spendthrift. Every person has his own selfish motive and there are many selfish groups in a city. In cities, governmental administration imposes restrictions on people. Sometimes, this artificiality becomes so dreadful that people don't cut off the sources of basic needs but they become spendthrift in order to maintain social respect. Cities have big hotels where tip is given to waiters. Urban people make it a competition that who will give more tips to waiter.

4. Town Citizens :- Urban people are of special type. In India, the population of cities is less compared to rural areas but still hundreds of people work there. Cities have all the facilities, and rural people get attracted towards cities. At present, the thinking of rural people is changing. They feel respect in calling themselves urbanites. Some people come to city for education and some for job. These people have different languages, religions, cultures and castes. The facility of electricity, water and jobs attract them towards cities.

5. Attractive Atmosphere of Cities :- Cities have all the facilities. Cities have such people those who show off more but they don't have a single penny in their pocket. Women do lot of makeup. Their beauty is not natural rather it has lot of artificiality. In the living style of urban people, artificiality can be seen on every step. A person gets attracted towards it. Moreover, individualism is being developed in urban atmosphere. The reason behind this is freedom of females, mutual struggle, education, social activities and life based on romance. Every person of a city works for his own selfish ends.

DEFINITION OF MARRIAGE

According to **Majumdar,** "Marriage is the mutual social tie up of male and female or marriage is such an social institution which gives consent to the tie up of male and female and whose motive is (1) establishment of house (2) indulging in sexual relations (3) giving birth to children (4) upbringing of children."

OBSTACLES IN TRIBAL MARRIAGES

1. Exogamy in Tribes :- Mostly, tribes have their own clan and totems. No person can marry in his own clan or totem. In almost all the Indian tribes, out of totem marriage is followed. Breach of this rule is considered a serious offence. As per the rules of exogamy marriages, any person of a

tribe can marry only out of his tribe. This group can be out of own tribe, caste, clan, totem, etc. Breaching this rule is considered very serious offence. Some Indian tribes have the tradition of marrying in own clan. But the followers of this rule are very rare.

2. Endogamy in Tribes :- Opposite to exogamy, there is endogamy. In this, a person has to marry in his own group. This group can be his own tribe, caste or clan. Most of marriages are of this type. The social decorum of tribes is also maintained.

3. Preference Marriage :- In Indian tribes, close relatives are given preference for marriage. For example, children of brother-sister, marriage with cousins is given preference. In some tribes, marriage with sister-in-law is given preference. In case of death of wife or under special circumstances, marriage with sister-in-law is preferred. In case of death of husband of any female, she is remarried to her brother-in-law. Even in today's civilized Indian society, this type of marriage is given preference.

In present times, this type of marriage is most preferred. In this type of marriage, one male marries one female or one female marries one male. In present civilized societies, these kinds of marriages are preferred.

Marrying two or more females at the same time is known as Multi-wife marriage. Sometimes situation demands for second marriage. In Hindu society, there is no tradition of such marriages. But sometimes under special circumstances, a person can be given permission for multi-wife marriage. Sometimes, first wife remains sterile or she gives birth to female child only. The permission of second marriage is given if one has the wish of male child. In Hindu society, last rites of a man are performed by son only. If first wife has not given birth to male child, a person can marry second time. Sometimes, husband keeps two or more wives because of sexual desires. Social status gets upgraded with more wives. That is why some people are in the favor of second marriage. But in society, such marriages are considered destructive for families, because of which mutual conflict, dispute of property and fight between children creep in. Jealously increases among the family members, and also have negative impact on children. No one in society respects such type of families. Females indulge in conflicts and males commit suicide.

In polyandry, a female is married to two or more males. Polyandry is defined as, "when a female marries another male while her first husband is alive or marrying two or more males at the same time is known as polyandry."

It is clear from the above definition that polyandry is that marriage where a female marries two or more males at the same time. Polyandry is that type of marriage in which a female is having more than one husband. She has to live under everybody. If all the husbands are brothers then in sexual relations, younger brothers have to follow the orders of elder brother. She does every work as per orders. The reason of marriage can be social or financial but the female has to obey this marriage. She feels depressed in herself. She feels inferior in society. In addition, the fatherhood of children of polyandry families is approved as per social customs. One who has the right to fulfill this custom, he is considered the father of the children. Females have no right in the society. In this

type of marriage, the condition of mother is of utmost importance. In some societies, father does not live with family on permanent basis but he lives with them for some time only.

DEMERITS OF POLYANDRY

1. Problems in Earnings :- The people of tribe are unable to earn livelihood because of illiteracy. A person is not able to earn livelihood for his wife and children in independent way. So more than one male (brothers) together take care of their wife and children. This is also a reason of polyandry family.

2. Less Birth Rate :- Because of polyandry, birth rate is decreasing and some tribes are on the verge of extinction.

3. Irresponsible Husband :- Because of polyandry, husbands don't take responsibility of children and it is not possible to give a good upbringing to children.

4. Unemployment and Poverty :- Unemployment and Poverty are also reasons of polyandry. In some tribes, husband has to pay for wife but he fails to do so because of poverty. So brothers or others jointly get married to the same woman. They get married to a high class girl because they are unemployed as a rich handicapped girl is married to poor and unemployed person.

MEANING OF POLYGYNY

When a male marries a woman without giving divorce to his first wife, it is known as polygyny. Polygyny means a male marries two or more females at the same time.

CAUSES OF POLYGYNY

Polygyny is that form of marriage in which husband keeps more than one wife at the same time. Following are its reasons:

1. Huge Number of Women :- Because of huge number of women, they don't get males for marriage. So, women marry the same male and polygyny comes into existence. Because of more number of women, they are married to the same male.

2. Religious Condition :- In some societies, the tradition of polygyny is prevalent. It is a normal tradition in Muslims. Islam religion gives permission to its disciple to keep four wives at the same time. In Muslims, a male can have four marriages at the same time. In those societies where civilization has not developed, this is also a reason of polygyny. Novelty is the psychological desire of every human. For novelty, males establish relation with more than one female. In tribal societies, the main reasons of polygyny are financial.

3. Proper Care of Children :- Because of polygyny, sexually more desirous males get satisfaction with more than one wife. They don't maintain illicit relation to satisfy their sexual

desires. Children don't get right brought up. Polygyny is a normal thing. Socially high and economically strong people indulge in polygyny.

4. Economic Condition :- In some societies, male marries more females so that the females can help in economical work. For making the financial status of the family better, males indulge in polygyny. Socially high and economically strong males do marriage with more females because it is easier for them to satisfy the needs of more wives. In some societies, it is believed that a person with more wives will have high social status.

Polygyny has certain disadvantages too. It is very difficult and expensive to spend money on the upbringing of children of so many wives. Financial burden on male increases. He is not able to make both ends meet. Male involved in polygyny becomes more jealous and does more struggle and the atmosphere of the family becomes worse. There is no peace in the family. In polygyny societies, the status of female is very low. Nobody respects her in the society.

With the modernization of the society, this tradition is on the verge of extinction. Only Muslim community has this tradition, but even educated Muslims are leaving this tradition. This tradition will soon be an extinct one.

Some rules have also been made for internal and external marriage. As per the rules of internal marriage, a person can marry in equivalent caste but not outside. In external marriage, a person cannot marry a female who is from the same clan or village.

A brief description of internal and external marriage is as follows:

ENDOGAMY

According to endogamy, a person should marry in his own caste but there is no permission to marry relatives.

According to **Hoebal,** "Endogamy is that social rule which demands that a person should marry in that group, whose he is also a member."

FORMS OF ENDOGAMY

The following are the types of endogamy:

1. Caste Endogamy :- In caste, a person marries in his own caste. E.g. a warrior caste person marries in warrior caste only.

2. Racial Endogamy :- Racial endogamy is that marriage in which a person marries in his own race. E.g. a white person cannot marry a female of Negro race.

3. Sub-caste Endogamy :- In sub-caste endogamy, a person marries in his own sub-caste. Caste is sometimes further divided into sub-castes.

4. Class Endogamy :- In such marriages, a person marries in his own class.

GOOD EFFECTS

Because of endogamy, the married life can be more peaceful and happy. Children are fully developed. Their relations become strong. Because of similar culture and economical background, the mutual relation between husband and wife becomes comfortable and there is unity in society. In ancient times, in India, the division of labor was based on castes. Because of endogamy, it is possible to maintain the purity of blood. It was a myth in the past that children of high castes possess more qualities as compared to the children of lower castes. In endogamy, this knowledge remains in the caste itself. Even the money of caste does not go out. Society gives respect too.

BAD EFFECTS

Dowry, cost of female and polygyny are the results of endogamy. Even some females die because of this. Their marital life is destroyed. They are a barrier in national development. The rules of endogamy allow a caste and sub-caste to marry in their own caste. In this way, every member has to choose his/her life partner from within the caste and society is affected by many evils. As a result, there is a difference between various castes of the society. Hindu polygyny has various forms. Its form has changed with the change in the social conditions.

EXOGAMY

Exogamy is opposite to polygamy. According to it, a person cannot marry in that group, which he is member of. This rule applies in India in clans. Every human group is following this rule. Because marrying own relatives is a taboo everywhere.

It is a taboo to marry in the same clan. All males and females consider themselves as brother-sister. That is why, persons of one clan marry in another clan. In Indian tribes, marriage is done according to totem. A person of one totem marries a person of another totem. Any animal or fauna is considered as totem, with which that tribe is associated.

In Hindu religion, it is compulsory to marry out of clan. In every society, rules of polygyny and exogamy are to be followed. These both have impact on society. Types of exogamy are as follows:

1. Spravar Exogamy :- As per the rules of sprawar exogamy, those persons are included in pravar who have common predecessors.

2. Spind Exogamy :- As per the rules of spind exogamy, those persons are included in spind whose parents, grandfather-grandmother and maternal grandparents are from the same clan.

3. Pind Exogamy :- As per its rules, persons from the same village cannot marry each other.

4. Clan Exogamy :- A person of one clan was not allowed to marry person of other clan.

5. Totem Exogamy :- Persons who worship the same totem cannot marry each other.

GOOD EFFECTS

Exogamy marriages promote unity in society because as per this rule there is a feeling of cooperation in different cultures. For the prosperity of the society, exogamy is accurate. Living in different groups after marriage, people come close to each other.

BAD EFFECTS

The area of exogamy is very limited. It becomes a problem to choose life partner. It also promotes dowry system. The female side has to buy a male by paying more money. This rule has negative impact on girls. Because the parents of the girl cannot make them sit at home nor they could find a suitable match for her. Sometimes the girls are married in their young age.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. Describe the changing trends in tribal society.
2. Urbanization is a new way of life. Discuss.
3. Discuss the characteristics of urban way of life.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 3
RURAL SOCIETY

Rural society, which has been defined a fundamental unit of the today's society, is an inseparable part of our life. They have an important place in development of human civilization. In initial stages of development of civilization, man had no knowledge of agriculture. During primitive times, the man was just a nomadic, because of which he used to wander around in search of food. The man started agriculture wherever arable land was available at that time and the human groups started living there permanently. Thus, with the beginning of 'Agricultural Age', began the setting up of villages. On account of living together, the mutual co-operation started and the groups gradually went on transforming into communities. Evidently, these agriculture-based small communities are called Rural Society or Village.

According to **Peake**, "The village community consists of a group of the related or unrelated persons larger than a single family occupying a large house or a number of dwelling places closed together, sometimes irregularly, sometimes in a street and cultivating originally in common a number of able fields, dividing the available meadow land between them and pasturing their cattle upon surrounding waste land over which the community claims rights as far as the boundaries of adjacent community."

CHARACTERISTICS OF RURAL SOCIETY

Characteristics of rural society can be described as under :

1. Control of family on individual :- The man is completely under control in a rural family. Every type of decision is taken by the head of family in a village. There is custom of joint family in villages and individual adopts traditional profession. All the members in family work together due to which they have community spirit.

2. Higher status of Brahmins :- Caste-system is the basis of social stratification in Indian urban community. In this stratification, the Brahmins have been given the highest place. Thereafter the place of Kshtriya, Vaishya, Shudra etc. comes. Shudras have very low place in village community. They were seen in terms of hatred. They were tortured by the upper castes, but their condition has improved a lot after independence. They have been given special rights and facilities enabling them to live life in equality with the upper castes. But caste system, sense of ups and downs and Untouchability etc. are still in vogue up to some extent, in village communities.

3. Close to Nature :- Village people have close relation with nature. Their prime profession is agriculture, hence they are related with nature. Their life depends more upon nature. These people fear of powers of nature, because these powers can destroy their hardwork done during the whole year.

4. Traditional works :- 'Jajmani System' is a significant characteristic of Indian rural society. Indian village people adopt their traditional occupations. The Jajmani system is based on the agricultural system of production and distribution of goods and services. It is the link between the land-owning high caste groups and occupational castes. To whom services are provided are called 'Jajman' and the service providers and serving communities are called 'Kurmee'. For example the washerman washes clothes of his Jajmans, the barber cuts hair of his Jajmans, the cobbler mends shoes for them etc. Under Jajmani system the relation between different castes continues. Jajmans give grains or money to Kurmees, in exchange of their services provided. Other than Jajmani system, every family adopts its traditional occupation.

5. Hardworking People :- India is an agricultural country. The main occupation of the village people is agriculture. Approximately 70% of the Indian population is dependent on this occupation. Majority of the villagers are connected with this occupation either in a direct or indirect way. People in the western countries are less dependent upon agriculture as compared to the Indian people. For example, only 5% people of England and 12% in America are connected with agriculture.

6. Simple Life :- In villages, the people have plain and simple life. The villagers had to toil hard to fulfil their needs and they did not get any type of rest too. Their children were busy in agriculture and could get education. Even today the villagers live together with love. They stand with one another through every thick and thin. They have limited type of needs and lead a plain and simple life.

7. Mutual relations of People :- Today the Indian villagers are coming in touch with the urban people and their loneliness is declining to some extent. The cause of loneliness of Indian people is lack in means of transportation and communication and illiteracy in the village people. Due to lack of means of transportation and communication the village people are un-connected to the outer world. Their illiteracy creates hindrance in their use of mediums like news-papers, magazines, books etc. Thus they can't set up their link with the outer world. Thus their struggle remains limited up to the surrounding villages and towns only. But today the situation has changed enough.

8. Joint Works :- A family is a unit of production in village life. All the members of family work together unitedly, for example animal-breeding, fishing, knitting baskets and mats, collecting honey etc. All the family members contribute towards these according to their age and ability. This way the workload is divided and working unitedly gives them mental satisfaction.

9. Work Expert :- The works of the village people are traditional and this makes them expert in their profession. For example, a potter that makes pots, is full expert in his work. He worships his work because his fore-fathers also did the same work. Besides, a farmer is necessarily required to know how to repair his plough, how to dig well, how to knit a rope, how to grow vegetables etc. Thus the village people don't expertise in any particular work, but they know well how to do their works of their routine needs. The village women continue doing their day-to-day work, because of which they are not so expert in a particular trade.

10. Social Mobility :- The life of Indian village people is very plain and simple. Due to under-developed agriculture system, small sizes of fields, superstitions etc. the Indian farmer is very much poor. Therefore, with difficulty, they are able to arrange thick grains and thick cloth for themselves. Similarly, simplicity appears in their nature due to lack of education and social mobility. But today, much change has occurred in their life. With expansion of education and appropriate cultivation systems, status of their life has improved.

11. Similarity in Thoughts :- As in cities, the outsiders belonging to different races, do not settle in villages. Therefore, seclusion is not created in village life. Due to this, there is homogeneity in their life. Their prime profession, agriculture, is also the main reason for this unity.

12. Importance of Panchayat :- Panchayat has much importance in Indian village life. A strong public opinion is seen in the society. Normally, village people don't like to act against the public opinion. In village, everyone personally knows each other. In this situation nobody dares to do some unnatural to avoid public opinion going against them. Therefore, all the villagers respect the ideas of the elderly and panches etc. They don't dare to go against them. Basically, the spirit of 'Panch Parmeshwar' remains present in the minds of the villagers.

13. Evils in Women Society :- Even today, the state of women is very low. Though efforts are being made to improve it yet their state is very low as compared to the women of cities. Purdah system, child marriage, joint family system, ancient values are responsible for this low status. In traditional way, the main work of ladies is considered to be at home and no efforts were done to provide education to them. In this way, the status of rural women is very pitiful.

ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENT OF RURAL COMMUNITY

Rural community is the oldest community. Human society developed in rural society. Rural society developed with the process of adaptation of human nature. If we compare the present day villages with ancient villages, we can see that there is huge difference. In order to attain present status, the villages have to go a long way. Villages also come in the category like every social event. Similarly, the development of rural community is an important part in the chain of development of

is makes them expert
is work. He worships
s necessarily required
grow vegetables etc.
well how to do their
day work, because of

and simple. Due to
the Indian farmer is
ns and thick cloth for
n and social mobility.
ation and appropriate

different races, do not
there is homogeneity
this unity.
Indian village life. A
like to act against the
ation nobody dares to
l the villagers respect
Basically, the spirit of

w. Though efforts are
men of cities. Purdah
for this low status. In
efforts were done to
iful.

MMUNITY

in rural society. Rural
mpare the present day
order to attain present
ike every social event.
ain of development of

human society. How the development of rural community took place, it is difficult to say about this. In initial stage, the condition of human was nomadic. They use to roam here and there in search of food they did not have any permanent residence. In the history of human life, humans have left hunting and the first profession they adopted was agriculture. After starting agriculture, they left nomadic life and started to live at a permanent place, because it was compulsory for them to live at a place for agriculture. The man has starting living in small groups in order to be secure from wild animals. These groups took the shape of small colonies and further villages and the rural community evolved.

1. Ancient Period :- In ancient time, man has started search for food to satisfy the hunger. Human race is on the earth since long. In this time period, for more than 99% time period, human community has remained hunter and food collector. They had to go from one place to another place for hunting animals, catching fish, collecting fruits and vegetables because it was not possible to make available these things at a single place. Man used to do hunting and catching fish and woman and children used to collect fruits and flowers. For hunting, men had to roam here and there and fruits and flowers were also not available at one place in every season. In this way, they had no permanent residence. Their residence can be called as community but these were not villages, because till the time man was nomadic, permanent villages were not developed.

2. Proper place for Living :- In ancient time, man thought that rather than killing animals, he should keep them with him making them pet animals. In this way, he can earn more sources of livelihood, those animals also have kids and he can also get milk from them. At this level, human life has become comparatively more certain because it was very tough to change place within a short period with along with animals. When man got irritated with nomadic life, he chose a place for him and started to live there along with animals. In this way, he established a permanent residence for his stay. These places became his native villages.

3. Changes in Human Life :- Human life changed drastically with animal breeding and permanent residence. Humans started agriculture with the help of animals. It is difficult to say about when and where did agriculture first started, but it can be said that agriculture might have started when the man got knowledge about planting seeds and plants. According to Hizer, females first got this knowledge because men used to roam here and there in jungles for hunting. It might be possible that females got this information first that how a plant grow from a seed. With the development of agriculture, human life changed a lot. First is that the food became available in more quantity and regularly. The availability of food more than the requirement, lead to the problem of storage of food and man started to live at a permanent place.

4. Development of Village Society :- It was not possible for agricultural groups to move here and there or to change their residence regularly. It was necessary for them to stay at a permanent

place look after their agriculture. The form of village was not exactly like the present form. There is a lot of change in the formation, organization and form of villages because of the effect of environmental and other reasons. The process of development was dynamic since inception and it is still going on.

In this way, the man started his work with agriculture. He did not have any permanent residence. In the history of human life, agriculture was the first profession, he adopted after he left hunting to satisfy hunger. In this way, man left nomadic life and started to live at a permanent place. These small colonies took the form of villages in later stage. After these villages, cities developed.

CHANGES IN RURAL SOCIETY

Change is the rule of nature. Everything changes with passage of time. In rural communities, change took place on the basis of their size, development and ownership. There were some villages whose development started from the ancient times and the development of some of the villages took place in the recent past. Similarly, the residents of some villages used to roam from one place to another and some used to live at a permanent place. Some sociologists have described the classification of rural communities on the following basis:

1. Decreasing differences in Areas :- The difference between urban and rural areas is decreasing day by day. This is the most important change. The means of transportation, metalled roads, spreading of education and means of communication have made the villages close to cities. Now the rural people are heading towards urban areas at a fast speed.

2. Form of Residence :- The second factor of classification of villages is forms of settlement of residence. Serjan has classified villages in two types on this basis.

First type of villages is known as Grouped Villages. In these types of villages, farmers used to live in houses in groups with their families. The fields are all around these houses. One of the characteristic of these types of villages is that villagers used to live at a high and safe place in groups. The average density of population is very less. There is less mutual cooperation, collaboration and spirit of organization in these villages. In the situation of any disaster, they have to rely on their own capability than the help from others. Because of this reason, these villages have more feeling of isolation.

3. Decreasing dependency on Nature :- Earlier, farmer was completely dependent on natural resources for production. This is not so in present times. Presently, the crops are yielded with new techniques. Now people have more capability to be safe from hot and cold weather.

4. On the basis of ownership :- In such type of villages, people use to live for short period of time and then they leave that village and move further. In real sense, these villages should be called

camps. During their long journeys, the primitive men used to stay at one place till the edibles were available there. When the source of food came to an end at that place, they moved further. Gujjars of Kashmir and Gaddis of Himachal, who use to crib buffaloes, sheep and goat, move towards plain area as when the winter starts. They stay there for approximately six months and as and when summer starts, they move towards hills and stay there for rest of the six months.

The second type of villages is called as semi-permanent agriculture villages by Peake. In these villages too, men do not live there on permanent basis rather they stay there for short period. Till this stage of civilization, man learnt agriculture but he did not know how to maintain the fertility of the land by the use of fertilizers. So, in these villages, man used to live for the time till its land remained fertile.

The members of third type of villages used to stay at a permanent place for generation to generation. They don't need to change their residence from time to time because they knew permanent ways of agriculture.

5. Social Stratification and Mobility :- According to this classification, rural communities are divided on the basis of social discrimination, continuity and land ownership. In the first type of villages, farmers don't have any individual right on the agricultural land rather there is joint ownership. This situation remained with the development of culture. In that era, tribe, kutumb, and family are one and the same thing. They use to live and do farming together. Till this time, there was no concept of individual property or ownership. Karl Marx has called this primitive communalism.

In second type of villages, farmers don't do their own farming; rather they use to serve any land owner as employees. They were neither lessee, nor owners but they were laborers. They are called as agriculturist labor.

In third type of villages, agricultural employees were either agriculture employees or agriculture labor. But their owner is not any land owner rather any state organization or any religious organization (temple, church, gurudwara, etc.). These people work in these organizations like labors on the basis of agriculture. In this type of villages, all the farmers are tenants of land collectively because of agriculture.

As per fourth phase, any type of tax or fine is paid by all the farmers of the village collectively in equal ratio. It is not necessary for them to be the owner of the land or the production from the land, usually they are farmers only. These types of villages are not found in present times. With the development of the history, individualism has developed and one person has the right on the land.

In fifth type of villages, there are no collective rights on agricultural land rather persons have individual rights on land. In such type of villages, land owner or landlord has the right on whole

land. Farmers give tax or fine to landlord for using the land for agriculture. Before independence, most of the villages in our country were of this kind. These were also known as feudal farm but after independence, the situation changed and personal tenancy has changed into personal ownership.

6. Change in the living standard of People :- In present times, because of low impact of caste system, there is a lot of change in the habits of people. People are using artificial food rather than simple food. Earlier, people used to wear linen shirt but now they wear pants, jeans, shirt, etc. Purdah system has almost eliminated. Now females wear modern jewelry.

7. Native village :- In these types of villages, one head conducts whole agriculture system and head is decided on heritable basis. In these villages, legislation is based on natural rules. These villages are in existence since ancient times. No major change can be seen in these villages. People use to live together with unity. These villages are exactly opposite to rayatwadi villages.

In these Villages, there is no head, conductor or owner. Whole land of the village and money is considered as joint property. Because of contribution in every villager in agriculture, everyone gets equal share in production and consumption. This is like a joint family system. In these villages, traditions and customs are given priority.

In the above discussion, we have described the classification of villages on different basis. But no valid classification is available. Still, efforts are required in this direction.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What is village community? Explain the characteristics of Indian village's community.
2. Describe the origin and development of rural society.
3. Describe the classification of rural communities.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 4
INSTITUTIONAL FEATURES IN RURAL SOCIETY

MARRIAGE IN VILLAGES

Marriage is a social institution. It not only gives recognition to man-woman relations but also to other relations. Marriage is the foundation of family. Sexual life starts upon marriage. Home is set up, produces off springs and up brings them. In other words, marriage is an institution which permits man and woman to live a family life and the society gives legal recognition to the children produced by their relations. Marriage has been approved as an institution for keeping stability and balance in the contemporary society.

Even after the independence of India, establishment of Panchayati Raj is included in villages and the country can't progress unless its villages progress. Mahatma Gandhi understood this fact very well and to achieve this he wanted to make every village an independent unit of a state. The authors of the constitution made a provision under Section 40 that the states will take steps to set up Panchayati Raj in villages and will empower them for self-governance and to work as independent units.

Family is the basic unit of society. A family produces children who, on growing up, will make future of the country. Every society has been setting up families since ancient times. Strength of a society or a country is directly related to strength of family. Combination of man and woman is essential to set up a family. Their combination starts the beginning of family. The tradition of marriage has been ongoing since ancient times. From time to time there have been changes in this tradition. Rituals are essential in a marriage all over the world. Different societies perform it in their own way. Some take it as a religious ceremony, in some it is social and in others it is a friendly convenient agreement. In India tradition of marriage has been ongoing since centuries. The bride's family gives lot of wealth and articles of domestic use to the bridegroom's parents so that their daughter does not face any type of problem after marriage, but still the girl has to face many problems. These days preference is given to dowry at the time of marriage.

DEFINITIONS OF MARRIAGE

The scholars have given different definitions of marriage. Some important of them are given below: -

1. According to **Hurton and Hunt** "Marriage is the approved pattern in which two or more people establish a family."

2. R.H. Lovy states that "Marriage becomes the foundation of family life. Marriage clearly expresses the relations that remain stable after sexual satisfaction."

3. According to **Westermark,** "Marriage is a relation between one or more men to one or more women which is recognized by institution or law, and involves certain rights and duties both in the case of parties entering the union and in the case of children born out of it."

4. Hoebal states that "Marriage is the complex of social norms that define and control the relations of a mated pair to each other, their kinsmen then offspring and society."

5. According to **Majumdar,** "Marriage is socially approved union of male and female, or as secondary institutions by society to sanction the union and mating of male and female, for purpose of

(*i*) Establishing a household

(*ii*) Entering into sex relations

(*iii*) Procreating and providing care for the offspring."

From the above definitions it is clear that marriage is a bond in which, after satisfying his sexual desire with the female, the male takes the responsibility of upbringing her and her children.

AIMS OF MARRIAGE

Different scholars have considered over the question as to why marriages are made, what is its necessity. Some scholars have considered its need and the others its purpose. Some scholars have described the following simple purposes of marriage:

1. Psychological Satisfaction :- Husband and wife not only satisfy each other's sexual desires but also get sentimentally connected which increases their mental peace.

2. Construction of Family :- It is a fact that only marriage assists man to become an important member of society. Home is established after marriage only. He enjoys sex, produces off-springs and up brings them.

3. Satisfaction of Sexual Desires :- Marriage is such an institution which socially permits him to satisfy his sexual desires. Satisfaction of sexual desires gives him pleasure which is called sexual pleasure.

4. Upbringing of Children :- Every husband-wife discharge their important responsibility well as parents by upbringing their children.

5. To Establish the Cultural Continuity :- Many desires of man are satisfied through his children. He wants to see his desires being satisfied though his children. His children save his family and with it remain cultural continuity.

6. Procreation :- Man produces children to maintain continuity of his family. His children give him self-satisfaction. Their children can continue his family.

7. Performance of Religious Duties :- Every man has to perform some religious duties in his life and he requires wife for the purpose. The discharge of religious duties is also a specialty of marriage.

As a result, we can say that not only the sexual desires are satisfied by marriage in society, many other responsibilities are also related to it.

CHARACTERISTICS OF RURAL MARRIAGE

1. Marriage is Necessary :- In rural society marriage is considered very much necessary. It is very necessary particularly for girls. If a girl does not get married, the parents understand themselves as non-performers of their duty. Rural society understands that it is necessary for women to become mothers because this further runs society.

2. No Divorce :- Divorce is prohibited in rural marriage. According to Hindu religious texts, "Marriage is an unbreakable bond." It can't be broken at own will. Thus, rural marriage does not permit divorce. But now provision of divorce has been made under Hindu Marriage Act 1955.

3. Restriction on Widow Remarriage :- According to Hindu religious scriptures while marrying a girl parents donate their daughter. It is called 'Kanya-Daan'(Donation of daughter). Under this ideology, widow-remarriage has been explained as donation of the thing again, which is already donated, by taking it back. Because a thing, once donated can't be taken back. Therefore, there is a strict restriction on widow remarriage in villages.

4. The aim of Village Marriage is Religious :- It is a specialty of a village marriage that its aim is religious. Marriage in different religions and societies has different aims. Hindu marriage's aim is to fulfil duty towards religion. A Hindu has to perform different 'Yajnas' (Yagya) such as PitriYajna, Braham Yajna, Dev Yajna, etc. to fulfill his different duties which can be performed by a married person only.

5. Marriage in own Caste :- This might be from religious point of view. A village marriage is done in own caste only. Any Hindu, by birth, can't marry out of his caste.

6. Many Defects :- There are many defects like child marriage, dowry system, and tradition of purdah etc, which have crept into the marriage system. These traditions have done great loss to the institution of village marriage.

7. Arranged Marriage :- In villages marriage is understood the union of two families, two groups or two villages. That's why parents play an important role in finding life partner for their children. Much importance is given to the size, status and financial situation of the family while fixing marriage. Besides the individual qualities of the child are also kept in mind.

8. Hindu Marriage is a Sacrament :- Village marriage is a sacrament. This can't be violated because it has a religious aim. From his birth till death, a Hindu has to pass through a number of rituals.

RULES OF MARRIAGE

Current generation doesn't want to seek permission of their parents for marriage. Rules of marriage have undergone numerous changes. Marriage of children is a big issue in every society. It is very difficult to select a life partner for marriage. It is compulsory to marry not only in the same tribe and clan but also in the same caste or sub-caste. Usually every society has different rules which keep changing with time.

These three points of views can be described as follows:

1. The Field of Selection :- While selecting a life partner the Hindus believe in the following two principles :

(*i*) Endogamy :- Hindu society has many castes which further have sub-castes. Under this principle every Hindu can marry within his own caste or sub-caste.

Different sub-castes are divided into parts which further have sub-parts, like – Visa, Dasa etc. Sub-parts Visa and Dasa are further divided into Ahmedabadi and Special Bhatti, depending upon place of their residence. Selection of life-partner has to be made out of these groups, as these are the end point for marriage.

(*ii*) Exogamy :- Hindus are prohibited to marry in their own clan (Gotra). Sometimes prohibition is there to marry in the same area where they are settled. Exogamy is also a principle for selection of mate according to which individual has to marry outside his clan. This makes the field much limited and thus creates problems in selection of mate. Many children have to face such situation because in Hindus it is essential to marry, leaving aside seven generations of their father's and five generations of mother's clan. Thus field for selection of mate from outside the clan and within caste, becomes limited.

2. Criteria of Selecting a Mate :- There are also some criterion for selecting a mate:-

(*i*) Family :- In Hindu theologies and souvenirs, an emphasis has been given to marry children in physically flawless, religious duty-performing and nice families. At that time care was taken to marry girl in family with status equal to or higher than her own. It was also emphasized not to marry in such families that don't perform their duties, how much ever the family rich or of high status. The boy should not be married in such a family where only girls are born.

The financial situation and nature of family members is considered while selecting mate. Any history of any incurable disease in the family is also taken into account. The public opinion regarding financial and cultural life of the family is also considered.

***(ii)* Qualifications of Bride :-** Presently, the qualifications for selecting a girl or a boy for the marriage are quite different from those in the past. These days, an emphasis is put on girl's age, health, character, education, job, financial and social status of her family and her ability to perform household work. Whereas in case of boys, his age, qualification, service, occupation, income, and the size, financial and social status of the family is looked into while selecting mate.

In older time, a father in the family used to select life-partner for his child. Both husband and wife used to live together life-long, lead comfortable and happy life. Such marriages are mostly successful. But now-a-days girls and boys themselves select their mates and such marriages are usually unsuccessful.

***(iii)* Dowry :-** The tradition of dowry was not so developed in ancient time. Presently it is prevalent. Dowry is the wealth or property gifted by a father to his daughter at the time of her marriage.

Tradition of dowry has increased in India. At current time it is prevalent all over India. It has narrowed the scope of selection of mate. Therefore, girls have been facing problems before as well as after their marriage. Many parents are not capable of giving dowry. Going abroad is another criterion while selecting mate in modern India. Many families prefer boy for their daughter who is either already settled abroad or is going to settle there in near future.

3. Party to Select in Marriage :- Eight ways to select mate were prevalent in ancient India. Out of which four were considered pious and the remaining four were considered profane (impious). Out of four profanes, two were considered 'Demon or Monster Marriage'. This was a condemnable task. In this task, the girl was kidnapped either forcibly or while in her sleep or under her intoxication. This kind of marriage or selection of mate is not approvable under any circumstances. A girl or boy themselves selected mate for themselves in 'Gandharva Marriage'. The tradition of 'Swayamwar' had also prevalent since ancient India and this was a way to select life partner. The princesses used to select their life partner under this system. In profane marriage the boy gave money to girl's parents and in return used to get her as his wife.

At that time 'Braham Dev', 'Adarsh' and 'Prajapati' were the approved systems of marriage. Under all these approved systems the father gave his daughter as a gift to the boy. In other words, the father had right to decide bridegroom for the girl at the time of her birth.

In traditional marriages parents of boy could ask him about his choice for a particular girl he wanted to marry, but there was no such tradition in case of a girl. This could be called a selection by parents. The girl had to marry the boy selected by her parents.

In current era parents give independent right to boy and girl to select their life partner. The children also want to select their mate themselves. That is why 'Love Marriage' and 'Inter-Caste' marriages have come into existence. The selection of their mate is done by boy and girl themselves.

They both agree to marry each other. In case their parents don't agree for the marriage, they marry against their consent.

CHARACTERISTIC OF RURAL ECONOMY

1. Method of Production :- Production in fields was very low before Green Revolution. After Green Revolution there was big increase in the produce with use of new seeds and fertilizers. Now farmers are making much use of fertilizers and new seeds.

2. Unemployment :- Unemployment means not getting work despite willingness to do it. The problem of unemployment is present in both rural and urban areas, but it is more serious in rural areas. It has turned into a big problem in India. The problems of 'total unemployment' and 'under unemployment' or 'latent unemployment' are also present in rural areas. The population engaged in agriculture is already double than that is required for it.

3. Dominance of Agriculture :- According to 1981 Census, 75% of the total population lives in villages, 70% of which is directly dependent on agriculture. The Indian rural economy is agriculture based. 49% of the total national income is got from the agriculture. From which it is clear that agriculture dominates the Indian rural economy.

4. Indebtedness :- Indebtedness is a general problem in Indian rural community. In Indian village community indebtedness is a common problem. The indebtedness of farmers is a key feature of Indian rural economy. Indian farmers are poor, but to maintain their respect in the society, they don't hesitate to spend more than their capacity on marriages, death or any other family celebrations.

The alarming fact is that major part of their debt is taken for consumption and not for the production. It means that the debt is unproductive that negatively affects the rural economy. Unproductive debt, once taken, can't be returned and another debt has to be raised for re-payment of the first one. Thus the farmer gets trapped in a machination and this continues generation to generation.

5. Poverty :- "Poverty is insufficiency of things that are essential for the health and fitness of a man or his dependents." Poverty is a big problem in Indian rural economy. In other words "It the state of man in which expenses are more than his income and it is not possible to maintain his affordability physically as well as mentally. Thus there is shortage of things essential for living."

It is clear from the above that there are many reasons for the poverty in rural community. Poverty is the main problem in rural economy. Traditionally, a man's luck or his doings were blamed for his poverty, but the current economic situation is so much complicated that only the individual can't be held responsible for poverty. Poverty generates under-nourishment which adversely affects the process of production.

Increasing population, decline in agriculture production, illiteracy, non-ownership of land and unemployment are the main causes for poverty Indian rural economy.

6. More Population :- There is more population in rural society. Our country is next to China in this regard. Due to more population the progress in development in different fields appears negligible. Most of the people of rural community are dependent on agriculture. Country's economy, therefore, depends on agriculture. Half the income of the country is directly or indirectly related to the agriculture.

7. Rural Industries :- Rural industries play a vital role in rural economy. These days rural industry is scientific. Keeping in view increase in population and rise in its poverty, the government is encouraging setting up small scale industries under self-employment schemes.

8. An Underdeveloped Economy :- India is a developing country and its being an 'agrarian' is the main cause for under-progress of its economy. Galberth has described reasons for the backward or under-developed agriculture as follows:

(*i*) Indebtedness is far more as compared to the assets and income.

(*ii*) The systems of agriculture and the instruments used are outdated.

(*iii*) The agriculture land being on a small scale and scattered the agriculturists are sentimentally attached to it and their land is further sub-divided with increase in population.

(*iv*) Due to shortage of savings, small land owners and farmers can't tolerate even short term difficulties/calamities and try to take maximum production in the minimum period, which decreases fertile power of the land thereby resulting into lower yield.

(*v*) The system for produce in the local market is too old and incapable. Selling is on very small scale and has no effect as to whether the farmer is a land-owner or a sharecropper.

Harvey Leibenstein has described the symptoms of under-developed areas as follows:

(*i*) Increase in population, higher birth rate.

(*ii*) Inferior status of women in society.

(*iii*) Insufficient and inadequate food.

(*iv*) Lack of means of communication and transportation in rural areas.

9. Economic Disparities :- Big disparities are there in the economic conditions of the villagers in Indian rural economy. The land owners who get farming done by other agriculture labor and farmers come in the category of 'Owners'. They are not themselves bound to farming. Those who work for money or grain are categorized as 'farmers'. Sometimes they are given a small piece of land which is insufficient for their fulfilment or living.The tenants who themselves do farming sufficient for their families, are called farmers. But they are not in position to engage as laborer.

Conclusion :- Economic problem is the burning problem in Indian rural communities. Their standard of living is very low and there is poverty everywhere. Though there have been a lot of changes in Indian rural society but ignorance of a common villager is still as before.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. Write a detailed note on Rural Economy.

   Or

   Describe the Rural Economy.
2. Describe the Organization, Functions and present form of Caste Panchayat.
3. Give the Historical introduction of Village Panchayat in India.
4. What do you mean by Village Community? Which changes are coming in it at present?
5. Which changes have taken place in the life of Indian Village Community after Independence?

   Or

   What do you understand by Village Community? Describe the helping factors in the growth of Rural Communities.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

rural communities. Their
there have been a lot of
l as before.

NS

nchayat.

ning in it at present?
nity after Independence?

ing factors in the growth

CHAPTER – 5
URBAN SOCIETY

Presently there are so many cities and towns in the country. People's life has been greatly affected by the increase in population in the cities. Urban population is increasing fast in our country. Needs of the rich are easily fulfilled but it is very difficult for the poor to fulfil their needs.

In India village communities came into being after clans and nomadic. Thereafter the towns and cities developed. Urban society is actually a product of industrial revolution. Small scale industries being run by human hands were replaced by factories run by machines, that's why it is called Industrial Revolution. The process of turning villages into cities is Urbanization. When due to industrialization or any other reason villages are converted into cities, this is called urbanization.

The process of urbanization is specifically affected by the process of industrialization. Both urbanization and industrialization are simultaneous processes. These are inter-dependents. Not only one of them affects the life style of a community, but both processes simultaneously affect the different aspects of social structure. It is clear from the above that urbanization is a dual process. In the process, first a village turns into a city and secondly increase in the population of the city. Village people get attracted to the cities which encourages urbanization. Employment further increases. Industries flourish which encourages industrialization.

URBANIZATION AND ITS SOCIO-ECONOMIC EFFECTS

Urbanization means development of towns and cities. The development of the cities depends upon the people living there. The people's trend towards living in the cities had started early. In 1951, total population of Punjab was 9.16 Million out of which 1.99 million was urban. Slowly the urban population began to rise. In cities the people are not agriculturists, but they have other means of earning. Villagers who are not agriculturists, come to cities to earn their livelihood. This process continues increasing population in the towns and cities. In cities the villagers besides work to earn their livelihood, they get many other additional facilities. Facilities for better education are also there. There government and private agriculture hospitals are available for safeguarding health. Besides these, no one creates hindrance for the other. That's the reason the villages started living in cities. These days Biharis are abundantly present in Punjab. Some of them help in agriculture in villages. While majority work as laborers in different fields. Mostly only Biharis are seen in every field. Most of them have built up their own pucca houses in the cities for living. This has abundantly increased their population in the towns and cities of Punjab. According to Dr. Gopal Krishan, in 1991 urban population had reached 6 million whereas total population of Punjab was 20 million.

The government earlier didn't much succeed in developing cities and towns according to a particular plan. Therefore, the Govt. of Punjab set up 'Town and Country Planning Department in

1961. This department made many big plans for the small and large cities and implemented Urban Development Programme. The cities began developing under this plan.

Cities are actually administrative and financial centers. The geographical, economic and political situation of cities greatly contribute in the development of city centers. The town or city that is surrounded by more villages and has got facilities for industrial development, will develop more. The cities having big industrial units and business centers will develop soon. From the point of view of population, there are three types of city centers in Punjab. One having population less than 10,000, second having population between 10,000 and 50,000 and the third having population more than 50,000. Small cities are the centers for rural products which are further linked to the big cities for business and financial purposes.

City business centers have developed more due to development of agriculture in Punjab. Some small cities and towns situated near some villages, have become business centers. Keeping in view the expansion of cities, the government built up new bus-stands to facilitate the public of cities. Model Towns were developed in the big cities for the increasing population. Due to rise in population of the cities, the government has arranged many direct and Bye-Pass roads so that the public does not face any difficulty.

The people belonging to scheduled caste also got attracted towards cities, which much increased their population there. According to Dr. Gopal Krishan in 1961 there were 12.9% scheduled caste people in the cities which increased every year and in 1991 it reached 19.8%. Thus there is enough contribution of the scheduled castes in development of cities. They increased most in Hoshiarpur, Gurdaspur and Jalandhar districts.

SOCIAL EFFECTS OF URBANIZATION

Urbanization had many effects on Indian society. The village people started living in the cities. This created many new social classes in the urban society. Though the labor class was already there in the cities but their number very much increased due to urbanization resulting into the entrance of many categories of people in the cities. A large number of laborers and artisans from Bihar started living in cities of Punjab. Their language and culture is quite different from that of Punjab. They became an important category of Punjab. Their strength is increasing gradually. They are influencing Punjabi culture too. Besides there are categories of businessmen, industrialists and laborers in cities. They have their own place in society. Government officials have their own separate class.

The village people have affected many customs of urban society. Many categories of labor class have started getting higher posts after getting education. They are also marrying in other classes, resulting into generation of new customs by merging customs of two different categories. Cities have better arrangement of education. Many schools, colleges and technical institutes have opened there. Educated people have adopted a vast outlook which has eased the development of society. The educated people always have a new society that keeps marching towards progress.

d implemented Urban

phical, economic and
nters. The town or city
lopment, will develop
p soon. From the point
naving population less
hird having population
urther linked to the big

agriculture in Punjab.
ess centers. Keeping in
facilitate the public of
pulation. Due to rise in
-Pass roads so that the

, which much increased
12.9% scheduled caste
%. Thus there is enough
ed most in Hoshiarpur,

N

le started living in the
labor class was already
tion resulting into the
orers and artisans from
e different from that of
reasing gradually. They
smen, industrialists and
have their own separate

any categories of labor
also marrying in other
vo different categories.
echnical institutes have
ed the development of
ng towards progress.

No class victimizes or tortures the other. Thus every class remains involved in its business and social harmony is seen in the cities.

Many people belonging to scheduled castes, have begun their business in the cities. They have started living there. Many have built up their houses too. But many of them live in slums and are short of basic amenities. Though government is trying its most to give facilities to them. There has been a great shortage of electricity and water supply. Besides many social problems have also arisen there.

Along with urbanization, the government is giving its attention to the issues arisen with rise in population and public welfare. The government hospitals have been expanded. Schools and colleges are quite open. Roads have been built. Better arrangements for power and water supply are being made. Peace has been maintained completely. Seeing these facilities, people are rushing towards cities. According to an estimate half the population of Punjab will settle in cities up to the year 2020.

ECONOMIC EFFECTS

Like social effects, some economic effects have also been there due to urbanization. With rise in urban population, the laborers are easily available for the industry in cities. The industrialists have financially gained due to more availability of laborers as compared to their demand. Similarly those who were jobless in villages got work for their livelihood in the cities. Those who were landless or who had no land for farming, came to cities and somehow or other they got some type of work to do.

People from Bihar and many other states (Bhaiyas) have come to Punjab. Financially, they have harmed the Punjabi laborers very much. They started work of many types. They work as laborers in building houses and pull rickshaw also. Many of them have started running auto-rickshaws by raising loans. Most of the vegetable rehdis (Mobile vending shops) also belong to them. They work in shops too. This way labor became cheaper which harmed the labor class of Punjab.

The business has also swollen in cities. Urban business has also gone up along with industrial development, due to big increase in population in the cities. Therefore sale of goods has picked up as compared to earlier. Due to increase in population there is rush of customers in every shop which has boosted the business. Every type of vegetable and fruit is available in the market. This is all due to growth of market to which means of livelihood of many people is linked.

Small cities are connected with villages. The crops or produce of villages are sold in the nearby town or market of the city which fulfils their daily needs. In big cities, the traders put orders for supply of fruit and vegetables to other states, according to the requirement or need of their customers. This way the traders gain well. This is the effect of urbanization.

This is true that city life is expensive as compared to the village life, but there are more means of income in cities too. But every item has to be purchased at its price. The status of the city people, particularly the rich class, has gone up due to good income. The poor is earning to live from hand

to mouth, but no body dies of hunger. Everybody does something for making his both ends meet. Due to rise in population the means of income of the people have also gone up. With prevalent peaceful atmosphere of the cities, people are leading a good life there.

SOCIAL EFFECTS OF IMPERSONAL SOCIAL RELATIONS

The social effects of the impersonal social relations can be described as under: -

The impersonal relations are found among the family members also, because they are busy in different jobs as a result of which family is converted into a hotel, where people gather to eat and take rest. Lack of mutual co-operation, love and affection gradually weakens the family and leads it to dissolution. When the people don't have close relations, they don't interfere in affairs of one another. As a result people feel fully independent and live life at their will. Thus every individual attains complete independence. In cities people don't take much interest in anyone's social or private life. So it is none of their concern which one believes in which religion. They are not concerned with anyone's language, culture, thinking etc. As a result there are no tussles originate over anyone's language, religion or food. The man lives among thousands of other men, but he finds no one to share what is in his mind or his troubles and agonies. Thus, one feels himself lonely and helpless despite living among so many people. In cities thick population and impersonal relations are found. These peculiarities have many effects on social life. Some are good for society and the individual and others are bad too.

CHARACTERISTICS OF URBAN ECONOMY

In cities, there are so many industries which have given employment to many people. The description of urban economy is as under: -

1. Division of Labor :- In urban society, there is dissimilarity in labor. In the past, the family was a unit of production. All requirements of an individual were fulfilled in the family itself. But after the development in cities different type of work is divided among different people, due to which division of labor is prevalent there. Every individual is an expert in his work.

2. Nature of getting More Profit :- It is a characteristic of the urban economy that the people want to get maximum profit here. The industrialists want to earn maximum profit with minimum investment. Everybody tries to earn maximum, may be through unfair means. The laborer wants to get maximum. The shopkeeper tries to charge maximum for his goods. Thus everybody wishes to be rich.

3. Importance of Money :- Money is very important in urban economy because everything is acquired with money. Rich people have more high status, while those having less are not given any importance in society.

4. Different Types of People :- Different types of people live in cities and they adopt different kinds of jobs. No type of job or task can be called important. Many types of jobs are in vogue here.

One is found a Clerk and the other may be Accountant, a Taxi Driver, a Teacher, a Private Servant, an officer in the Telephone Department, a businessman or might be a hawker. Thus every type of work in the cities, particularly those related with industrial trade, run on large scale. Therefore, division of job becomes essential. In the context of conducting works on large scale, specialists are required. Therefore, in urban economy, a judge, a doctor, an engineer etc. all are specialists in their respective fields. In urban economy a person's respect is based on his personal qualities and not on his birth. This makes ideal personalities selfish and everybody is busy meeting his own interests.

5. Increasing Population :- The rural people like to live in cities. Thick population is a peculiarity of the urban economy. The more important is the city from industrial angle, the more will be the population. Development of industrial trades in cities attracts rural people and they are more coming to cities because here they get every type of job.

6. Solid Economic Structure :- Investment plays an important role in urban economy and to earn maximum is the target of every industrialist here. People in cities pay their attention mainly to their jobs. They work overtime and thus strengthen the economic structure. In the similar way, people connected with business and commerce also strengthen their nature of making maximum profit through both fair and unfair means. Money gets more importance in urban economy, because respect of an individual, is directly related to it. In such societies, money is also a source to get political power. Variation found in the social set-up, is a describable characteristic of the urban economy. Due to facilities available for Industrial trade, business and commerce in the cities, people belonging to different religions, castes & creeds, categories and states, come and settle here. Due to which, no uniformity is found in the living style, language, dressing-sense etc. of the people. This maintains social diversity in the society.

7. Industrialization :- The country has progressed a lot with development in industrial units. In urban societies, small scale & cottage industries have been replaced by big industrial units run by modern machines. These big units may be under private ownership or government owned. Because economic units are run with very big modern machines. Sufficient benefit is possible only when the production work is on large scale. Mills and factories are run round the clock by shift-system. A very big investment is required for setting up and working of the big mills and factories. It is, therefore, said that not lacs but crores of rupees are involved in urban economy.

8. Urban Associations :- In cities many associations are functioning for their own benefits. People having blazonment in living style, dressing-sense, ethics, way of talking etc. get more respect in urbans society. The value of urban economy depends most on artificiality and external show-offs. Lavish expenditure is done to maintain this show-off. These associations or groups work for their vested interests. During this arises problem to control their activities. There are so large number of these associations which makes it impossible to control them. Therefore, the help from law, police force, courts and army is taken to control them.

9. Education and Science :- The urban people are educated and act with understanding. Education removes conventionality. As a result of which we don't trust religious superstitions. Co-relation of education and science lowers the importance of religion and family too. Besides this,

availability of many facilities in urban economy, we can eat in hotels also. Clothes can be got cleaned from laundries. Even for entertainment and other needs can be fulfilled from outside the home. Therefore, man does not feel so much necessity of family.

10. Problem of Drug Addiction :- Urban people live a luxurious life with the result that their children are trapped in bad company. Drug addiction causes many more problems in the cities. Crime is more in cities which generates other new problems. If science and education have contributed towards man's progress, they have created new modes of crime too. Different problems include mainly problem of famine, poverty and disease, alcoholism etc. These problems have polluted and corrupted the urban atmosphere very much.

11. Mental Disturbance :- The people in cities always live in an atmosphere polluted with noise. The people here never have peace and rest and they are always busy in their work. They are always facing mental turbulence within. Because if on one hand they have facilities to eat, to earn wealth and to lead luxurious life etc., there are accidents, unemployment, loss in business etc. are their routine, on the other. Under these uncertainties, the man does not get mental peace and his day and night working makes him sick.

12. Social Qualities :- Every type of facility is available to the city people. Accessory-Groups are present there in excess and they have 'Touch and Go' attitude. In fact, in industrial societies the links are mostly set up through post, tele-communication, telephone, cinema etc. and personal relations are negligible here. All remain busy in fulfilling their own interests and every group or individual tries to beat or knockdown the other. The competition gets harder. Everybody has got facility to grow according to his ability in the urban economic atmosphere. It is due to these social facilities that the life is more comfortable in cities than villages.

CHARACTERISTICS OF URBAN SOCIETY

1. Competition :- Mostly educated and qualified people live in cities. Therefore, there is always competition going on, for getting admission in educational institutions, services or jobs and for getting promotion in service. In urban community, everybody has got opportunities to rise. The competition has become more hard with Industrial development.

2. Technology and Invention :- More advanced technique, education and different types of educational institutions are available in cities as compared to villages. The people in cities have to face new problems in their day-to-day life and therefore they continue to invent solution to their problems. Better education, better technique and science are available in cities only.

3. Industrial Progress :- The current is the age of machines. Every individual completes his work before time, otherwise it would have taken long. To strengthen their financial position, the people come to cities and keep wandering from city to city exploring the better job opportunities. In cities, a man is respected not by his caste or religion, but by his ability, status and high financial position. Industrial progress has most affected the social mobility. In city every kind of wish of an individual is fulfilled. Wishes of an individual are personal, so he is not concerned about the group, community, family, caste and religion. He is his own master and he is not under anyone's control. He lives life in his own way and doesn't care for another's ideals.

4. Selfish Person :- Those living in cities have a complex life. At every step they have to compete. There is competition between different categories, jobs and services. Ethics are continuously losing their values before materialism. Hedonist and consumerist industrial development has inspired man to go to lowest standard. The man may sell himself to fulfil his interests. He is not ashamed of stifling his humanity. Neither society nor family or his community, has got any control over him. The man in a city is fully selfish and opportunist. He is not concerned about moral values.

5. Lack of Living Places :- There is scarcity of living places in cities due to large population. It is a very big problem in big cities. The poor live roadsides or in huts. In cities, all the members of the family live in small houses, which leads children view something which may not be suitable for them.

6. New Social Relations :- There is a lot of difference in rural and urban societies. In villages, a family is a fundamental institution which fulfills man's most of the needs. But in cities are centers of complexity. Here organizations have to be set up to fulfil his needs. The man tries to satisfy his needs through these. Village society has simplicity in social relations. Everyone is well aware of his role and status. Neither artificiality nor stink of deceit is felt in their behavior. On the contrary, the city people have artificial relations. Here relations are not set up out of feelings, instead they are set up with people belonging to different caste, community and category based on one's selfish motives. Thūs, his urban relations are temporary.

7. New Social Class :- Different classes play their vital role to maintain the existing social set-up. It has been since ancient times that different social classes have been traditionally fulfilling needs of the society. But currently these classes are more flexible and variable. Now, either new classes are set up or the old ones change their workings so much that they appear to be new. There is a great difference in the traditional society and urban society. In cities, a man works according to rules, whereas rural society is not bound to any such rule and works according to the weather. There is no time management for them.

8. Disorganization of Joint Families :- These days people don't like to live in families. Here live people belonging to different cultures, caste & creed and religions. There is a great difference in their role-models, ideas, thinking, values and outlook etc. Every individual looks and thinks from his own point of view and acts accordingly. Therefore, similarities like those in rural society, are not found. It is not possible to control traditional rules and beliefs in the cities. There is less community spirit in cities. Here, neither one group nor a community spirit exists. Neither the people are afraid of public-censure nor are they considerate about their neighbor. Everyone here thinks that all others are corrupt, fallen and unethical. City is the center of diversities. Here, standards and roles are not clear. Man is unable to think, how to work to keep his family, his officers, his colleagues etc. happy.

9. Changes in Married Life :- Besides other changes in urban society, the beliefs regarding married life have also changed. Sometimes, working of both husband and wife at different places, creates differences between them. There is difference of opinion in each other's targets and ideas. These differences sometimes lead them to divorce. In industrial cities, men and women have been

working together for years and know each other well. They know each other's interests, nature and habits. Their understanding results into their love-marriage. Thus, the structure of city life has much changed and the beliefs and norms, connected therewith, are also undergoing change. An individual is more vigilant regarding his rights in cities. Love-marriages and inter-caste marriages are continuously increasing. He has his own ideas and outlooks regarding economic, social and political topics. Therefore, they set up their own committees to fulfil their own motives having diverse ideas.

10. Modern Way of Life :- Increase in distance of modern man from Nature is turning his life to artificiality. The entire environment of the cities, is full of artificiality. The whole life of man i.e. life-style, diet, dressing-sense, way of talking etc. have become artificial. This has become a fashion. He claims himself to be an intellectual by displaying books-cupboard. By using imported things, he artificially claims to be a top sawyer. Display of luxury goods in drawing room, artificially show his economic status. Use of Hi, Ta-ta, Bye-bye, Dad-Mom, etc. in behavior, are fully artificial addresses. Use of knife and fork on the breakfast table is merely show off. Having dinner in big hotels is a token of his artificial life. A man's body works like a machine-tool from dawn till dusk. His sense of feeling, emotions, heart-touching behavior etc. all have become like a lifeless machine. Because of this his life has been filled with more artificiality than originality.

IMPACT OF URBAN SOCIAL RELATION ON PERSONALITY

The personality building process of a man entirely depends upon his surrounding environment. We find a huge difference in personalities of individuals living in villages, cities and metros. A villager is simple, straightforward, illiterate, religious, conservative and traditional. Whereas individual living city is clever, literate, progressive, selfish and opportunist. From this we come to know that the environment of a place plays an important role in building personality. From the following, we can understand this phenomenon:

City life is competitive. An individual here is well aware that no one will come to help him in his distress. Therefore he doesn't want to take any risk. He is concerned with his business only. City makes a man tolerant. In city life, one's secrets can be shared with few people only. The city environment makes man selfish. He is surrounded with his desires. He acts on his own will. He gives preferences only to his desires and wishes. To fulfil his desires, he does what he doesn't want to do.

DEFINITION AND FEATURES OF URBAN FAMILY

Family is one of the fundamental units of the society. Family affects both an individual as well as the society. Every child grows up in family to become an able citizen. The prime purpose of a family is to have children and up bring them. Fulfillment of sexual desires is possible only in a family, because society accepts it in family only. A city-family includes husband-wife and their children only, which is quite different from a joint family. The love between family members found

in villages is absent in city family members. Village families are joint families in which all the members live of life full of mutual love and dependence. They bear one-another's sorrows and sufferings, whereas an individual in the city is selfish and always thinks about himself only. The effects of industrialization and urbanization have brought about many transformations and have changed the structural character of the family. In a joint family people from many generations live together, and that is no so in a family in the city.

DEFINITIONS OF FAMILY

1. According to **Clare**, "Family is a system of relationship existing between parents and children".
2. According to **Elliot and Merrill**, "A family is Biological Social Unit consisting husband, wife and children."

CHARACTERISTICS OF URBAN FAMILY

Given below are the characteristics of an urban family:

1. Urban families are not so big, these are very small and nuclear families.
2. Children of urban families set up their own establishments after their marriage. They don't live with their parents.
3. Children in city families are small in number, because urban people are educated and are acquainted with benefits of small families.
4. People of urban families are well aware of their work.
5. Urban family members have an individualistic approach, they are selfish and think of themselves only.
6. In urban families every member acts upon his own will and doesn't seek advice from family members and does whatever he wishes.
7. Urban people, being educated, seldom have faith in religion and they put everything to the test of reasoning.
8. In urban family members, individualism is more as compared to mutual love.
9. Women in the urban families have status equal to that of a man because they also earn and contribute towards the family income.
10. Urban family members prefer going to cinema and clubs, watching T.V., listening radio etc. instead of spending their time with their family members.
11. Break-ups in urban families are more as compared to rural families because divorces are more in cities.
12. Urban families have very low interest in rituals because they always remain involved in their work.
13. Children in urban family do not want to be under the control of their parents and always act upon their will.

From the above we can say that urban family is a product of mobility and industrial development. Urban family has limited contribution towards an individual. Urban family is child-centered which puts women in stronger position. Urban family is small in size and personal interests are given preference in it. This can be called a Democratic Family which is not under much control. Family members have less nearness among them which leads to disintegration of family.

PROBLEMS OF URBAN FAMILY

Urban families have been facing a lot of problems, as described below:

1. Problem of mutual co-operation between Husband and Wife :- There is a big problem of lack of co-ordination between husband and wife in modern families. An educated and awakened woman of today puts herself equal to her husband in every field. But even today, the men are not in favor of giving her the right to equality. Which inevitably leads to clash. Dis-satisfaction in sexual relations and marital instability also create conflicts in husband-wife relations.

2. Love Marriage :- Another problem that is faced by urban family is Love-Marriage. After such marriages, when thrilled dreams of husband-wife are not fulfilled, they face problems of life, they begin blaming each other. Everyday there is clash which ends on break-up of marriage.

3. Problem of working Women :- These days, women have begun working outside their homes. They don't have time for taking necessary care of the children. Due to tiredness of work, they can't serve their children and husband. This creates hindrance in growth of children on one hand and differences and clash among husband-wife, on the other. Thus, due to their working outside their home, it becomes a problem to maintain domestic peace and harmony at home.

4. Lack of family Discipline :- Lack of control of family over its members, is also a big problem in urban families. Every member in the family wants to act in his own way and doesn't like any type of interference. This has reduced discipline in the family causing disintegration of families.

5. Family conflict and Tribulation :- Lack of control over family and change in values has caused conflict between husband-wife, parents and children in the urban families. Families being nuclear in nature, have no control over an individual which has led to problem of conflict and tribulation in the family. Normally this conflict is indirect but this breaks peace in the family. The feeling of mutual trust and security also ends.

DISORGANIZATION OF URBAN FAMILIES

Urban families are disorganising. This disorganisation is not a result of happenings of one or two years. A number of factors are responsible for it. These reasons are described below:

1. Industrialisation :- Modern society is being called an industrial society these days. Factories have been set up in large number, cottage/domestic production has stopped and has gone to factories. Artisans have started working in factories instead of homes/cottages. Thus they are no more part of families. There is no binding to adopt the father's trade. The children have started new trades in cities. Thus, joint families have transformed into nuclear families after turning towards disorganisation.

2. Importance of Money :- After being educated, man is changing his life-style in modern society, which requires more money. Using his ability, he wants to earn more and more wealth so that he is able to upgrade his life-style. This factor of his nature has forced him to keep separate from family.

3. Impact of Westernisation :- English regime in India has encouraged western culture. Today people have started liking to live separate from their families. Western education created libertarianism in the minds of people and individualistic interest began progressing. Having entered the field of education, women have come out of their homes to enter the field of employment. This has changed the values of joint family. Joint families have disintegrated and converted into nuclear families. Under the effect of western culture now nuclear families have started to disintegrate further.

4. Development of Means of Transportation :- In modern times means of transportation have largely developed. In ancient times the man was not able to travel fast and he had to live at the same place. But the development in means of transportation has solved this problem. Now people remain in touch with despite living far away from one another. Due to this reason also, the situation of disorganisation has started in the families.

5. Problem of Urbanisation and Immigration :- Fast urbanisation is an important reason for dissolution of rural families and hence their settling in urban areas. Whereas cities are much short of houses. In cities houses are small besides being short. Therefore, shortage of living space is also causing dissolution of families.

6. Increase in Population :- Population is fast increasing in India. Shortly, it is found that the family property is not sufficient for use by all the members and they have to leave their families for searching jobs. This is also the reason for dissolution of families.

SLUMS

The population of the country is increasing fast. It is creating many other problems too, which includes a big problem of housing. There are small houses in cities and their rent is very high. But the individual working there can't leave the city and is forced to live in slums. Thus these slums have become a major problem in the cities.

Meaning of Slums :- A group of dirty houses, homes or huts is called a slum. These have no provision of light and fresh air. No arrangement of clean drinking water is there. People live life in lack or absence of facilities. This polluted and dirty environment adversely affects the human health and they fall sick from different diseases.

It is clear from the above that there are many variations in their kinds. Every country may have its different kind of slums but basic atmosphere and living conditions are almost the same. The people living there are poor, unemployed and having low income and they have no house of their own. This is a residential orphanage where all the discomforts of life are available together. The people live here like animals. Slums are result of industrial development in cities.

CAUSES OF SLUMS

Slums have not arisen suddenly. There are many reasons behind it which have caused their rise. The main causes of rise of slums are given below:

1. Economic Causes :- Economic cause is also a reason for rise of slums. People leave their villages due to poverty seeking jobs in cities and settle here for earning money. Their income is less and expenditures are high. In addition to their subsistence, they have to save for their family living in their villages. They can't, therefore, afford living in expensive houses and they have no alternative other than living in slums. In the area of their living, the environment begins fouling due to gradual increase in population. That's why, due to low spending power, they are forced to live in those slums.

2. Administrative Causes :- Local administration is always thought to be corrupt and incapable. Local administration is also responsible for arising of these slums. Local administration is responsible for development of all the cities, as they make plans for the development. For some reasons, either they don't take care of these slums or they intentionally ignore them. Shortage of economic resources is also responsible for non-completion of the plans. If existing limited economic resources are properly utilised, condition of the slums can be improved. But this is not done, so rise in slums continues.

3. Increasing Population :- Increasing population has become a big problem in cities. Due to which poverty, illiteracy and unemployment has posed serious problem. Poverty in this world is like a hell. Poor, unemployed belong to the category which neither can properly feed their families, despite their hard labour nor are they able to build their own houses. The slums are inhabited by such people. These people live there. In cities, population is more whereas the housing space is less. The land-prices are skyrocketing. A common man can't build his own house by purchasing land. Most of the people live in rented houses. It is also not an easy job to rent a house in cities. Millions of labourers, having limited source of income, are forced to live in slums. Resultantly, slums are continuously on the rise. Slums are due to industrial cities. Lacs of people come seeking work and they settle here. Their income is not sufficient for their living in good houses. Shortage of income and resources force them to live in slums.

4. Industrial Revolution :- A number of industries are developed in cities. People come from villages and live in cities. Cities have many types of occupation. Lacs of people come here for earning more but they get frustration only. These people make their livelihood by working in some mill, factory or some other way. This industrial metro civilisation and culture force them to live in slums. They have no other solution. The important part to the production, labourers, live in slums whereas the factory owners, sitting in air-conditioned rooms, keep them reeled in problem of their daily bread. A hungry man prioritises arranging bread for his family and doesn't care for other issues. The master can arrange housing for his labourers, but he is bent upon exploiting them. At last poor and exploited person is forced to take shelter in slums.

5. Over Population :- Today, cities and big industrial cities are over populated manifold. Cities like Mumbai, Kolkata, and Delhi have population in crores. Houses have not been constructed in proportionate with the population. Labour colonies are negligible. Lacs of people, who have come to metros for jobs, are facing problems. Therefore, these slums are on the increase in outskirts of cities.

6. Lack of Town Planning :- The municipalities and the government are more responsible for arise of slums in cities. Had the cities been developed under plan, the humanity would not have been blotted with arise of these slums. The houses in slums are constructed undulated. They don't care for government rule-regulations and construct houses in illegal ways.

7. Cities are the places of Security :- In rural areas people have no social security, hence they come to cities to settle. They are forced to leave rural area fearing theft and robbery. Cities are equipped with administrative arrangement and police to safeguard them. Therefore, population in cities is continuously increasing, thereby giving rise to slums.

8. Illiteracy and lack of Awareness :- In India, illiteracy and lack of awareness have played vital role in rise of slums. Illiterate people live in slums despite the existence of innumerable social evils there, because they have to pay nominal rent there or they are compelled by circumstances, to live in huts there.

9. Ignorance of Slums :- The people living in slums have their personal properties there. Hundreds of people are owners of huts, dumps and compounds. Their concern is only to charge rent. How do the people living in these slums live or die is none of their concern. If the government removes slums by somehow pressurising the slum owners and gets constructed small houses for the labourers, the number of these slums can be lower to a great extent.

10. Natural Calamities :- These slums can come across any type of calamity or problem at any time. For example – drought, floods, excess rain-fall etc. All these damage agriculture. Agriculture is the prime source of income of villagers. On damage of their crops they turn to cities seeking work. All those together set up slums. Wherever they find place they build huts, which with the passage of time take the form of slums.

CONSEQUENCES OF SLUMS

Slums are the places where evils are born, which afterwards engulf the whole society.-This hell on the earth is a blur to the civilised human beings. The bad results due to slums may be described as follows:

1. Personal and Family Disorganisation :- Development of personality and family is not possible at these places. Most of the families adopt appropriate or inappropriate means to fulfil their requirements. Whereas alcoholism, gambling, immoral sexual relations, theft etc. destroy man, there they disorganise families too.

2. Centres of Crime :- Children are born midst many social evils here. They are surrounded by social evils. They easily and naturally adopt these evils and start committing crimes from their

childhood. They are used as medium for supplying hashish, hemp and country liquor. They also work as touts in setting up immoral sexual relations. They take care of the gambling dens. They are trained in this way. In future, they become big criminals.

3. Social Disorganisation :- Social ideals, values, ethics, tolerance etc. are not found in these slums. These people are always ready to do anything for fulfilling their needs. They can be hired to do anything. They can be bought to create disturbance in society. Such type of acts disorganises the society.

4. Centres of Serious Diseases :- These slums are centres for serious diseases. From health point of view, these are hell for human society. Everything is polluted here. Here, neither water and air, and nor environment is pure. Here, Tuberculosis is a common disease. Dysentery, Cholera and other many such diseases start to spread from here.

5. Lack of Isolation :- At such places, single room is shared by many people. These people are starved of isolation. The parents don't find isolation for fulfilling their family needs and the children too don't find favourable environment for their development.

Conclusion :- Thus, we conclude that thousands of slums situated in cities have turned human-beings into animals. Rural social concentration discourages workers, keeping their wives with them at industrial centres. In a country where children are married in their low age and have just started their married life, also gets attracted towards city and comes to settle here.

INDUSTRIAL SOCIETY

Industrial and post-industrial societies were born after the gradual development of tribal and village societies. Industrial society is in fact a product of industrial revolution which developed in the second half of 18th century. It is called an industrial revolution because it brought total transformation in craft system of England and small handicrafts factories were replaced by big factories run with machines. Industrial revolution out of this comprehensive economy was not an unrealised/subliminal incident. Its gradual development is still continuing. It was during this development that the birth of industrial and post-industrial societies was possible. In short, we can say that the industrial society is recognised by its industrial activities. Whereas the post-industrial society is an ultra-modern form of the latter condition of industrial society.

CHARACTERISTICS OF INDUSTRIAL SOCIETY

In cities, mills and factories run round-the-clock, which boosts their production rate. These are the characteristics of Industrial Society:

1. Greed of Earning Money :- These days every businessman wants to earn maximum because the investing person wants to earn profit too. In industrial society it is a game of capital and every industrialist has his main objective to earn maximum. Wealth is also a source to gain political power in such a society. The rich rules, whereas the poor is confident only over God. In Industrial societies, respect is determined on the basis of funds.

2. Industrial Profit :- In industrial society everything, particularly that related with industry, is done on large scale. Therefore, work division is very necessary. The operation of large scale works related to work division, require only the specialists. Therefore, in industrial society, Judges, Engineers, Doctors, Teachers etc. all are specialists in their fields.

3. Variety in Industrial Society :- In India, people do business in various trades. Due to availability of many facilities in industrial trade, business and commerce, the people belonging to various religions, castes, sections, states etc. come to settle in industrial society. Due to this diversity, people's living style, language, dressing-sense etc. is not similar and this creates social variety in such societies.

4. Competition in Industrial Life :- Due to close relation between education and science in industrial society, the religion and family have got much less importance. In industrial society, a particular type of mental turbulence goes on in every person. Because if on one side he has got many facilities like food to eat, earning of wealth and to live life, on the other side he has routine incidents like - accident, unemployment, loss in business etc. which result into mental disturbance and mental illness thereby.

5. More Production :- An important characteristic of industrial society is that handicrafts and cottage industry have been replaced by big industrial units and factories. These industrial factories may be private or run by government because economic production is done by big factories with ultra-modern machinery.

6. Mutual Relations of People :- Industrial societies have an important characteristic that here the human relations are neither close nor personal. Its main reason is that the field of social relations in such societies is very large and it is not possible for any person to have personal relations with all those humans in the society.

7. Artificiality in Society :- An individual depends more upon the outer show off in the industrial societies. More the person has glittering artificiality in the living place, dress, behaviour, way of talking, the higher will be his social status. There is much extravagance to maintain this artificial social status. In Indian cities people pay much attention towards the show-off.

DYNAMICS OF INDUSTRIAL SOCIETIES

Dynamism of different types is observed in industrial society which is described as the following:

1. Dynamics in Social Life :- Industrialisation has very much weakened the caste system. Industrialisation created many types of jobs. Many mills and factories were set up. Wherein people from all castes get opportunity to work together. With this, sense of untouchability on one side and profession related restrictions on the other side, are getting away. Marriage related caste taboos are also weakening. The construction of houses for the residents is not proportionate with the increasing population of the cities due to industrialisation. This has created shortage of residential places. Industrialisation has encouraged the importance of wealth and the private groups. This has made

the man self-centred. Industrialisation has created many such situations that have led to crimes and child-crimes. This has grown competition in industrial business and commerce. Industrialisation is also a cause of mental tensions and diseases. Industrialisation is responsible for many new types of diseases, spread in the society these days.

2. Dynamics in Home Life :- Industrialisation has also significantly affected the home life. It has caused dissolution in joint families and has raised small families. Industrialisation has, on one side ruined the cottage industry in villages and boosted opportunities for jobs and professions in cities on the other. People began settling in cities leaving their villages and thus joint families were disorganised.

3. Dynamics in Economic Life :- Economic life has also not been left untouched by the effects of industrialisation. Due to industrialisation, big mills and factories have started running with machines. In fact, a big capital is required for large-scale production. Those having more wealth or big capital, have right over such means of production. Thus, industrialisation has divided the existing society into two classes. One is class of capitalists and the other is labour class.

Thus, it is clear that industrialisation has made possible the expansion of the state's field of operation. Industrial society is the society, wherein the economic production work is done by the factories and other industrial units run with modern machines and it is a huge community full of diversities, where group and control, industry and commerce, thick population, non-personal relations play their vital roles. Thus industrialisation has brought many changes in society, economic and domestic life in India. The standard of living of people has gone high.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. Define Urban Community. Discuss the features of Urban Communities.
2. What was the impact of urban social relation on Personality?
3. Discuss the features of Urban Communities in India.
4. Examine the relation of History with Sociology.
5. Describe the characteristics of urban economy system.
6. Define Industrial Society. Describe its characteristics.
7. Define Post-Industrial Society. Describe its characteristics and Dynamics.
8. Define Urban Family. Describe its main features.
9. Distinguish between Rural and Urban Family.
10. Describe the changing patterns of Marriage and Family.
11. What is the meaning of Slums? Write in detail.
12. Describe the causes and consequences of Slums.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 6
MARRIAGE AND FAMILY

Marriage ceremony had a great importance in ancient India. After this ceremony only, a men entered family life and increased his pedigree by procreating children and fulfilled his duties towards his society. In this ritual husband and wife swore for a harmonious mentality and prayed that no discrimination arise between them. Their family life may be happy, prosperous and peaceful. An off spring of healthy conduct may take birth to them. A literal meaning of marraige is taking the bride by the bridegram to his own home from the home of her father. But we imply all those rituals and ceremonies which are observed at the time of matrimony between a bride and a bridegroom.

In Ashwalian Gritk-sutra (family-clue) in most of the religious scriptures, eight types of matrimonies are described whose brief details are as under :-

1. Brahma Marriage :- In this type of marriage, a father gave the hand of his daughter well adored with ornaments and clothes to some such man who was knower of Vedas and full of character. The father of a daughter invited this man to his home and married his daughter with him in prescribed vedic procedures. We come to know about this type of marriage that father of a girl gave her husband dowry as per his capacity. This type of marriage was not done for only wordly pleasures, but also the relation of the couple lasted till the after-life, because the target of both of them was to achieve Brahma or liberation.

2. Deva Marriage :- In this type of Deva or Divine marraige, the father gave his decorated daughter to the priest, who himself looked after the rituals of the marraige. In this type of marraige too, by bestowal of same ornaments, we conclude that in this marriage also some dowry was given by the father of the girl. Such marraige is called Deva Marriage (Deivine marriage), because after this marraige bridegroom could do Yagya ceremony for pleasing his god which was done for the birth of a son and for rainfull.

3. Arsha Marraige :- In this type of marraige, father of bride took a cow or an ox or both from the bridegroom and gave his daughter to him. This is the view of Kullab that the father did not sell his daughter by receiving cow and ox, but in fact fullfilled his dharma (duty). He gave this cow and ox to the father of girl as his obligation, as the bridgroom had entered the married life by marriage with that girl only. Another purpose of this was also that in those days cow and ox were the main sources of livelihood. With their help the newly wed could start their family life.

4. Prajapat Marriage :- In this marraige, a father willingly married his daugher with a charaterful person, so that both of them could look to thier family life. Before the marraige, the father respected the bridegroom in a particular way. The main purpose of this marriage was that the couple could spend their life happily by begetting children,

5. Asura Marriage :- In this type of marriage, the bridegroom gave a large amount of money to the girl and his relatives. This implied that the bridegroom purchased the girl with money and then married her. Some scholars have the view that since this type of marraige was in vogue in Asyria in ancient times. so this is called Asura Marriage.

6. Gandharva Marraige :- This was a sort of love marraige. In this marriage, the parents of the boy and girl had no role. This marriage could be cermonised afterwords. The marraige of Dushyant and Shakuntla is a major example of this marriage.

7. Rakshas Marriage (Demonical Marriage) :- In this type of marraige, persons of bridegroom side killed and maimed the relatives and parents of the bride and forcibly carried away the girl. It is possible that this marraige may be prevalent in those days in some barbarous unciviliged tribe. Just to give place to children of this marraige probably, it might have been accepted as a type of marraige at that time. The marraige of Krishna and Subhadra is an example of this marriage.

8. Pishacha Marriage (Phantom Marriage) :- In this marriage the bride raped the girl in sleep, or in intoxicant condition or sleathily raped a mad girl. It is possible that there might have been a non-Arya race in whom this marriage could he prevelent. The scriptures might have accepted this also as a type of marriage.

In the Griha-Sutra (family-clue) a detailed description of various phases of marraige, pertinent time and abilities of the bride and bridegroom has here made. As per it, the girl should be a virgin and should not be of the Gotra of the bridegroom and also should not be from the consecutive six generatons of the bridegroom mother. The main purpose of these bars was that there might not be inbreeding in close relatives. As per Manu the daughters of those families should not he taken in marriage, who do not obseve their dharma or who do not study the Vedas or birth of a son does not happen in these families, and which families suffer from some chronic diseases, as an increase in the family-tree was not possible in the absence of a son, whereas the effect of inherited diseases could fall on the off-spring also. Vatswayan too has stated these qualities in the girl. Though Manu has not given some special description of the qualities of the bridegroom, yet Narad and Yagya-Valkya have given their detailed description. As per them, the bridegroom should be conversant with the Vedas, characterful, healthy, intelligent and elite.

In the Griha-sutras (family clues) the following phases have been described :

1. First the relatives of the girl went to the home of the parent.
2. When father of the girl gave his acceptance, then the bridegroom family made a Yagya.
3. On the Marriage day, the girl was given a bath in the morning.
4. The priest of the bridegroom side made a Yogya and four or eight married women danced.
5. Clothes, mirror and bath-paste (Shampoo) were sent by the boy for the girl.
6. The girl was formally carried to the boy. This ritual was observed by the father or brother of the girl and it was called Kanya-dan (Donation of girl.)
7. The boy caught the right hand of the girl with his right hand. The was called Pani-grahan (Acceptance of hand).

8. Bride and bridegroom put their feet on a slab of stone.
9. Bride and bridegroom were made to have a circumference of the fire. This ritual was called Agni parinayan.
10. Then the custom of Laja-hom was observed.
11. The couple walked together seven steps which means that they will go together for whole of their life.

In the end, the bridegroom brought the bride to his home. In this way the ceremony of marraige was completed.

After completion of every matrimonial religous rite, a morsel was ofered to the fire and brahmins were given a feast. Among the above religious rites, Kanyadan, maraige Havan, Pani-Agni-parinayan, Ashmarohan, Laja-hom, graha and sapta-Sodi were highly important. A brief description of these ritules is given as under :-

The meaning of Kanya-dan is that the father of girl or her guardian hands her over to his bridegroom and the bridegroom accepts the girl. As this event the father says to the bridegroom that you should take the cooperation of your wife in fulfilling all the three enterprizes related to Dharma (duty), Artha (Economic affairs) and Moksha (liberation). The bridegroom then replies that he will do the same.

Afterwords, the ritual of Panigrahan takes place in which the bridegroom takes the oath that I have caught your hand in the shape of our husband. You should understand this fully that the gods have given your body to me, so that by cohabiting with you, I may meet the duties of my family life.

In the Laja-hom rite, the girl gives an offering to the gods i.e. Yryama. Varuna, Pusha and fire and seeks the blessing from these gods that her married life may he full of happiness and properity.

At the time of Agni-Parinayan, the husband made three circumferences of the fire as well as Jal-Kalsh (waterful earthen) and the wife fallowed him. At this time, he-uttered I am the sky, you are earth, I am the music and you are my poetry. We are marrying which means no discrimnation is between us. We may spend a life of 100 years in this way. This is my desire that whole the life, we shall live loveingly and beget children and spend a flawless life. Afterwards the ritual of Ashmarohan takes place in which wife puts her foot on the stoneslab with the help of her husband. At that time, the husband says to his wife that your love for me should be strong like this stone slap. Afterwords, Saptasadi happenes as per which the husband and wife walk together for seven steps. This was also considered a highly important ritual of the family. At the time of this ritual, the husband exclaims that we are making these seven steps for energy of life, strength, money, progeny and long prosperous life. You have become my life partner and we both will spend our family life within the limits of Dharma (duty) and increase our family tree by begetting the off-spring and shall try to repay the favour of the society, which is due on us towards the society.

After the marriage ceremony the huband brings the wife to his home. At the time of departure of girl, the father says to his daughter that from today I free you from my home. I make you the prisoner at your husband home. May the God Indra render you prosperous and son-bearing.

In the ancient times, bride and bridegroom cohabited after 4th day of the marraige. It is clear from this that in those days, both the boy and girl were adults. But afterwards, the marriage of the girls was done in their childhood also.

From the above description, it is known that the religious rites which were done at the time of marraige ceremony were not only a show or formality, but were observed to render the marraige as a pious band. At the time of marraige the main purpose of the couple was to enable themselves for all the three enterprizes of dharma (duty) economics and cohabitation, so that they might ulimately attain liberation from this world, a the main target of their life. Vatsyayan explains the importance of oaths taken before the fire that after this matrimony, it was not posible for the couple to separate.

In the Ashwalyan Grih-sutra (family clues) Brahma, Dev, Aush and Prajapat categories of marraige have been declared as religious and blissful for the ancesttors, whereas the other four types of marriages have been stated to be anti-religious and unblissful to the ancesstores. In the first four types of marraige, the father of the girl himself performed the Kanyadan, due to which they have been described to be in conformity with the religous law, whereas the last four types of marraige have been considered against the provisions. As per Aapstamb and Bodhayan, the marriage in which the relatives of the girl or her father were given money was the most anti law marriage, becasue in such a marriage the girl was cansidered to be sold in return for money. Manu has accepted the marriages of Brahma, Deva, Arsha, Gandharva and Rakshasa type as per law, whereas described the Asura (demon) marriage and Pishacha (Phantam) marraige against the law. As per him, the persons of superior families should never conduct these marraiges. This means that upto the time of Manu, Gandharva and Rakshas marriages were usual in the Kshatriyas in the society, due to which he had to give his recognition to these marriages. In the Mahabharat epic too, it is stated that Rakshas and Ghandarva marriages are suitable to the Kshatriyas.

In the ancient India, the follwing main purposes of the marriage have been given :

1. To beget the stong progeny of good quality
2. To maintain order in the social life.
3. To make the family life happy.

FAMILY-THE INSTITUTION OF KINSHIP

1. Definition and Origin :- Every body is born in a family, but what is the family is difficult to define. Burges and lochts have defined the family by stating that the family is a group of such persons, who are connected with each other due to matrimonial alliances or blood relations or due to the custom of adoption. All the members of this group, husband wife, mother-father, father-son or daughter or brother sister reciprocate with each other. All these memebrs jointly create a culture of particular type and develop it. This definiton of family can be right as per western world view, where the base of family is defined by merely material elements. But in the Hindu families, members of the current generation and their elders are not bound together by merely there physical requirements. Some spiritual, religious and psychological factors too contribute, which are their main quality.

f the marraige. It is clear
ards, the marriage of the

were done at the time of
o render the marraige as
to enable themselves for
hat they might ulimately
xplains the importance of
the couple to separate.
d Prajapat categories of
ereas the other four types
esstores. In the first four
due to which they have
st four types of marraige
an, the marriage in which
law marriage, becasue in
Manu has accepted the
w, whereas described the
. As per him, the persons
at upto the time of Manu,
iety, due to which he had
s stated that Rakshas and

e been given :

SHIP

t is the family is difficult
family is a group of such
r blood relations or due to
other-father, father-son or
jointly create a culture of
per western world view,
Hindu families, members
ere physical requirements.
are their main quality.

Originally the purpose of family must have been procreation of progeny, but afterwards its importance highly increased as a social unit. Macciver Paige and other scholars held that no other contituent of the society can be equally important. Family as a form of social organisation provides for some basic necessities of a person. These scholars have stated three main functions of the family which are as under :

1. The family satisfies the sex-desire of male and female in an authentic way.

2. It gives birth to children and brings them up and enables them to live in the society.

3. Provides an opportunity to receive all those facilities which are essential far a social and civilized person.

These scholars believe that in a successful family, these three works interrelate with each other in such a way that the existence of one cannot be possible without the other meaning they become complements of each other. For example the way satisfaction of sex desire can take place in a family cannot happen in other organisation because society does not approve it. Secondly the upbringing of children can he made properly in the family only and not in government organisation or by some public nursery. The importance of family is too much both for the individual and the society. The society can obtain a good-mannered person from the family only, and an individual will grow the good qualities, only if he will remain in the company of good persons and this company can be available to him only in a family. In fact, the development of initial qualities in a man grows in a family only, and the family plays a great role in his personality development. The psychologists believe that the family leaves such a deep psychological effect on a child that he starts to moulds his personality and character as per his family, before the tender age of just five years. The family leaves the most effect on the qualities like compassion, self-sacrifice, service of humanity, mutual brotherhood, altruism etc. which develop in a man.

The learned experts believe that every child has four primary needs which he can meet by living in a family. These four desires are desire to gain experience, desire of protection, desire for responsibility and desire for getting reaction. The child daily gains same new experience in a family. These experiences are gaind by him through his parents and elder brother and sister. The parents provide him protection by making arrangements for his upbringing. They try to provide for every type of his desires and give him protection. When a child does a good work, then he is praised by all the members of his family, which satisfy his desire for respectability. On the other hand, when some bad work in done by him, then it is criticized, so that he may refrain from doing these works, In this way his desires for reaction, that is, restraint is satisfied. In fact these are the primary desires which help in the shape of a person's personality and due to which the society gets a well-mannered human.

In this way it can be said though in the beginning begetting, the children might have been the purpose of family, but after a passage of time, it become an integral part of the society without which the existence of the society cannot be expected in any way. It is the reason that the Hindu society has always considered the actions like sex and progeny imferior to moral values. The Hindus have always, remembered to improve their after-life, even while spending a family life and they have always made effort to make the family as a sacred institution.

(B) NATURE AND DEVELOPMENT OF FAMILY WITH THE PASSAGE OF TIME

1. Rigvedic Period (About 1500 B.C.) the condition of family – In the Rigved period, the word "Kulp" has been used for the head of a family which means Kula or the protector of the family. In those days in the Aryan families, father was the senior *i.e.* considered the family head. Father alone was the owner of all family property. He had a control over cows, horses, ornaments, gold, silver, weapons and slaves and slave girls. He was the owner of the land too. Then the families were of joint family type in which three or for generations of members resided. Father was an epitome of greatness and kindness. He treated his sons with much kindness and open heart. Sons too also always obeyed the commands of their father. Rigveda has some stories as per whom it is known that the father had a full control over his sons. The story of two brothers namely Rizashav and Bhuju is of such kind. Rizashav was blinded by his father, becasue due to his negligence wolf had eaten one hundred sheep of the family. It comes to he known from the story of Bhuju that in that period the father had the right to banish the sons from his area or to sink them in the water also. The birth of a son in the family was also given more importance, because he helped his father or family in earning money or in fighting the battles for the family. The father had the right to divide his property during his life time. After the death of his father, the elder son was accepted his inheritor.

Through the marriage Sukta of Rigveda, we come to know that the newly wed doughter-in-law was given a warm welcome by the members of the family. She was called Griha Lakshmi (family wealth) and she had a complete right over her in-law brothers and sisters and in-law parents. She too respected the elders of the family and loved its younger members. This is clear from it that in this period the wife had a good status in the family. She participated in all the religious and social rites alongwith her husband. She had the permision to converse with other persons without any taboo and she unhesitantly took part in the parties called Priti Bhojas of the family. All chances of education were given to the girls and she was married at an advanced age. Generally she herself chose her bridegroom and her parents helped her in doing so. The marriage was considered a very sacred ritual which had very little possibility of divorce. Commonly the man married only a single woman, but second marriage too could he done, in case no child was born to the first wife or if she died an untimely death. Then a custom of widow-marriage was also prevalent and a widow-woman could marry her elder or younger in-law brother. After the death of a father, the brothers looked after their sisters properly.

In the Rigveda period, hospitability was given a high importance. This fact is clear from it that in that period Agni meaning fire was given the name of guest and during the Rigvedic period, Agni was a leading god of the Aryans.

2. Post Vedic Peirod i.e., 1000 B.C. to 600 B.C. and condition of family– In the Rigveda, where Kulp word has been used for the head of a family, in the Brahmin scriptures, Kulp meaning clan word has been used at some places. From this historical evidence, we come to know the head of the clan was either a father or the eldest brother, and all the memebrs of a family lived in a clan.

Y WITH THE

n the Rigved period, the
e protector of the family.
the family head. Father
horses, ornaments, gold,
. Then the families were
Father was an epitome of
pen heart. Sons too also
er whom it is known that
Rizashav and Bhuju is of
ence wolf had eaten one
ju that in that period the
water also. The birth of a
ther or family in earning
de his property during his
ritor.

wly wed doughter-in-law
d Griha Lakshmi (family
d in-law parents. She too
clear from it that in this
religious and social rites
ns without any taboo and
All chances of education
lly she herself chose her
considered a very sacred
ied only a single woman,
irst wife or if she died an
d a widow-woman could
rothers looked after their

is fact is clear from it that
he Rigvedic period, Agni

family– In the Rigveda,
scriptures, Kulp meaning
come to know the head of
family lived in a clan.

We know from Aitrey Brahmin that in this period too, the father had a full control over his sons. His description is made in the story of Shanshep. In this period head of the clan was also called 'Kulpati'. If a son was not born, the father could adopt some other boy. If the sons were not capable, then also the clan-head could do so. It should not he inferred from this that there was some breakage in the relations of father and his sons. This was done only to increase the clan.

In the absence of the father, the eldest son looked after and protected the family. In that period too, members of three generatios lived together under a roof. There is a mention of maternal uncle, nephew, brother-in-law, cousin etc. during that time.

Hospitality was then too considered a pious work. A full sukta of Arthvaved is full of praise for playing host to a gust. In the Airtrey Arnayat too, a great stress has been made on hospitality. Allocation of food for the vistors was considered an integal part of daily religious activities.

In that period, wife had a gret importance in the family. In the Shatpath Brahmina, it is said that a man does not becme a complete person, unless and untill he marries and procreactes. Only after the birth of progeny, he becomes a complete person. In his works Vrihad-Aryanaya Upnishad, Yaga-Valikya has made a beautiful description of unity between the husband and wife. He has written that originally the man was a single entity and he found no joy in the would living alone. So he divided him-self in two parts. These very two parts got a fame in the world as husband and wife. Both are two halves of a same circle. When these two halves unite, then a full circle comes into existence. It is therefore clear that for the property of a clean, both the husband and wife had equal importance and one was considered without the other as incomplete.

In the family of Vedic Aryan clan-head and dependent memebrs, mutual relations depended upon their mutual cooperation and there was no element of fear or terror in it. It is implied that their inter-relations depended upon fine emotions and not on fear or terror. In the Vedic period, the father did give same preference to the eldest son as he alone had given more support to him in the expansion of the clan and its up-brigning. We get indication of this fact in the Brahmin scriptures at the time of study about the division of property among the sons of Prajapati, Gods and Asura (demons).

3. Family in the Sutra-period i.e. 600 B.C. to 300 B.C. – On the study of Griha-sutras, we find a knowledge of family life from which we gain that the joint families existed in this period too, but sometime too large families broke after the death of Kulpati, meaning the sons separated after the death of their father. We know from these clues that in the Bali ; Veshavdev Yagya (Sacrifice Yagya); sacrifice was made by the elder son, which gives the infarence that in some large families, the food was cooked on more than one oven. But usually joint families existed in which three generations resided together. In this period, the birth of a son was preferred to daughter. When the father returned home from outside or from abroad, then he addressed the sons and doughters in different ways, which shows that he preferred sons to doughters.

It was an obligation on the head to take care of the clan or family. He first fed his dependents and then himself ate food. But we come to know from the Parashar Griha-Sutra that the members of a family considered their duty to first serve the food to the clan head and only then they themselves took food.

In this period too, the sons were under the control of their father. We find that in this period the son ate the refuse of his father. But the father treated his sons with kindness. Sankyan Sutra has condemned the treatment given by father to Shun-Shep. In the Upnishads, it is said that the son is the inheritor of father's spiritual activities. In the Chhandogya Upnishada, the seriatum of the family relatives is given as father, son, daughter, brother and sister. It is also indicated in the Sutra literature that the father could even sell his son or could pledge him. But we also get such indication also, in which such actions were considered a sin. Excesses by parents on their off-spring are also condemned.

As per the Griha-sutra, family life starts after the marriage when the bride of a son enters the home, then his responsibilities start. There is provision of five Mahayagyas (Five targets) in his family life. The provision of five Mahayagyas highlighted a bright aspect of the Yagyas. In these Yagyas, it has been shown that the main duty of a family man is to do altruism and not keep a sense of selfishness. These Sutra-kars (law-givers) hold the view that a family person daily commits five murders, for whose disposal, he should do five Mahayagyas daily. These five murders are done by him while he uses the oven, flour grinder, broom and a pounder. When these articles are used, then unintentionally, some tiny creatures are killed by his hands. This pity towards the tiny creatures indidcates torwards the higher ideals of the humanity. It can be implied from this that even before the non-violence propagated by Jainism and Buddhism, it was present in Hinduism. Through the five Mahayagyas, killings can he attoed for are – Brahma Yagya, Pitra Yagya, Dev-Yagya, Bharat Yagya and Nirya Yagya.

Every family man studies and teaches in order to pay off the debt of learned Rishis which is called Brahma Yagya. He observes the rites of Tarpan and Shrada so as to show homage to his ancesstors, which is called Pitra Yagya (Ancesstors' Yagya) He gives offerings to the fire, so as to complete his duty towards the gods which is called Dev Yaga. For pleasing the life-forms, he spares some of his food, which is called Bhut Yaga. He observes the Nirya Yogya by serving the guests. In fact these five Major Yagas are considered the symbols of doing betterness of others. The ancient Hindus had the belief that which family person does not observe these five Maha-Yagas, he is dead impite of being alive. Any family person who desires for the happiness of his family, these five Maha Yagas were compulsory for him. Besides these Yagas, three more Yagas were there which were observed by him on special occassions. In the yagas in which he offered food to his ancesstors were called Pak Yagas (cooking yagas). Another yaga was called 'Hariv Yagas' in which ghee was offered to the fire. On special occassions, Soma Yagas were perfomed in which participating members had to consume Somrasa which was a sort of intoxicant liquid. Here it is pertinet to note that only that person was competent to perform this Yaga, who had fed his dependents for a minimum period of three years. All these yagas had a common thing in that the family head and his spouse themselves ate the food, only after serving it to Rishis, Gods, ancesstors, guests and servants. Aap-stambh has the view that in a family, the husband should always live with his wife & children cooperatively. If he does not do so, then he does not observe the duties of his family life. He has mentioned the main purpose of marriage as continuation of family tree or clan.

Which sacred fire was burnt at the time of marriage the same was kept burning by the husband with a great effort. In his absence, his son, daughter or his disciple looked after it and worshipted it. The commentators (Sutrakars) view is that if the fire gets put out, then the wife should fast.

When a house was built by some family person for his residence, then too he had to fulfil same religions rites. Here he gave sacrifice for the Vastoshpati, so that humans and animals living in the house may be protected.

In these Sutra-Scriptures, it is stated that for a Hindu family man, his stay in this world is just a sojourn or a temporary stay. His real residence is some-where else. He comes to perform his religion and then goes away. From this angle, this home belongs to the fire-god. The fore-fathers of the present family man and his off-springs lived in the same and went or will go away. The fire-god is a witness to this fact. So it is expected from every family person to complete his all the duties in this world without any attachment to this world. If he fulfils all his religious duties properly, then he attains his final goal i.e. Moksha or liberation from this chain of life and death.

In the Brith-Sutras, forty types of rites have been mentioned from a person's conception in his mother's wamb to his journey from his birth to his death. The main purpose of this is to purify the body by absolving it from the faults of the previous life & to fully develop the god-given powers. A mention has been made for the rites of the women too, but no use of Vedic hymns was made in them. In fact by these rites and rituabs, man was made organised and disiplined and useful for the society. One purpose of these religious activities was to prepare a person to enter the next stage of life by completing the previous stage and to understand his liabilities in every stage of his life.

As per these Sutrakars and commentators, after the death of their father, the younger brother should remain under the control of their elder brother and they should show the same amount of respect to him which they showed to their father.

Here it is noteable that the Aapstamb has decried the privilleges to the elder brother. He says that the father should give equal rights to his all righteous and obedient sons Bodhyan too has given his consent to this type of views.

In the Sutrakal period, one things had fully taken root in which the status of daughters had become inferior to that of sons. But they were not given mal-treatment. It is said ther Gautam Budha too gave his consent to entry of the woman into Bodh Sanghas, only after big stress by his disciple Anand, Mahatama Budh intially was not in favour of entry of the women in the Budha Sanghas, because the contemporary society did not have wide outlook towards the women. They we considered a cause of moral fall. So Mahatama Budh too was afraid that by entry of the women, Budha Sanghs could fall prey to moral decay.

4. Condition of the families from 300 B.C. to 300 A.D. – This was the period which had seen the rise and fall of great Maurya empire. In this very period, Shung and Satvahan dynasties and their rulers promoted the Hindu Religion and this very period had seen the rise and fall of great Kushan dynasty. Though in the Ramyana and Mahabharta period, a picture of an ideal wife has been drawn, but it is known through the mention of Magsthnese that all women were not heedful to their husband oriented religion. Many examples are known from the Jatak Gathas, where it is known that

many families in the socicties existed, where there was a lack of husband-fidelity in the married women. Magsthnese has written that the rich people married several woman. They married some women, because they were helpful in their political affairs, they married others for begetting the children and they married still others for satisfaction of their sexual desires. Those women who had Varna-relation with their husband had some privilleges. But due to polygamous marriages, many women had to face humiliation also, which often disturbed the peace of the family. In the Mahabharta period a mention is made that Draupti had five husbands which shows that this practice of polyandry also existed in ancient times, but even in that period, this practice was not given ruspect.

Eight types of marriage have been described in the Dhram Sutras. This implies that eight types of marriage happened in this period. Among these, Brahma, Deva, Arsha, and Prajapat marriages were considered as per dharma, whereas Asura, Ghanderva, Rakshasa, and Pishach marriage were considered anti-dharma. This implies that only those marriages were given more importance which were fixed by the parents. In this period girls were married in an age younger than earlier periods, due to which a decline in their level of education and culture came, as a result of which their status in the families decreased.

Manu has wrote on the relation of husband and wife that the gods are pleased on those families more where women are given respect, and the king should punish such a husband who leaves his wife without any reason. Menu has written that if the wife supports the husband in his religious and social works, and she has given birth to a son, then in the lifetime of such a wife, the husband should not marry another woman. Manu further writes that if the wife is of the Varna (colour) of her husband and is obedient of her husband and helps her husband in religious and social works, then the husand should not disrespect her. He should marry some other women only if his previous wife agrces to it. As per Manu, Hindu Marriage is such a ritual where no place of seperation exists. Menu says that if the wife speaks anything disrespectful to the husband, then the husband can leave her. On the contrary he writes in favour of the husband that the wife should serve him as a god, even if he has several bad qualities. Manu's views about women show that in these times, the status of woman had fallen significantly in the family.

But advisor of Chandragupta Maurya who was also the great theorist of his time, Kotilya does not seem to agree with the views of Manu. He has given the same status to both husband and wife in the family. He has written in his book Arthashastra (Economics) that if the husband of a wife is characterless, has gone to a foreign country since long, is an insurgent, if the life of the woman is endangersed by him or if has been excommunicated from his caste, or if he is impotent i.e unable to produce children, then the woman can leave her.

Similar to eartlier periods in which five Mahayagas were compulsory for the family man, in this period also these Yagas were compulsory for the family men. In the Manu-smriti, it has been said that after performance of any yaga, only after serving food to the Rishis, gods, friends, worship of domestic deities and serving food to the guests and servants, a copule should eat food themselves. It is also said in the scriptures that a man should conplete all the religious activitcs as his commitments, because after death no relations or relatives of him will he helpful to him. Only the dharma will accompary him and on the support of dharma alone, he can be through the dark.

fidelity in the married
n. They married some
thers for begetting the
Those women who had
mous marriages, many
mily. In the Mahabharta
is practice of polyandry
given ruspect.
implies that eight types
and Prajapat marriages
Pishach marriage were
more importance which
ger than earlier periods,
ult of which their status

leased on those families
husband who leaves his
band in his religious and
vife, the husband should
e Varna (colour) of her
s and social works, then
only if his previous wife
seperation exists. Menu
e husband can leave her.
rve him as a god, even if
nese times, the status of

of his time, Kotilya does
both husband and wife in
the husband of a wife is
the life of the woman is
e is impotent i.e unable to

ry for the family man, in
Manu-smriti, it has been
is, gods, friends, worship
ould eat food themselves.
ivitcs as his commitments,
m. Only the dharma will
e dark.

Mutual relations of spouses : Manu too has mentained several rites in the human life. He had laid a special stress on this thing that only after the marriage ceremony, real family life starts. Manu has said this too that dedication of the spouses towards each other is the true dhrma of family life. They should always try to keep sweetness in their mutual views. Statement of Manu is that the husband should have love feelngs towards his wife only. Manu further says that a family always prosper where husband and wife are committed to each other and are satisfied with each other.

There are several explanations in Maha-bharta where the status of wife in the family is shown too high. In this scripture, it has been written that the hand of which women has been accepted in marriage, should be given a kind treatment, and the husband should always try to give her anything which she likes. His in-law parents and elder brothers in-law should also treat her kindly, because she begets the progeny and the welfare of the society depends upon her. Wife is the better-half of her husband and his true friend and she is the source of Dharma (duty), Artha (economic) and Kama (sex) and liberation of the husband is possible only through him. No person should say anything against his wife due to his anger, as the happiness of the family, joy and admiration depend upon her. In the Shant Parva of Mahabharta, Bheesham Pitama too expressed similar views. He says that the husband should not quarrel with his wife, brothers, sons, daughters and servants. The importance of wife in the family has been given in a shaloka of Mahabharta, "Without his wife, a home full of sons, grand sons, daughters in law, servants appears to a family man as empty." If Manu expects from a woman to obey the orders of her husband, till he is alive and keep a sense of faith to him, even after his death, Then on the other hand, Manu says so that the welfare of the family is with her presence only. So a husband should never mistreat his wife. The statement of manu is that only that man is complete who has agrceable views with his wife and sons. Manu writes on the liabilities of a wife that the wife should herself look after all the works of the family. She should keep a record of income and expenditure of the family, cook food, should keep everything neat and clean and at proper place and she should participate in all the religious and social activites of her husband. About this mention of husband-wife relations, it appears that the woman had no previous status, still as a wife she still had an important part in a family.

The status of son in a family :- There is one Shloka in Mahabharta which says that a man can conquor whole the world with the birth of his son and birth of son transcends every other happiness to him. As per Manu, if a man is to attain liberation, then he should try for the birth of a son. In the Mahabharta, it is written that son-birth is a very sacred incidence, because this runs his pedigree further.

In this period, the elder son had a position superior to other sons. As per Manu, on the birth of the eldest son the father passes on his ancestoral debt to him and becomes immortal, because that is the dharma-son. Other sons take birth just due to intercourse. After the death of a father, all other brothers remained under his control. The elder brother should treat his younger brothers as if a teacher treats his disciples and younger brothers should trust their elder brother similar to their trust in father. The elder brother forgetting his own facilities gave his full attention to the upbringing and education of his younger brother and sisters. The younger brothers too considered him like their father and obeyed his every cummaned. Manu has written that for the son, father is like his tutor.

The sons gave full respect to the father and accepted his every order with a smile. Some Smritikars (law givers) have given the mother a higher status in the family. But all the Smritikars are agreed that the children should give full respect to their parents, tutors and elder brother. As per Manu, after the death of parents, all the brothers should mutually divide their ancesstal property. In this way Manu has rejected the prerogatives of the oldest son.

Position of the daughters in the family. In the Mahabharta, it has been stated that the wealth of family resides in its daughters. A father should never dispute with his daughters and should always treat them kindly. If no son was born to a man, then he made his grand-son (son of daughter) as his inheritor and gave him the rights to perform his Shradas. It was carridered the utmost duty of a father to marry his daughter at a suitable age. A father always married his dauther with only that boy with which once marriage relations were settled. The father never married his daughter in exchange for money, but there were several tribes in which this practice was prevalent. Therefor though the position of the girls was inferior to the sons in the family, yet the girls were not ignored.

From the above desription, it is clear that in this period, family life had a special importence. One main speciality of the families in this period was that the children were given a training from a young age to respect the elders and love the youngers and thus it was tried to make tham useful members of the society. A family man by fulfilling his duties in the family completed all the three enterprizes of dharma, artha and kama. The use of artha and kama too was limited within the circle of Dharma. A family man considered it his duty to observe all his duties towards his wife, children, and other members of his family and towards his elders or ancesstors. Not only the owner of a house and his wife observed their duties and discharged their liability towards their forefathers and their offspring, but other members of the family too considered their duty to support him in his works. In those days, a great stress was paid on the happy relations of various family members. By understanding the importance of this very principle, Ashoka had stressed on the balanced relations of the family in his inscription No. 9. He has given a command in this archive that everybody should respect the parents, teachers and elders.

5. Gupta Perido i.e., 300 to 600 A.D. :- In this age also, the Hindu community lived in joint families. But power of the father was descreasing. In this period, sons had equal share in the family property, which created a tendency for transition of joint families into personal families. and ancient paternal authority conventions were used for strngthening of the joint family. Manu has written that whatever a man earns through his personal hardwork without the use of his family property, he should have his personal ownership on it, which means that it is upon his own will whether he shares this income with his father, brothers or his sisters or not. Yoga-Valkya too increased the concept of personal property. Narad and Katyayan both provided that any person can retain his art or craft, if he learnt them without the use of his family property. But side by side this, he has made some other provisions also, lest the existence of joint families disappeared altogether.

In this period some Smrities (religious laws) have laid a stress on an-early marriage of the girls, but we know from Kamsutra (sex-book) of Vats-syanan that in that age too, girls were married at the attainment of their adulthood. In this Kamsutra (sex-book), it is written that at the time of marriage, the age of the girls should be 3 years less than the boy. An implication should be drawn

from this that till now the practice of un-harmonious marriages had not started about which we know later in the works of the middle ages. In this period, usually the marriages of the girls were settled by their parents. But in some cases, young, boys and girls chose their life partners themselves, but even in that situation, an approval of parents was essential. In this age too, only marriages of four types— Brahma marriage, Arsha marriage and Deva marriage were given recognition. In the Kamsutra (sex-guide) Gandherava marriage, Rakshas marriage and Pisacha marriage also have been mentianed, which were considered anti-dharma, and did not carry social recognition. Generally, it was considered good to marry the girls in young age. When girls were married in their young age, then its effects on their education were natural. But the girls of upper families were given an education of 64 brnaches of knowledge which included solution of riddles, poetry-lessons, completion of incomple shalokas, knowledge of rhymes and rythms etc. Girls of some higher families were given training in Dance, music and painting and similar fine arts. Yagya-Valkhya has written that everybody should perform his religious rites through his wife only. This verifies the fact that polygamy was fairly widespread in ruling classes and this fact also is confirmed that women had enough importance in religious rites.

Vatsyayan has described the there qualities of an-ideal wife like— service of the family members, self-control and skillful management of all domestic affairs. During this age, other duties of the wife have been given as under :

(*i*) Preperation of food as per taste of her husband.

(*ii*) Fast along with him.

(*iii*) Participation in social events, yogas and religous processions as per order of the husband.

(*iv*) Participation in sports of husband's interest.

(*v*) Refraining in from the company of bad characters.

(*vi*) Concealment of annoyance before her husband.

(*vii*) No excursions without the approval of husband nor standing at the gate of the house.

An ideal wife did not have a pride in her property and no charity made to anybody without knowledge of her husband.

As per orders of her husband, she welcomed the guests to the house and arranged for their food and water. Such a wife served her in-law parents and obeyed their commends. Before them she talked in a low voice and did not laugh in a high tone. She elicited work from the servents in a proper way and gave them incentives on the occassions of festivals. When the husband left for abroad, then she spent a life of recluse and an his return to home immediately saw him in her simple clothes.

It is further stated in description of an ideal wife that she kept her house neat and clean and decorated. She paid heed to the worship of the gods. She grew vegetables, fruits and plants in the family orchard. She stored enough quantities of domestic articles. Sometimes she helped her husband in agriculture and rearing of the cattle too. She was expert in spinning, weaving and other domestic matters. She prepared an estimated budget of annual income and expenditure and ran the household accordingly.

From the above description, we come to know that in the Gupta period, ideal wives had several rights in the family. In the Katyayan Smriti, those duties which have been described for their husband have been confirmed in Kamasutra too. In the work of Kalidasa, 'Abhi-gianum Shakuntelam' drama, Rishi Kanv (Sage Kanv) at the time of her departure had given the similar instuctions to Shakuntla. This means that in the Gupta period, all these things were expected from such an ideal wife.

In the Gupta period, what imporatance wife had for her husband can be inferred from this thing that a husband says about his wife, "she was the owner of my home, my advisor and a friend, she was proficient in fine arts and in a way my disciple."

As per Yaga-valakya, a husband should work according to desires of his wife and should love her. He has further written that if the wife of some husband is of the same Varna and gives birth to a son, then the husband should not even think of marriage with some other soman, because that woman only can fulfil his all the religious and social duties. In respect of marriage with other woman, Katyayan has written that a man can merry another woman only with prior consent of his wife. Yagavalkya was not in favour of leaving the woman except in case of some serious fault. He writes that all women are not impure. They become pure after a temporary impurity in every month. They always remain pure even if they commit any crime. But this does not mean he has encouraged them to become characterless. He further writes that if a husband gets clear proofs that his wife has illicit rebtions with some other male, then he can divorce her. If a wife intercourses with the tutor or disciple of her husband, then such wife should also be divorced. In the Briht-Samhita, it is written that if the husband leaves his faithful wife then the king should give him the same punishment as is awarded to a thief. In the Yagya Valkya smriti (Law-code) it has been told that if a husband deserts his faithful wife, then one third of his property should go to his wife. This sage has clearly written that son, grand son and great grandsons help a men to attain heaven. So everybody should respect the women, should give a suitable treatment to them and protect them.

Yagya valkya has written that a family should rise at dawn and contemplate upon its interests. They should do the works of Dharma, Economics and intercourse at their night time and should not withdraw from them whenever they receive proper chances for them. It can be intersting that money matters and sex too appealed to him similar to dharma. He writes that a family person should in the morning do the fire-worship and study the Vedas and scriptures and in the afternoon should perform Deva-puja (Divine worship), Pitra puja (Ancesstors worship) and guest Yagya. In this way in the Gupta period too, these five Mahayagyas were given enough importance. Yagavalkya has said that Shudras too barring the recitation of Ved Mantras (Vedic hymns) should do these five Mahayagyas.

Yagya valkya has written that the first commitment of a family man is toward his children. The couple should first feed their children, forsaken daughter living with them, old parents, pregnant ladies, ill members of the family and servants, and only after that they should eat their own food. A family person should spend his life as if an individual distributes his earnings among others and himself feeds on its remains. This means that a person should not hoard money.

d, ideal wives had several
escribed for their husband
ıum Shakuntelam' drama,
instuctions to Shakuntla.
such an ideal wife.

ɔe inferred from this thing
advisor and a friend, she

f his wife and should love
e Varna and gives birth to
ther soman, because that
t of marriage with other
with prior consent of his
of some serious fault. He
impurity in every month.
t mean he has encouraged
ar proofs that his wife has
ercourses with the tutor or
riht-Samhita, it is written
the same punishment as is
d that if a husband deserts
is sage has clearly written
everybody should respect

emplate upon its interests.
night time and should not
It can be intersting that
hat a family person should
nd in the afternoon should
d guest Yagya. In this way
tance. Yagavalkya has said
do these five Mahayagyas.
is toward his children. The
em, old parents, pregnant
ould eat their own food. A
arnings among others and
money.

Narad writes that the parents, children, cousin brothers all lived in a same home and used their ancesstral wealth. Brishpati has written that Hindu family is that community whare all the members take food of the some kitchen.

Yogya Valkya has written that a person should do rites for the purity of his body. The purpose of these rites was to make a person to be useful to the society. He has written that marriage of the girls at right age too is a sacred rite for the parents and the daughter.

Yagya Valkya writes that the father is the biggest teacher of a son. Narda writes that the father rules over his family members like a king rules his subjects. Yagya Valkya writes that a father should not disown his son, usless he has committed some serious crime. Vishnu says that father should use every type of strictness in-order to chastise him.

Yagya Valkya has said the division of the property made by a husband is always judicious and right, even if he allots to one of his sons less or more. Narad too has confirmed these views of Yagya Valkya. But Katyanan is not agreed with the above views. He says that during his life-time, the father should never discriminite with any of his sons at the time of division of family property or money. Otherwise in future serious causequences may arise. The father should not unreasonably divest any of his sons from the family wealth.

From the above description, it is known that in this period, joint families were drifting towards personal families, but such families had still not taken root.

In this age, which relations have been described, the importence of mother and her brother (uncle) and her father has been very much stessed in them. Son of the daughter too had gained high importance in this period. He inherited that father who had no son of his own. In Dharm Sutras (Law codes), Manu smriti (The law of manu) and in the epics, it is written that in the Hindu families, no matrimonies were made among the three generations, as the relatives of their parents had very close and emotional relation. In fact in the Gupta period too, the purpose of the joint families was the same as was the case previously. The children learnt the lesson of love and respect in their very families. They considerd it their religious and social obligation to fulfil their duties towards the family person and other members of the family. In this way, every family person prepared himself for Vanprastha (Retirement) and for Sanyas Ashram (reclusion), after the completion of all the three obligations namely Dharma, Economics and Sex. Their fnal target after Vanprastha and Sanyas was to attain liberation from the cycle of life and death.

6. Parition of the family after Gupta period i.e. from 600 A.D. to 1200 A.D.— From a study of literature of this period, it is known that the husband had a high position in a family. In the Matsya Puran, it is said that the wife should worship her husband as a god. Vedvyasa has written that if the husband has gone on a foreign travel, then the wife should starve herself into a skelton and should use no cosmetics. In Das Kumar Chrita, it is written that if a woman is a very good wife, and if the husband forshakes her, then her life becomes full of misery. Generally the wives kept a complete faith in their husband and arranged their homes with great efficiency. From the examples of Raj-

shree, Kadambery and Maha-sheweta, we know that in the ruling classes in those days, the girls were given an education in dance & music. In that period Ghandrva Mariage (love marriage) was considered bad. As per Medha-tithi, the parents themselves should arrange for the marriage of their dauthter. He was in favour of marriage of the girls in their early youth. He says that if a father fails to find a suitable match for his daughter within 3 years of her early youth, then the daughter has a right to herself find a match. In this situation too, marriages were done under the supervision of the parents. In the Katha-sarit Sagar, it is said that the marriage of their daughter in a suitable age is the utmost responsibility of the perents.

From the records of this period, we find that the kings in this age had several wives. Some marriages in this age were done in a method of Swambar. But this practice was confined to Rajas and Maha-rajas only. Normally father himself searched for the bridegroom of his daughter.

Mutual relations of the spouses :- As it is already told that in this period the position of the husbands was considenred for more superior to their wives. The law-givers (Smritikars) of this age say that the wife should have a complete allegiance to her husband and should obey his orders. Medhatithi has written that the wife should press the feet of her husband and serve him like a maid. But besides this, he says this too that the husband should too go on the way to dharma and honour his wive's emotions and feelings. He should have no hate or jealousy with his wife. As per Medha-tithi, husband and wife have only two different bodies, but both of them have equal rights. Both have equal works in the society. Both can defend their rights through law. If the husband hurts his wife or causes privation to her, then the wife can complain against him to the king. the king can enable her to get rid of him. Contrary to this, if the wife perturbs the husband, then the husband after giving an application to the king, can leave her. As per Medha-tithi and Gianeshwer, even if the husband hates the wife, still to feed her is his duty. If the husband has to go abroad, then it is his duty to depart only after making necessery arrangements for his wife. If the wife has been excommunicated from her caste community, then the husband can leave her, but under this situation, he should keep his wife in a different home and arrange for his life. Medha-tithi has given this right also to the husband that he can punish her financially, and physically, so as to mend her ways. But often he has recommended for canvassing to mend her.

Medha-tithi has the view that the women are not independent in respect of dharma, economics and sex. They can spend money on these only through the approval their husband.

Shukara-Niti (The policy of Shukra) which was created in 13th century, it has been written in it that the wife should rise before her husband in the morning and she should clean all the utensils, and her home and take the blessings of the elders of the home. The women have no right to spend money an dharma, economics and sex in an independent way. The wife should be pure in her heart, untterance and actions. She should obey the orders of her husband and should follow here like a shadow and should support him like good friends in his good deeds. She should carry out his commands like maids. She should have a sweet speech and soft attitude in the home. As the husband

gives her everything, so she should worship him like a good. The wife has a duty to make every effort to attract him towards her. It is clear from this description that in that period, husband had a complete right over his wife. As per Shukra-Niti, the order of father has more importance them that of a mother in the family.

The views of eleventh and twelveth century commentators is that the husband should keep his wife in the domestic works so busy that she may find no time to think of other men. On the other hand, some commentators hold the view that the husband should keep his wife happy by presenting her good food, clothes and beautiful ornaments. The husband should in every way respect his wife. If the husband goes out from his home for a longtime, then he should depart, only after making necessary arrangementes for his wife. Which wife has been farsaken by the husband, even then arrangements for her residence and food and drink should be made by the husband himself. If the husband deserts his wife without any reason, then he should he given the same punishment by the king, which is meted out to a thief. In this period, the commentators have expressed this view also that if the husband dies without a son, then all his property will be inherited by his wife.

In this period though same improvements were made in respect of property matters of a wife, but her status in the family had lowered to a large extent. Her position had become like an obedient maid. For children also, father's command carried more importance. In spite of all this, parents of the educated families observed their duties towards their children in society. The children had a training of love, respect and goodwill in the suitable atmosphere of a clan. They became useful members of the society. Such parents did not care for their own rights. They started to think about the improvement of their after-life after fulfilling their temporal responsibilities. Besides this, they tried to carry the society too on the part of progress. The base of success of joint family was a sense of sacrifice for the others. In those days, these was no place for selfishness of a family. A family man was always ready to bear several pains for the happiness of his children, servants etc. In this period also, a family man considered his utmost duty to perform five Mahayagas. In fact in this period, whole the life was a Yagya for ideal family-persons. Attainment of liberation (Moksha) was their real aim of life. When the sense of altruism disappeared in the persons, then the utility of joint family too ended.

After the ninth century, the commentators too started to recognise the tendencies of individualism, and so caused amendments in the laws on the basis of materialistic principles, but they too stressed on joint family and family organisation of paternal relations.

7. Advantages and disadvantages of joint family :- Joint family had same merits too. Like, every member worked as per his capacity and everybody got according to his needs. Secondly, the children acquired skill in their paternal prefession. Thirdly a child received the convents of Indian culture through his parents and passed themon to his next generation. Thirdly, love, sense of service, altruism etc. were those qualities, which the children acquired them from their families and spread them further in the society.

Joint family was not altogether flawless. First defect of this system was that some persons knowing that whether they worked or not had an assurance of basic necessities, due to which they became lazy. Secondly, in this system same persons did not find any reward even after putting in a lot of hard work, because the family head was. responsible for whatever good or bad happened in the family. Third defect in this system was that the women received little chances to develop themselves fully.

From the above description, we reach to the conclusion that in the ancient India, mostly the system of joint family was prevalent, which had some merits and demerits. But in the modern age, no original shape to the joint family can be given. The main reason of this is that in the current economic system, passage of time is very difficult, unless every member of a family utilizes his full energy for income. In the present time, everybody is busy in staisfying his own interests and nobody cares for the facilities of the others. So in this vicious atmosphere, induct of joint families and their success cannot be even dreamt of.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. Give a detailed account of the importance of wedding rituals in ancient India.
2. Express your views on the origin of family, while giving its definitions.
3. What was the condition of family in the Rig Vedic age and the Post-Vedic age ?
4. Throw light an the structure and position of families in the Sutra Age.
5. Throw light on the structure and position of the Indian families from 300 A.D. to 600 A.D.
6. Give a brief account of the merits and demerits of joint families.
7. Analyze different forms of Marriage in Ancient India.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 7
ORIGIN OF UNTOUCHABILITY

Untouchability which was present in every corner of India, sometime before, now has stopped. In our constitution to use untouchability in any form has declared illegal. Some sociologists believe that Brahmins started the concept of untouchability in our country. From ancient literature, it is known that it was prevalent in India before the establishment of caste-system. From 2000 B.C. to 1200 B.C., history of untouchability is described as under. In other words, we meant by untouchability, is not to touch any person.

UNTOUCHABILITY IN PRE-HISTORICAL PERIOD

1. Vedic age (almost from 2000 B.C. to 600 B.C.) :- In Rigveda, Aryans have used many insulting words for their opponents non-aryans that showed physical and cultural dissimilarities of both these castes.

From these words it has cleared that Aryans thought Non-Aryans inferior from them but in Rigveda no evidences are found regarding this saying that Aryans considered their opponents or Non-Aryans as untouchables.

Even today some aboriginals consider the people working at cremation ground and who carry dead-bodies as untouchables. On this basis, some scholars think that untouchability was present in India even before Aryans. When Aryans and Non-Aryans started living together then Aryans too accepted this practice. Later on, the person who did some work of low dignity, considered as untouchable. So, in this way, the practice of untouchability can't be said the invention of Brahmins. This practice was received by Aryans from aborigines as heritage. It is a historical truth that when two cultures or civilizations start living together then they receive some qualities of each other. It is the rule of nature. From the meeting of these two cultures, that culture is borne to which we call today Hindu culture and to which untouchability is like curse.

Many other factors contributed for the progress of untouchability. As we know that every culture thinks itself superior to other cultures. The persons of one culture make some rules to distinguish their culture from other cultures. These rules forbid to sit, to talk, to eat with people of other cultures and many other social actions are forbidden which give birth to untouchability and feeling of superior and inferior.

From the literature of North-Vedic period, we come to know that at that time many Non-Aryans became the part of Aryan group but they were counted in the fourth section i.e. in Shudras. In the Brahmin scriptures, the rules which were made to stay away from their touch, from them untouchability was taken birth in the Indian society. In 'Kathaka Samhita', it has

written that the milk that was used in the fire worship (Yajna) that was not milked by the Shudra. In 'Shatapatha Brahmana' it is said that the people participating in fire-worship should not talk to Shudras. In the same scripture it has said ahead that any person who performs some religious action should escape from the touch of Shudras. According to Shatapatha and Taittiriya Brahamana, in Rajsurya yagaya, Shudras have no right to take part in it. But it is also a truth that in Brahman scriptures, right has been given to the Shudras to perform fire-worship and to take part in it. From this, it is concluded that in North-Vedic period, Shudras took participation with other sections of Aryan group in every field and they were not considered as untouchables. During North-Vedic period, some shudras were considered as untouchables and they were deprived of doing religious activities. In this way, the feeling of untouchability started in this period but it was not developed in the proper form.

2. Time after North-Vedic period (from 600 B.C to 300 B.C) :- In this period, proofs have been found about the development of the feeling of untouchability in religious literature or religious texts. According to Gautama and Aapstambh, it was forbidden for Brahmin to make Shudra to eat food with his own hand. This work should be done from his servant or slave to Brahmin. Aapstambh has written clearly that if any Shudra touch a Brahmin during eating his food then the Brahmin at once should leave the food because with the touch of Shudra, Brahmin and his food both become impure. Almost in all religious scriptures it has been said that a Brahmin should not accept food from the hand of any Shudra. Its reason was not only religious but also philosophical. In that period, it was common estimation that the type of food human eats, his views also become the same. The food of the Shudra was considered impure and if a Brahmin eats it, his views also get impure. But from the literature of this period, we come to know that some Shudras had the right to make food for Aryans in the accompany of higher sections. So it is meants that in this period, all Shudras were not considered as untouchables.

Baudhyana has written that the student who wants to get success, he should not talk to shudras and women. According to him, a believer should not do travelling in the company of women and Shudras. In Shakhayan Shrautsutra, it is said that Shudra has no right to participate in Vajpayee Yagya but Audenasab and 'Mahavarat' named religious activities, they can take part. From this, it is clear that in this period Shudras were not considered as untouchables fully.

In the scriptures of this period, the proofs which are found about untouchability, in those Shudras were not only included. In many scriptures, it has been written that any person who does not fulfill decided religious activities, he is corrupt. For instance if upto three generations of any family of Brahmins, Kshatriyas and Vaishyas, Upnayan sanskar has not performed then that family was considered corrupt and to face or see the members of that family was considered not good. There were such arrangements that such type of families had to stay outside of the village or city.

Panini in his scriptures has classified Shudras in two groups - forbidden and non-forbidden. He has considered Shudras of forbidden group as untouchables and not the Shudras of non-forbidden group. He has counted chandaal in the Shudras of forbidden group because in their living and eating, mess was found. In Aasavalyayana Strautsutra, Yowans and Kambojs are counted in

untouchable Shudras because they were not among Aryanas or we can say that they were considered untouchables because they were Upadravi.

Gautama has written in his scriptures that every person should escape himself from the touch of chandaal or the person who is outcasted. If this happens then he should take sudden bath. In Aapstambh, it is written that baharajas, nishiddhos or ugros should not study Vedic-literature. According to him, these three castes had relations with primitive tribes and these people did very low works. The same scholar has written ahead that to see and to touch a chandaal, every thing gets polluted. So it means that he has counted chandaal in forbidden Shudras. In some scriptures it is written that a person should take a bath wearing cloths if he touches a chandaal. Some views has been given in some other religious scriptures about chandaals. In Mahabhash, it is written that chandaal people live outside villages and cities. Perhaps these people are aborigins whom Aryans considered untouchables. The same proof has been found in Jatakas that chandaals in this period were considered untouchables. From Cittybhuj Jataka, it is known that in this period to see chandaals was considered bad.

In the Bhodh scriptures of Pali language except chandaals, the description of other four castes i.e. nishadh, venu, rathkar, pukas is found. These were not among Aryan's sections. So these were called bahariya. Among them, the people of nishadh caste were considered untouchables like chandaals. But venu people were considered good from chandaals and they were not considered untouchables. But after sometime, venu and rathkar people were also started considering untouchables. We come to know that in north-vedic period, rathkars were counted among high status servants and sometimes king used to stay at their homes or in those day rathkars were not considered untouchables.

In reality, the base of the feeling of untochability was, keeping themselves away from being in contact with the people who did impure works i.e. non-Aryans by Aryans,. All persons those who did the work of carrying garbage or did messy works, to them all, Aryans called, untouchables. In this way, in India, the origin of untouchability and its development was sure before historical period.

UNTOUCHABILITY IN HISTORICAL PERIOD

(*a*) Period from 300 B.C. to 200 B.C. :- This was that period in which national empire came into existence and in which Chandra Gupta Maurya got the honour of being national emperor. This was that period in which having being powerful great Ashoka had given the message to all the people to live with peace and feeling of brotherhood to the whole world. After Maurya race, Kaushans accepted this land and glorified Hindustani culture with four stars and in South India, establishment of the strong state Saatwahan and its elopement had done in the same period.

About the question of the feeling of untouchability in this period, in Manu Samriti and Mahabharta, proofs are found from which we come to know that in the beginning of the period, Shudras were not considered untouchables. Manu has appreciated the marriage of Brahmins with Shudras. In Manu Smriti, it has written that Brahmins should eat food from the house of those

Shudras who performed the death anniversary of fathers. He has also given the examples of Shudra teachers and students, But again, it is said in the smriti in its opposition that Brahmins should not have any contact with Shudras. A believer should not eat food at the house of Shudra and also should not travel with him. From this, it has concluded that in this period, the feeling of considering Shudras as untouchables had started establishing. In the beginning, only those Shudras were considered untouchables who did messy work. At that time, the feeling of untouchability was not allowed for the Shudras.

In the earlier Bodh scriptures, Chandaals, Venus, Nishadhs, Rathkars, Pukas are said low caste people. Among them who accepted the civilization of Aryans, they were given the name of Shudras. Painini has used the word non-forbidden for these Shudras. It means that these people were not left out from the Aryan society. Those who were not included in the brotherhood of Aryans they are called forbidden. In Aashwalayan, Yowans and Kambojs are considered forbidden because they were foreigners and were not related with Aryans so they were considered untochables. Surely this was the reason that Aryans did not let them eat food in their utensils and the word Malaish used for them also.

The Head Minister of Chandra Gupta Maurya and the famous scholar Kautilya has said untouchables, only to chandaals. He has written in his book of economics that if any chandaal touches an Aryan woman then the king should fine him hundred pun.

Kautilya has not counted Venus, Nishadhs, Rathkaars, Pukas among untouchables. It means that in this period, except chandaals the social condition of other untouchables was somewhat improved. At the time of death anniversary, chandaals could not see the Brahmins. He has written that chandaals should live outside villages or city and should consider as impure. Kautilya has written about chandaals that they should wear the clothes of the dead people, eat food in the broken utensils, wear jewelry of iron and wander place to place. Any people who perform religious activities should not have any contact with them. Aryans should not give them food from their own hands, the food should be given to them in the eartern utensils by the servants of Aryans. At night, they should not roam in the cities and even at day time they should enter in the cities by wearing clothes decided for them. They took the bodies of those people who did not have any relative. They hanged the people who were sentenced to death and accepted the clothes, jewelry etc. of the hanged people. In Mahabharata too, the same views are illustrated for the chandaals.

It seems that in the end of Mauryan period untouchability was developed in its full boom. This was the reason that Manu created many hard rules against Shudras. By doing this, perhaps his motive was to protect Aryan culture from the polluted impact of primitive castes. In Jatakas, Untouchability has presented in a very horrible way. In these scriptures, it is told that if any chandaal entered in a village then he informed his arrival by striking the stick against the ground. If he entered in the village without informing then he was beaten because people did not want to be impure with his touch.

(*b*) Untouchability in the period of Smrities (from 200 A.D. to 500 A.D.) :- In the Smrities of this period it has been written that Brahmin should not eat food of Shudra's house. It has meant

that this restriction was only on Brahmins. The obligation was not on Vaishyas and Kshtriyas or they did not think Shudras, untouchables and they could eat from the Shudra's houses.

Rishi Yajnavalkya has clearly written that people of higher classes could eat food at farmer, barbar, milkman or their Shudra friend. It has meant that in this priod also only those Shudras were considered as untouchables who did dirty works with their hands. In this period also chandaals were considered as untouchables because even for many Shudra castes, the food or water from chandaals hands was restricted.

Here, it is a describable fact that the basis of untouchability were not only birth and occupation but those people whose characters were corrupt or who were characterless, they were also counted among untouchables. Rishi Vashistha also considered disbelievers, backbiters, thankless people and very furious people same as chandaals. He writes that as Aryans should stay away from the contact of chandaals, in the same way, chandaals should stay away from their contact also or they should also be considered as untouchables. In the Gupta period vaishavanism, was very famous because of it Brahmins hold somewhat kind viewpoint towards Shudras and they did not declare untouchables fully.

In Smrities it is clearly written that in that period, chandaals lived outside the villages. They were not allowed to enter in the village or city at night. Even at day time they could enter by wearing the clothes decided by the king for them & before entering in the village they had to give information. According to Yajnavalkya, if a chandaal touchs a Brahmin then he should be fined hundred pun by the King but if he touches the soil of road or water, then they themselves get pure by the blowing wind. So from this, it is known that Yajnavalkya's viewpoint towards chandaals is not very hard. He has not said anywhere that after being touched by the chandaals, the people of higher sections were need to perform any religious activity to be pure again. He just suggests to have bath or to recite Gayatri Mantras after being touched by impure people. Here it is note-worthy that this arrangement was not limited to chandaals but it was also related to all impure people. From this, it is know that in this period, the condition of the chandaals was somewhat improved. Brihaspati has written that chandaals should stay away from the higher class people at the distance of sixteen hands. Fahiyan says that chandaal people stayed outside cities and bazaars. When they entered in city then they informed their entry by striking the stick against ground so that higher caste people could stay away from their touch or sight. To see chandaals was also considered impure by them.

Another scholar Amar Singh of Gupta period has used ten words for chandaals in his writing Amarkosh and these words were not used in any other scriptures before him. From this it can be concluded that in this period, there was an increase in the castes of untouchables. In this period, there were separate castes of domo and charmkar but they were not counted among untouchables. The hardness of the rules of untouchability was only for chandaals.

In Markandeya Purana, it has written that if any person's sight put on some chandaal then to make himself pure that person should do some religious activities.

The present society had view about chandaals that they live impure life, they lie, they are non-believers, they are angry, they are greedy, they are quarrelsome etc. This was the reason that the

writers of smrities had arranged very hard rules to stay away from their contact. These rules were not for all Shudras, these were for those who did dirty works and who had corrupt mentality and who were characterless.

UNTOUCHABILITY AFTER THE GUPTA PERIOD (FROM 500 A.D. TO 1200 A.D.)

In this period, untouchability had crossed all its height. The smritikars of this period had announced a very big part of Hindu society, untouchable. Many castes were deprived of social and religious rights by considering them Shudra and untouchable. Prashar has written that if some strong person eat food with Sudra, have contact with him, sit on his seat, take education from Shudra, then he becomes impure. Another smritikar has written that in Kalyug, a Brahmin should not make food from a Shudra and some other smritikar has said that if some higher caste person would have a sight of any Shudra while performing some religious activity then he should immediately stop that religious activity. If a Shudra touch him then he should atonce have a bath. According to Garg, if a higher caste person touch a Shudra, then it is enough for him to recite some mantras.

As we have read that in Gupta period, it was forbidden for a higher caste person to eat food at the home of farmer, milkman and a Shudra friend. But in this period some smritikars had arranged that higher caste perosons could eat food in the houses at these people in emergency. But after this, it was declared completely forbidden to food at the homes of these people by higher caste people. No Brahmin should give permission to enter in his kitchen of his house. So in this period many Shudras were considered as untouchables. From Hemadari (almost 1270 A.D.), we come to know that Brahmins, also stopped to eat food at Vaishyas' homes because they had deep relations with Shudras.

In this period, many sankar castes were counted among Shudras. In 'Brahmdharm Purana' people of Ambshath and Karn castes were considered as Shudras. In Ved Vysa Smriti, kairaths were also counted among Shudras. Some historians had the opinion that child from Anulom marriage remains the same but child from Pratilom marriage is equal to Shudra. Meghatithi has considered people of Soot, Magadh and Aayarav castes as untouchables because they were born because of pratilom marriage. In Brahmdharm Purana, the counting of these Sankar castes has given 41. Among them, condition of 36 castes was like Shudras or the people of these castes were considered as untouchables. It means that the smritikars of this period had declared a big part of Hindu society as untouchable.

In this period also, the chandaal had to do the same works. They took away the dead bodies of those people who did not have any relative and they hanged the guilty or they picked up the rubbish. In this period also they remained untouchables. Some smritikars of this age had the opinion that higher caste people did not only become impure by the touch of chandaal but they also became impure by their image. That person was also considered impure who saw the Shudras, talked to him or crossed his image. Those people whose God was Chandaal, in Megatithi, they are called sopak.

In Agni Purana, Sopak people are also considered as untouchables. In the literature of this period, it has said that the chandaals lived outside from villages or cities, did low works and they were considered as untouchables. The view of all smritikars of this age about the image of chandaal are not some. In Atreya, Angrish, Shatatam, Aoshnus smrities, it has said that if a Brahmin crosses the image of a chandaal then he should take a bath. Vyaghrapada and Brihaspati have the opinion that Shudra should stay away from Brahmin at a proper distance. But according to Shivdharmotar and Megatithi, no-one become impure after crossing the image of chandaal.

In Vaijanti Kosh of the eleventh century, dhobis, charmkar, venus, baluyons, machuyarons, mandons and bheelons were counted among low castes. Among them, venu, burul, maind and bheel were primitive castes but other three dhobhi, charmkar, mashuyare were considered untouchables because they earned their livelihood by doing low works. Pulind, shabar, kiraat and bheel castes lived in forests or on hills. These castes slaughtered man to please their god-godesses and they used alcohol and meat in excess. To get married, they took away the women of others. Because of their these low works they were considered as untouchables.

Some samritikars of this age have accepted followers of some other castes as corrupt. According to them, Bodh, Jain, Lingayat, Nastik, followers of Kapil and Vammargi Shakat all were untouchables. In Brahmand Purana, it is said that every high caste person becomes impure by touching Shaiv, pashupat, lokyato people and to become pure again that person has to take bath by wearing clothes. Varid Hatir has the opinion that every person should take bath to be pure after touching Shaiv or after entering in temples of Bodhs.

The description which is given above about untouchability, we end up that in the words of Pandurang Vaman Kane who has concluded after studying religious scriptures deeply that in ancient religious literature, except chandaals many people of the following sections were considered as untouchables :

1. The person who did some severe sin was banned and he was considered as untouchable. But that untouchability was limited. It means that these persons after regreting could enter in their castes again and their untouchability was ended.
2. In that period, the followers fo Bhodh dharma were considered non-believers so they were thought untouchables. Kautilya has written clearly in his writing economics that Bodh people should not be invited at death anniversary.
3. Those people were also considered untouchables who pretended to worship of gods just for the greed of money.
4. The crops that Aryans did not use, the sellers of those crops were also considered untouchables.
5. During menstruation, every woman was considered untouchable.
6. The persons who carried away the dead bodies were also considered untouchables.
7. Some countries were considered untouchable and the persons who travelled to those countries were also considered as untochables.

But now in our country, the curse of untouchability has stopped. According to our constitution, to take untouchability in practice has declared illegal. In today's scientist era, even the dirtiest work has done with cleanliness. So to consider a person untouchable from the very birth is a big foolishness. If Hindu society wants to progress then it should give all social, religious, political and economic rights to all those untouchables who are deprived of these rights. To get rid from the feeling of untouchability many laws are made by our Govt. and many steps have taken for the welfare of these untouchable people. But still in India many places are such where these bad luck people are still depriving of these rights. People of high castes do not allow them to take water from their wells and even don't allow them to enter in the temples. It is very unhappy behaviour. By removing the feeling of high-low and untouchability, we have to make Indian society and every phase of this country strong. This is the first and important duty of all of us.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What do you know about Untouchability ? Give a detailed account of untouchability in Pre-Historical Period.
2. Give an account of untouchability from 300 B.C. to the Gupta Period.
3. What were the trends of untouchables from 500 A.D. to 1200 A.D. ?

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

o our constitution,
n the dirtiest work
s a big foolishness.
ical and economic
om the feeling of
he welfare of these
ck people are still
om their wells and
moving the feeling
se of this country

uchability in Pre-

CHAPTER – 8
SCHEDULED CASTES

India is a vast country, where in the society, Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaisha and Shudras are found on the basis of their caste. Shudras were the most backward of the people in the society who were discriminated in every sphere of life. In this section of the society, people of scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and backward classes can be included. Ever since the ancient age, people of this class have been discriminated in economic and social spheres. The people of upper classes not only hated them, but exploited them too. Therefore due to strict bars of caste and class, these people lagged behind in every field of life. Till independence, their condition was miserable. After independence of India, several provisions in its constitution were made whose target was to grant opportunities and facilities for the progress and development of these people of backward classes. As per Indian constitution, backward classes can be divided in four sections on the whole as under:-

1. Scheduled Castes
2. Scheduled Tribes
3. Denotified Tribes
4. Socially and Economically Backward Classes

1. Scheduled Castes :- As is above narrated, Indian society has been divided mainly in four classes - Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudras. Shudras were the lowest of the society who were called 'untouchables'. The others classes of the society hated them and they were kept deprived from general human rights. No bond of bread was kept with this section of the society. There was a bar on them to go to public and religious places. Brahmins even avoided to see them, not to speak of touching them. So they avoided even the shadow of them. Their main profession was to do cleansing work and leather works etc. They had no right to change their profession as per their will. This was the reason that they had no right to receive education. In this way these people had the lowest status in the society.

In the 20th century, Mahatma Gandhi made important steps to improve their condition i.e., he addressed them with the name of Harijans instead of untouchables. Due to efforts of Gandhi, the British Govt. gave these people same facilities under the Govt. of India Act and these people were given the name of scheduled castes which then included 429 castes.

In Independent India the people of this class have not been given equal rights like others, but they have been given even many privileges also, so that they may make progress in their life. Now their name has been given the list of scheduled castes.

In this regard this has been provided in the article 341 (1) of the Indian Constitution that,

The President may with respect to any State or Union territory, and where it is a State after consultation with the Governor thereof, by public notification, specify the castes, races or tribes or

parts of or groups within castes, races or tribes which shall for the purposes of this Constitution be deemed to be Scheduled Castes in relation to that State or Union territory, as the case may be

It may be remembered that an amendment may be made from time to time in the list of scheduled castes and scheducled tribes. The parliament had made amendment in 1956 in the list of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes which was issued by the Indian President in 1950. A statute namely, 'The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes order (Amendment) Act (1956) was passed. In India currently 779 scheduled castes are included in it.

2. Scheduled Tribes :- Such a group of people are called scheduled tribes who earlier spent their lives on high mountains or in the jungles in isolation of general people. So they were an uncivilized people. Generally they fed themselves by hunting of wild animals. But at some places, they did agriculture also on a small or marginal scale. In fact these people were more backward even than the scheduled castes. In Independent India, these have been included in the list of scheduled tribes so as to bring them in the national main-stream.

Parliament may by law include in or exclude from the list of Scheduled Castes specified in a notification issued under clause (1) any caste, race or tribe or part of or group within any caste, race or tribe, but save as aforesaid a notification issued under the said clause shall not be varied by any subsequent notification.

It may be kept in a mind that the Indian Parliament has a right to make amendments in the list of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes promulgated by the Indian President. It means that the number of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes can be decreased/increased. The President of India had presented a lists of scheduled classes which was amended by the Indian Parliament in 1956 through 'The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes' order (Amendment) Act, 1956.

3. Denotified Tribes :- Two classes can be included in the Denoatified tribes—migrant tribes and unclassified tribes. The people of migrant tribes do not reside permanently at a single place. But they migrate from place to place in search of their livelihood and temporarily camp outside the towns and cities. Their main job is to sell iron-wares in towns and cities.

On the other hand those people can be included in un-categorised classes who in order to earn their livelihood follow the profession of show-works like dance of monkeys and bears, snakes shows or sell herbs and roots and other articles so as to feed themselves. The women of these tribes too do the job of public dancing and singing in order to fecd themselves and their family members.

As per Criminal Tribes Act 1924, about 137 tribes were declared criminal tribes. There was a provision in this Act, that whenever a child was born in such tribes, then he was considered criminal that very day and on completion of 18 years of age, his name was registered in police record as a born criminal. These people were kept like prisoners in their colonies under police supervision. They were made to do works related to agriculture and craftsmanship under police supervision.

After independence, Indian Government prohibited it to treat their children without any offence as criminals. In 1952, the Indian government replaced Criminal Tribes Act of 1924 and changed its name into Denotified tribes and Indian government made special provisions for giving education, training and jobs to these classes.

4. Other Backward Classes :- Socially and economically backward people in the society have been given the name of other Backward classes. The Central Government has not prepared the list of other backward classes, but has given the right to the respective State Government, that they may prepare the schedules of other backward classes on the basis of specified criteria. This is the reason that the State Governments have made the lists of other backward classes keeping in view their economic conditions. These people of backward classes too have been given special rights like scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and notified tribes in education, employment and in local governments.

Constitutional provisions and steps taken by the Government for the welfare of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and other backward classes.

India is a welfare state in which government is obliged to take steps for the welfare of every caste, tribe and class, It is special responsibility of the government to do the welfare of scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and other backward classes and their people. In Indian Constitution too, special provisions have been made for the welfare of these classes. Besides this, many government and N.G.Os too take special measures for the welfre of these people. In Independent India, following steps have been taken for betterment of these special classes.

1. Right to equality :- In articles 14 to 18 of part 3 of Indian constitution, right to legal equality has been mentioned, as per which every section of society is given a legal equality and without distinction of caste, colours, religion and sex, equal citizens rights are given to all. In this way, special facilities are given to the erstwhile untouchable castes to bring their status at par with the other sections of the society.

2. End of untouchability :- As per article 17 of the Indian constitution, a provision has been made for legal abolition of untouchability and if some person treats some (erstwhile) untouchable caste in an unequal way, then an action may be taken against him meaning he can be punished or fixed. As per article 35, Indian Parliament has the right to decide punishment for violating the article 17 of Indian Constitution, which means that a jail of 6 months or a fine of Rs 500/- or both can be given to him.

3. Right to access to public places :- Earlier these esstwhile untouchables had no right to enter the public places, temples, water taps or wells, vehicles, buses, hotels etc, be but as per article 15, this provision has been made that the shops, hotels, recreation rooms, cinemas etc. public places are kept open for all the persons and no person can be barred from using these places on the basis of his religion, caste, race, colour etc. Similarly public wells, ponds, washing rooms, roads etc. set up by the government are opened for all the citizens without any discrimination. Besides this, the state can make special arrangements for the welfare of backward classes, scheduled castes and tribes. It may be remembered that such action of the state will not contradict article 15 of the Indian Constitution under which discrimination on the basis of caste, race, tribe, birth place, religion etc is prohibited.

4. Right to elect and be elected :- In an Independent India, the people of scheduled castes, tribes and classes have not been given merely the right to vote and to contest elections, but also many seats are reserved for them in all the elected bodies of the country like Panchyati Raj institutions, municipalities, boards, State Legislative Assemblies and in the parliament of the country these election facilities are available to these people till now in 2015.

5. Representation in the Council of Ministers :- Though there is no constitutional provision to the effect that the people of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes and classes will definitely be given representation is cabinets at the center or state levels of India, but practically this has become customary for the Indian Prime Minister to give proportional representation to the members of these castes and tribes and classes and similarly in all the States of Indian Union, the respective Chief Ministers have to necessarily include the representatives of these special categories in his council of ministers. This is done with view that these representatives may participate in the policies of the government for the betterment of their respective caste categories.

6. Facilities for education :- Many special facilities have been given by the government for free providing of education to the students of scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and classes and other backward classes. The members of these castes and tribes are given totally free education from 1st class to the university level. They are given special discount in the examination fees. Similarly the Government of India every year arranges for the higher education or training in foreign countires for that students of these special castes and tribes. Under this scheme, every year, 50-60 students are sent to foreign countries for higher education or training, so that they may contribute to public welfare work in their own country. Arrangements are also made for these special categories for milk and day-meals also in the schools. At the time of admission in the general education and technical and industrial education, a sizeable percentage of seats are kept reserved for the students of these special categories.

7. Reservation in the civil services :- Reservation of a sizeable number of seats for these scheduled castes and scheduled classes and backward classes has been provided in the All India Central and State Civil Services. In this way since 1990, 27 % seats have been reserved in All-India Central civil services for the people of these backward classes. In state civil services too, many places are reserved for all these classes and categories. It may be kept in mind as per one decision of supreme court of India, theoretically reservation should not exceed a total of 50 %. Similarly the government of India has arranged for many training centers for preparing them for competition examinations. In north India, Punjab University, Chandigarh, Punjabi university Patiala, Guru Nanak Dev University, Amritsar and Shimla Univ. Shimla etc are important centers among these center. In these training centres, free education and training is given to the students of these special categories and a totally free arrangements of their lodgeing and boarding is also made.

8. Reservation in Promotion :- Besides reservation in recruitments, the members of scheduled castes, scheduled categories and backward classes are given reservation in promotions also and some percentge of promotions also are reserved for them. This is done so that these people may get an opportunity to work at higher posts. It may be remembered the Supreme Court of India had abolished this privilege through one of its decisions, but through 88 constitutional amendment, this privilege has been reinstalled.

9. Grants and Loans :- The Govt. of India allocates interest free loans and grants to the scheduled castes and scheduled classes for purchase of land and plots, for setting up industrial units, for building good homes etc., so that these people may build means of their livelihood. For completion of these plans, many times the government of India issues grants and loans to the state governments of India also.

10. Encouragement for inter-caste marriages :- Awrds are given by the Indian goverment and respective state governments to those persons, who make marital relations with the scheduled castes and scheduled tribes. This policy of the Indian goverment has been very successful. because many people have broken the caste bars and done inter-caste marriages.

11. Unofficial bodies :- Besides the goverment arrangments, many Non-Govermental Organistatons (NGOs) too are giving their contribution towards the welfare of these special categories like scheduled castes, scheduled categories and other backward classes. Such important organisation are - Harizan Sewak Sangh, Indian Dalit category people, Hind Sweepers Sangh, Indian Adam Jati Sangh, All Indian Backward classes federation, Rama Krishna Mission, Servants of Indian Society etc.

12. Commissioner of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes :- As per article 338 of Indian Constitution, a Commissioner for scheduled castes and scheduled categories was appointed by the Govt. of India. Through this 68th constitutional amendment in 1990, commission has been made a multi member organisation.

COMPOSITION OF THE COMMISSION

Thus Commission has one chairman, one vice chairman, 3 other members. They are appointed by Indian president. The president decides for the service conditions and tenure of the posts for the commission Chairman, vice chairman and other members.

FUNCTIONS OF THE COMMISSION

As per Indian constitution, commissioner of scheduled castes and scheduled categories will have the responsibility to do scrutiny of welfare programmes related to these categories and to present his report in this regard to the President of India who further presents this report to the Indian Parliament. The National Commission for scheduled Castes and scheduled tribes has the following assignments at present :-

1. Scrutiny and assessment of special facilites available to the scheduled castes and scheduled categories through constitution or some other law.

2. To investigate in the special help given in cases of violation of special rights to the people of scheduled castes and scheduled categories.

3. To take part in the planning for social and economic development of these people amd to give suitable advice to the goverment in this regard and to assess the progress report.

4. To present an annual report to the Indian President about the above arrangements.

5.To give recommendations to the President of India about the steps taken by the Central Government or some State Government for social, economic progress and welfare of scheduled castes and scheduled categories.

6. To do other such works related to the security, development and progress of the scheduled castes and scheduled categories, which are assigned by the Indian President to the Commission.

7. It may be kept in mind that the commission has all the rights of a civil court.

1. It can call the witnesses and ensure their attendance.

2. It can order for presentation of any document before him.

3. It can call any governmental record of any court or office. The commission has given the following suggestions in its various annual reports :-

(*i*) Besides the steps taken in the field of legal provisions, measures should be implemented effectively for complete abolition of untouchability. For this purpose, services of regional staff of common development plan programmes, and welfare department should be taken. The state government should set up various committies, so that untouchability in different areas may be assessed.

(*ii*) The services of the Panchayats are very essential for removal of the evil of untouchbility. Their answerability should be enhanced and the state governments and union territorries administration should send a warning to the panchayats in this regards that no social discrimination should be meted out to the people of scheduled castes and tribes who live in their areas. Presently, this provision has been made that in the areas of those Panchayat in which discrimination has not been ended with the scheduled castes and scheduled tribes, their aids and grants may be with-held.

(*iii*) The commission has given this sauggestion also that whenever the State Governments prepare a scheme for landless labour, then it should pay a special attention to the scheduled categories. If landless farmers are given some land, then the people of these categories should be given preference. Under Bhumidan (land donation) and Gram-dan (Rural donation) schemes, Economic departments and Bhumidan committees should keep the record of benifits received by the people of these categories, so that it may be ascertained to which extent these people have benefitted.

(*iv*) The commission has given the direction to the State government that like the Punjab Government they should make laws in their respective states, under which the needy among these categories may be given interests free and surety free loans. The commission is also investigatng in the issue that in those states where steps to erase discrimination in the Hindus have been taken, then suggestions to them may be forwarded if there is some discrepancy in them.

(*v*) In the government employment, seats reserved for the people of scheduled castes and scheduled categories are not filled up fully. Though the people of these categories are being encouraged to join the State services, but no machinery is available which may reveal within a short duration of time the information about the filled up and unfilled parts. Similarly the Central Government takes suggestions of the commission an expenditure of education to people of these categories.

Conclusion :- From the above description, it becomes totally clear that besides the constitutional provisions, many steps have been taken by the government organisations and non-government oragnisations for the welfare of scheduled castes, scheduled tribes and other backward classes. But it is a matter of regret that even after implemention of constitution of independent India, desirable targets have not been achieved. Inspite of this, the fundamentalist people say that no social equality should be granted to the people of these categories and so in some parts of the country, discrimination is done to the people of these categories. So the government should take effective steps for removal of excesses on the people of these categories.

DEFINITION OF SCHEDULED CASTES

1. As per **D. N. Mazumdar,** "The untouchable castes were those who suffered from various social and political disabilities many of which were traditionally prescribed and socially enforced by the higher castes."

2. As per **G. S. Ghurge,** "I define scheduled castes in the form of those groups which are included in the order of scheduled castes."

PROBLEMS OF SCHEDULED CASTES

Scheduled Castes have been kept deprived from many religious, social and political rights. In fact these handicaps of the scheduled castes are the reasons of their backwardness.

1. Restriction to public places :- The members of this category were prohibited to go to the public places.They could not go to public places. If they want there or broke the social customs, they were given punishment.

2. Untouchability :- The people of lower castes could not even touch the higher castes. Schedule castes were called untouchabilities.They had to go through several religious rites for this impurity, so as to obtain freedom from this uncleanliness.Even the people remained away from their shadow too.

3. Educational disabilities :- The level of their education was very low.Scheduled castes had no right to education. If someone got admission to educational institution, then he was mistreated.

4. Lack of choice in occupation :- These castes could not choose an occupation of their liking.They had a permission to do the works of leather, skinning, brooming and such types of other works only.

5. Social disabilities :- The concept of untouchability in Hindu society has always given a low place to the untouchables. Due to their low place in the society, it appears as if these people are not part of the Hindu society and form a seperate community. Not alone their touch, but even the shadow of them was avoided by the upper caste Hindus.This practice remained in vague upto the start of 20th century. But this condition is no more. Now they can go to any public place independently. They can use the public places in an equal way. Much time ago untouchable children could not gain an entry into the schools. If he howsoever entered the school, he could not sit with the Hindu children. So they remained deprived of education. In the India of bygone eras, this situation was deploreable. Their habitations in separate colonies was indication of a boycott of them. Their houses were of shanties and huts and improvised coteries. Even now caste hindus do not like to reside with them. But there is one strange thing in the behaviour of scheduled castes and scheduled categories also. They too have an internal sense of untouchability. One cobbler or skinner cannot touch a washerman or one scavenger cannot touch a cobbler or skinner. These people mutually observe untouchability in the way the high castes do with the people of untouchable castes. In india there are

several untouchable castes whose people do not consider it auspicious to go to brahmins or to see them.

6. Religion disabilities :- In the ancient period, a great injustice was done to the untouchables. They were not allowed to enter the temples and the untouchables could not study the Vedas. There is a mention in the Vedas that the women and shudras are not deserving to study the Vedas. If some shudra mistakenly entered the temples and heard the Vedas, or recited them, a strict penalty was given to him and many tribulations were caused.

Not this only, they were kept away from the religious rites, No priest could perform religious rituals in their homes. With the passage of time, many social reformers came forward. They made several efforts for the removal of these evils, but the Hindus too opposed the entry of the untouchables into temples. They were adamant in this regard. So the social reformers were forced to stage agitations against them. Arya Smaaj and Gandhiji are highly praise worthy in this regard. Todays shudras have all the rights like the other Hindus and they cannot be restrained from performing pooja after entry in the temples.

7. Political disabilities :- The untouchables had no chance to partake in the government affairs and whatever justice was given to them by the state too was based on a sense of discrimination. So much so, these castes were deprived of general social rights also. But now this is not the situation. Now provisions have been made for reservation of these people into state services.

8. Economic disabilities :- Just like social field, in the economic field also, these untouchables had to face several hardship. Scheduled castes had no land, so they could do not farming. Due to landlessness, they were compelled to do labour. So they did the work of labour in the land of the landlords. Moreover the landloards exploited them through the practice of Begar labour (partially forced labour). From an economic point, they had very inferior occupation. They earned from these occupations so less that they could not meet their both ends. On different occassions, they were compelled to take loans from money lenders and could not repay their loans for their whole of life. They were forced to do inherited and detestable works and were not allowed to do economically better jobs. Due to this drawback, they had to survive under pitiable conditions. This is the very reason that under the changed conditions too, these people are still caught in vicious circle of poverty. Due to a sense of untouchability, inspite of necessary ability, these people cannot gain entry into various institutions. Consequentially, their economic conditions remain in doldrums.

THE CONUSEQUENCES OF DISABILITIES

From the above details, many handicaps of the untouchable people are highlighted. These handicaps have very ill-effects. We can describe these ill-effects as under :-

1. Political Consequences : Political field too could not remain intact from the handicaps of untouchables and their ill-effects are seen in politics. Due to several bars on these people in the name of untouchability, one consequence was that the untouchables began to think themselves separate from Hindu society and slowly this feeling caught so force that the Harizan headers refused to continue as a part of the Hindu Society. They stopped the use of Hindu word for themselves. So

the unity of Hindu society was threatened. The Harizans demanded separate rights for themselves. But due to efforts of Gandhi ji, this could not happen and he stopped the separation of Harizans from the Hindus.

2. Religious consequences : The results of these deficiencies are seen in the field of religion also. Religion has a special place in the life of a person and several personal expectations are attached with the religion. A large number of these people have changed their religion. Due to these conversions, the numbers of Hindus have declined. Christians, Muslims, Sikhs, Buddists do not accept untouchability. Instead these religion oppose and refute untouchability. So many of these untouchables have accepted the other religions which has attacked the Hinduism very much.

3. Conequences related to ignorance :- Due to insufficiencies in the field of education, a big part of Indian Society remained ignorant and superstitious. No effort was done by these people for their genuine rights. Ignorance added to their sorrows and these people were unsuccessful to face the exploitation and bars of other castes. So several provisions have been made for education of there people and they have been given many educational facilities, so that these people may progress like other people of the society and may use the equality rights.

4. Economic consequences :- These disabilities have generated many ill-effects in economic areas also. Due to these deficiencies particularily due to economic deficiencies, economic disparities of untouchable castes have increased. The economic condition of this untouchable class remained very low. Not even this, these people could not contribute to the economic development of the society, inspite of their ability and skill. So these people had to face several economic difficulties and today also these people are facing these difficulties in one way or other.

5. Consequences related to low standard of life :- These handicaps had multi-dimensional and for reaching consequences. These people were forced by the Hindu upper castes to live in dirty habitations. Here neither the facilities for health problems nor for proper stay and eating and drinking were available. Under this condition, their low level of life was a natural thing.

Conclusion :- In this way we can conclude that due to these bars and handicaps, where these untouchable people had to face several restraints and difficulties in social fields, there they had to face economic disparities also. As a consequence, the problems of illiteracy, dirtyness, poverty, low level of life etc. several problems took root. But after independence, a surprising improvement in their condition has happened because untouchability has been made a punishable crime and any person practising it is given strict punishment, so that this problem of untouchability may be rooted out.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What do you mean by Scheduled Castes ? Explain their disabilities.
2. Describe the disabilities of untouchable castes in India.
3. Discuss the changes in the status of Scheduled Castes in the Modern India. Explain.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 9

SCHEDULED TRIBES : MEANING AND DISABILITIES

INTRODUCTION

In Indian constitution, different 550 tribes are declared scheduled. According to the census of 1961, the total number of tribes was 2,98,83,470 in which the number of women was 148,42,763 and of men was 150,40707. By collective efforts, tribes related themselves to many Indian religions. Most of the tribes among them accepted Hindu religion. From the viewpoint of population, Gond, Santhaal and Munda tribes are very famous. In India, there are more than 550 tribes in different states those are called scheduled tribes. At present, sub- tribal groups are established as separate tribes. So there is an increase in its number. The information of these tribes is noted down in article 342 of constitution. Because of the development of the means of transportation and communication, at present the relations of tribes with other people have developed. By not sticking to their hereditary occupations, they are now capable to adopt new occupations. Now these people are able to get any profession like- teacher, doctor, engineer and many other professions. So it is impossible to keep these tribes in one stream based on their work because these people have started accepted many other occupations along with hereditary occupations. Like in Bhotat, women are efficient in the works of making clothes and carpets. Among 550 Indian tribes, govt. has kept 75 groups under tribal group.

DISABILITIES OF SCHEDULE TRIBES

Tribes have come into contact with our society just before some time. The disabilities that lower castes have to face, tribes did not have to face those disabilities. The description of their disabilities is as follow :-

1. Poverty :- Tribal people could not make progress and remained backward. No section of these people was found in the society and they had limited needs. But gradually they come in contact with the society and their needs started increasing. Tribal people are being exploited by money-lenders and landlords.

2. Policy of Segregation :- When Britishers started exploiting India then tribal people come in their way. Then, Britishers adopted a policy of segregation to separate these people. Because of the policy of segregation adopted by Britishers, these people kept on being backward in the society and because of it they became more poor.

3. Exploitation of Tribes :- Because of Britishers, tribal people started to come in contact with other people in the society. When the Britishers started to spread telegram lines to make administration more strong in India then tribal people opposed it violently. By getting angry, Britishers forced their landlords and money-lenders to exploit tribal people. In this way their living standard

became more worse and they did not remain able to spend a good life. In this way, this disability happened among these people.

PROBLEMS OF THE PEOPLE OF TRIBES

Many economic, social and cultural problems are these, the description of which is as follows :

1. Child Marriage :- Tribal people came under the influence of Hindu religion. Influenced by Hindu religion, tribal people started to get married their children at a very young age, because of which they had to face many problems.

2. Problems of Agriculture :- The techniques of agriculture of the tribal people were very old. Because of the ancient method of agriculture so the production is quite less. They can't fill their stomachs because of less production so they have to do labour also.

3. Prostitution : Moneylenders do misuse of the tribal people's poverty and make extra- martial relations with their women. In this way, women are moving towards prostitution.

4. Problems of Debtness :- Tribal people spend their whole life paying their debts to moneylenders and become more poor.

5. Problems related to Forest :- Tribal people collect their things of eating from forests and sell the wood by getting that cut from the forests. But they have to face a lots of problems when forests laws are made and forests are hired. So,it has become hard for them to survive.

6. Health related Problems :- Tribal people stay away from common population. In their areas, there is spread of epidemics like - cholera, smallpox etc. Tribal people are working in industries so industry related diseases are also increasing.

7. Educational Problems :- The main cause of poverty of tribal people is illiteracy. Now they are also getting education in English, even after that many problems are taking birth. They are leaving their hereditary occupations because of which they are being unemployed. Even after getting education, their problems are increasing.

WAYS TO REMOVE PROBLEMS

If there is a problem, then its soultion is also certain. In this way, tribes have some problems and there can be a solution to these problems. If a plan is properly made then their solution can be easily found. The solution to their problems is as follows :

1. Prostitution should be stopped from their society so that morality would not be dissolved, so they should be given economic help.
2. There should be provision of hospitals and efficient doctors in tribal areas.
3. Laws should be made to stop child marriage in their areas. Bribe cost should be stopped so that there can be marriages in their areas and immoral works are stopped.

4. Cottage industries should be developed in their areas. Loans and grants should be given to them.
5. After being educated, education related to handcraft and many other works should be given to them.
6. Lands should be given to tribal people to do agriculture so that they can do agriculture by living at one place.
7. Laws should be made related to forests so that they can be benefitted by forests too.
8. Education about modern techniques of agriculture should be given to them to increase production. Along with this, they should be suggested to stop transposed agriculture.
9. They should given education in their mother tongue.
10. Schools should be opened in tribal areas.
11. Education of doctory and compoundory should be given to tribal people so that in the hour of need they can do their own treatment.

STEPS TAKEN BY THE GOVERNMENT TO SOLVE THE PROBLEMS OF TRIBAL SOCIETY

For the welfare of scheduled tribes and development of their areas, many solutions are given in the constitution. Much money has been collected to be spent on five year plans and many welfare programmes to join them to the main force of the country. In the constitution, the steps taken by the govt. for the welfare of the tribes are described as follows :

1. In five year plans, Centre and State governments have kept crores of rupees for the welfare of scheduled tribes. Many other programmes are being enforced.
2. Special grant would be given to the states by central govt. for tribal welfare and proper administration in their areas according to the article 275 of constitution.
3. According to the article 325 of constituiton, no citizen would be deprived of the right to vote. Tribal people also have the right to vote.
4. President selects a special officer for scheduled tribes and castes according to the article 338. Every year, this officer gives information about these groups to the President.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What do you understand by Scheduled Tribes ? Explain their Disabilities.
2. What are the disabilities that the Scheduled Tribes suffer in our Society ?
3. What are the Steps taken by the government to solve the problems of Tribal Society ?

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑

CHAPTER – 10
STATUS OF WOMEN IN INDIA

It is essential to know the condition of the women in present and in past in a society or in a country, before the knowledge of history of that country or a society. Without this knowledge, there is no use of gaining knowledge about the history, because without this information, we cannot acquire the knowledge of social and cultural structure of that country. Our country too is not an exception to this rule. Since the ancient times in our paternal societies, sons have got more importance than daughters. There were many causes for it. The first was that as a warrior, the son was more useful than a daughter. Secondly, in economic activities also, more benefits were expected from a son than a daughter. The third reason was that the son was considered to be an increaser in the family-tree because the daughter was supposed to leave for their inlaws. In this chapter, we shall discuss about the various conditions of the woman-kind and about various systems, marriages and family related to them.

I. DIFFERENT STAGES OF WOMAN'S STATUS

1. As a daughter :- In a vedic society, there was no reason of grievance at the time of a daughter-birth. Though a desire for a son was definitely made, which was considered a natural thing. Certainly some such religious rites have been mentioned in Arthaveda whose aim was to achieve a son, but the family members did not become sorrowful at a daughter-birth. From the ancient scriptures, we very well know that many such religious rites were performed whose aim was to get a daughter. For example in the Brihad-Arynak Upnishda, one such religious ritual has been described whose aim was to obtain an intelligent and able daughter. In these days, the girls could study the Vedic literature or do a yajna to please the gods. There was no difficulty in their marriage because widow-marriage was allowed in the society, so they were not considered a burden on the society. Due to these reasons, daughters were seen with an inferiority complex. Due attention was given to their education. We know about this from several Rigveda works, whose comparison was done by females like Hopemudra, Vishwa-wara, Sikta, Nivavery and Ghasha etc.

In the past vedic period, the girls had no right to perform yajna so as to please the gods. These religious works were began to be done by the sons alone. In some families, the birth of daughters was considered inauspicious. But still no uncare in their upbringing was taken and full attention towards their education too was paid. Usually the girls were married only after an age of 16 years. They were also given 'Upnayan ritual' through which they were initiated into a student life. In the Arthaveda, there is a clear mension of girls persuing a Brahmacharya Ashram (celibacy). Matry the wife of Rishi Yagavalkya took part along with husband in philosophical and religious discourses. Gargi and Aatryi etc. women were quite educated and they had knowledge of the Vedas sufficiently.

The girls usually lived under the care of their parents. After the death of the father, older brother looked after them. The married women lived in the custody of their husbands. But we get clear proofs of this fact that in the past vedic period, i.e., at the time of rise of Buddhism, the birth of a daughter was considered painful for the family.

2. Woman's position as a wife :- In the ancient period, target of marriage in spouses in Indian society was not merely to satisfy the sex-desire or to beget children, but through this ritual, the aim of matrimony was to develop their worldly and spiritual attainments. In the family life, it was expected for the couple that they should bear children and arrange education of them and thus make them useful for the society. In the Rigveda period, the institution of marriage had developed in an advanced form and after the marriage the couple spent a life of restraint. In that period an unmarried person was considered impure and useless for the society. In a contemporary scripture, it is written that the women which is not married, her funeral rites cannot be performed. It implies that in that period the marriage of young boys and girls was deemed to be an essential social obligation. Child-bearing woman was given a great respect in the society. Non-birth of a child was taken as a misfortune for the family. Normally a man married only one woman but some rich people in some circumstances married more than one woman.

In the Vedic period, usually the girls were married at their adulthood, we find many instances in the Rigveda and Arthveda where we know that some girls themselves selected their own husbands and their parents helped them in this matter. In those days Gandherva Marriage (Love marriages also happened, We find instances of Rakshas marriage (Demon marriages) also in the Rigveda. One example is that one warrior namely Vimard got his wife after conquering a war. The mention of Aswa marriage (diabolical marriage) is also made. In such a marriage the side of a male offered money to the father of a daughter or her custodians. But such marriages were condemned on the whole. If the girl had some physical defect, then the father had to marry her by giving dowry. Some wealthy fathers too gave dowry at the time of marriage of their daughters. In the Rigveda, there is a mension of a rich father who gave a dowry of one hundred cows to the bridegroom side. We know from several instances in the Rigveda that the girls were married in their adult age.

It is clear from vedic literature that the wife was given a high respect in the family. She was believed to be Griha Lakshmi i.e., wealth of the home. From the very word 'patni' (wife) it is clear that in social and religious activities, her position was equal to her husband. In the Vedas, husband and wife have been jointly given the name of a couple (Dampati), which means both of them were equal owners of the home. In the Shatpatha Brahmin scripture, it is said that a man is incomplete without his wife. No Yajna was considered complete without a wife. In the Aitrey Brahmin scripture, wife has been said to be a friend. There used not be a conflict in a couple, because there was a harmony in their views. The wife looked after all the domestic works. She had a complete control over servants, slaves and slave-girls. She had a control of elderly inlaw parents, inlaw younger brothers and sisters also. The wives respected the tutors of their husbands.

But in the past vedic period, surely the position was not the same as earlier. Though in these scriptures, she is narmed as a better-half (Ardhangini), yet now they were deprived from the religious works in an independent way. In this period, the wives were also counted as private property of the husbands. They were classified alongwith wine and gambling. The wives normally took food after their husbands. Only that wife was considered a good wife who did not give replies to a husband before him. At some places in Brahmin scriptures the condition of a woman is equated with a Shudra. This can be inferred from this fact that equal punishment was given to the murderer of a Shudra or a woman.

Generally women were faithful to their husbands. But in the past-vedic period in some scriptures, a religious ritual named Varun Praghas is mentioned through which an adulterous woman was accepted by the husband, after her due atonement. In the Vaj-snehi Samhinta (Code) we come to know of an unmarried mother. But such incidents were quite less, because those were condemned by the society. In the past vedic period, some incidences of polyamy are known, but they were generally made by the Kashtriya-kings.

3. Position of widow :- In the vedic period, the condition of women was no low as was the case in the following times. In the Rigvedic period the woman whose husband died was allowed to do a second marriage. Usually she did this second marriage with her younger brother in law or with some other male relative of her deceased husband. The only aim of the widow marriage was to give birth to children. Those widows who had already a son, spent their whole life in the memory of their husbands without any remarriage. No mention of widow-immolation (sati) is made in the Rigveda. A widow woman gave a bath to the dead body of her husband, but never committed self-immolation (sati) on his pier. It is mentioned in the Arthaved that widow-women used to lie beside their dead husbands, from which the scholars have inferred that upto this period the practice of sati had begun.

4. Veil system :- In the scriptures from initial period upto 6th century B.C. no mention of veil-system is made. When the wife went to her husband's home first time, then all the family members saw her face in which males were also present. In these days women participated in Yajnas, feasts and public convocations without any veil on their face. As per Yasak, the women themselves attended the courts in order to claim their right portion. So we know from this that veil system was in currency in those days.

5. Occupation for women :- In the vedic period, women generally remained busy in their domestic works only. From the works in Rigveda, we know that in those tribes in which the males were often busy in their war-fares, their women in addition to their domestic works also looked after animal-rearing and agricultural activities. In the past vedic period, we know about other obligations of the women like weaving, sewing and dyeing of clothes, embroidery, basket-making, flour-dowing, bow and arrows making etc. The main entertainment of women was singing and dancing.

6. Women's participation in religious rites :- In the Rigveda too, prayers have been made to the gods, where it has been said that they were from both husband and wife. In the absence of her

husband, the wife solely performed religious rites. This comes to light from this that in the Rigveda period, the wife had a right to do yajna and give offerings. The couple jointly defended the yajna-fire. It is a clear mention in Arthveda that at that time, the girls were also given an initiation ceremony and they studied the vedic scriptures. Afterwards religious deeds became largely complex which were then completed by the males alone. But at the time of their performance, presence of the wife was considered compulsory. But in the last phase of past vedic period, priests had replaced the wives which means that several such religious activities had begun in which participation of wife was not obligatory. But in yajnas like Rajsuya, Ashwamedh, Vajpay etc. presence of wife was still considered compulsory. A clear description is given in Shatpath Brahmina that the women had a complete right to study vedic scriptures and to perform yajna. In Tatriya Brahmin too, a religious activity has been mentioned after performing which the women got a right ot study vedic sriptures and to do yajna.

From the above description we know that upto 6th century B.C. the status of women had come down as compared to earlier times, yet her condition was not so deploreable, because in this age too, they had a right to take part in various social and economic rites. In these families, where son was not born, the daughters did the funeral rites and in some circumstances, women inherited some part of their ancestral property.

In principle, at present and forever, the woman has a dignity and is respected. In Hindu society, mother has a place of respect. The power of omnicient all mighty god are described in faminine forms of Lakshmi (wealth), Saraswati (knowledge), Durga (power) and Kali etc. In this way, woman power is believed to be incarnation of force, wealth and knowledge. This is symbol of our nationality. We call our country as 'Bharat Mata' and show our faith towards her, but inspite of this practically the discrimination and excesses which have mared our to women are known by us all.

DISABILITIES IN THE LIFE OF WOMEN

In the medieval age, the condition of women was highly miserable but in the modern age also their disabilities are not small. In the Indian society, disabilities faced by the women were as under :

1. Social disabilities :- Though women have progressed to a large extent in these days, still they have to face difficulties in several fields. Women do not have the right equal to men. In this country, education is received only for a job and it is not considered. suitable for the women to do a job. So no need of education is thought for them. Traditionally it is considered against the honour of a family if its women work outside the home. They are mothers first and then only earners of money. Before independence, number of employed was just nominal. Formation of committees and Sanghs by the women is a new thing. Upto independence it was not deemend suitable. It was only a dream at that time for the women to form some kind of committee or Sangh due to lack of education and veil system in these women. So to think of women as equal to men is just a non-sense.

2. Economic disabilities :- Before 1937, the women had no property rights. They had not even a nominal share in the property of joint families. Unmarried girls too had no share in the

property of joint family. Their turn came in the other property after boys and widows. A married woman had no property right in a practical way except Istri-Dhan (woman-wealth).

3. Family disabilities :- The women have to face several problems in domestic life in Indian families. She had a good status in the shape of a mother, provided the husband was not dead. As a wife her position was very pitiable. In the shape of a daughter, the condition of women was even more worrisome. They were considered a burden on the family and they were married early. Their approval, the consent or non-consent had no question in respect of marriage too.

4. Political disabilities :- Upto 1919, women had no absolute right to vote. In 1919 development plan, the British parliament delegated the question of women right to vote to provinicial council. In 1935 legistation too, no special progress was made in this regard and women were given a right to vote only on the basis of their education, status of husband, properly etc.

CAUSES OF LOWER STATUS OF WOMEN

After vedic period the position of the women in Indian society continuously went down. With the passage of time discrimination and excesses towards them increased. There are several reasons for this, some of which are mentioned here under :-

1. Paternal family :- In Indian society paternal families dominate. Every work of the family is done with the approval of the father. Women have quite a low status in the family because their approval is not taken in any work of the family. In the domestic matters and property, father controls the affairs.

2. Depending on men :- From the very beginning, the type of Hindu families has been of paternal nature and the wife has to go to the home of her husband after marriage, Additionally, in domestic matters and property affairs a complete control belongs to the father and he alone controls the family.

3. Lower standard of women :- In the family, the level of women has been inferior to the males. The main reason of this is that doing a job outside her house was considered against the respect of a family. So in economic matters, the women had to depend upon their husbands. In fact due to this economic dependence, the condition of the women went very down and the men got an opportunity to do partiality and excesses on them. Since old age itself, the women have remained dependent on the men.

From this shape of the family, it is clear that in such families, the condition of males would be automatically higher than women. In the very start, the ideal of Kanya-dan (Girl-donation) was accepted. The father was to donate his daughter to a bride groom chosen with his choice. Donation by the father indicates that the husband had a dominence over his wife.

4. Hypergamy :- Hypergamy was also a main reason of low status of women. As per this practice, the marriage of a girl is to be done only in a family equal to or higher in status, where the

boys are allowed to marry in a lower family. Due to this practice, every father wants to marry his daughter in a higher and higher family. The competition acquires a hard way and in this competition parents of average level have to face several hardships. Consequentially general people become afraid of a girl-birth.

5. Child marriage :- In India a major reason for the fall of women level was a practice of child marriage. So on the one hand, they were unable to get education, on the other, husbands conveniently took then under their control.

6. Illiteracy :- In the olden age, education to women was considered un-neccessary. Due to illiteracy, no awareness in women about their rights was created. Instead they became fixed in many superstitions, ill-manners and social customs. From the very childhood Indian woman first at her father's home and then in the home of her husband heard a preaching to think about her husband as god.

7. Expensive marriages :- In these days a large expenditure on the marriage of daughters is incurred. Even after marriage, boy-side demands dowry, and if their demends are not met, then they mistreat the girl.

8. Joint family system :- Due to joint family too, the status of women has been low and full of partiality. The reason for this is that under this system, the women do not get any right. Only males receive the property and social rights. Through child marriage, blessings of Kanya-dan are obtained. All these things show a low status of women.

VARIOUS LEGISLATIONS AND GOVERNMENT PROGRAMMES CONNECTED WITH THE STATUS OF INDIAN WOMEN

After independence, several laws were passed so as to improve the condition of Indian women. Some of these important laws are as under :

1. Various legislations :- To protect the interest of Indian women and to improve their status, many laws were passed which are as under :

(*i*) Hindu widow re-marriage Act – 1856.

(*ii*) Hindu marriage and divorce Act 1955 & 1967.

(*iii*) Hindu succession Act 1956.

(*iv*) Special marriage Act, 1956.

(*v*) Anti-dowry Act, 1961 and 1986.

(*vi*) Anti-sati pratice Act 1829 and 1987.

Through this Act, an explanation has been made of the diversity of Hindu family and fending for wife, widow, old-age, infirm, weak and shelterless persons. Through Hindu minor and guardian Act, immature children are given protection. Due to above Acts, there is a great improvement in the society.

2. The central social welfare board has set up low-cost hostets for working women in cities.

3. Women welfare programme :- After independence, several programmes have been started for improvement in the poor condition of women, whare description is as under :

(*i*) In 1986-87 Women Development Board was set up so as to give maximum job opportunities to women.

(*ii*) In 1982-83, a programme was started for economic strengthening of rural women.

(*iii*) In 1922, National Women Commission was re-constituted against excesses on the women.

4. Consitutional provisions :- Following provisions have been made for improvement of women's condition :

(*i*) As per article 14, all have the right to equality before law.

(*ii*) As article 39 (D) Males and females will get equal pay for equal work.

(*iii*) As per article 51 A (E) practices unrespectful towards women will be abandoned.

(*iv*) As per article 243 1/3 seats should be kept reserved for women.

(*v*) As per article 15 (1) no discrimination can be made with any citizen on the basis of religion, caste, gender etc.

PRESENT STATUS OF WOMEN

After 1947 A.D., a big change in the condition of women has come. This was natural because during 1920 and 1930 independence movement, women had played an important role. Gandhi ji had declared, "I have brought the Indian women out of kitchens, now it is upto them not to return there." Women's role in political independence struggle, opened new ways for them. If the women could take part in the processions, could go to jails then they could do a job also and could achieve a right to vote also. The women took every part in all fields of national movements, whether it was Gandhism, or Socialism or communism or a revolutionary movement. In 1926, the women established an important organisation by the name of 'All India Women's Conference'.

After independence, more attention was given to secure the constitutional rights of women. The constitution fulfilled its promise and the women got a right to vote for which the women of western countries had to undergo a long struggle. Indian Government in initial years began to give a legal shape to Hindu Code Bill. This was an important demand of Indian women.

In 1944, B.N. Rao presented a Draft-code. Second Bill was presented by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Law Minister, in which a stress was made on the age of marriage and consent of the girl, monegamy and dowry as an Instri-dhan besides many other things. A strong opposition came from various quarters of the society and many congress leaders like Rajendra Prasad opposed it due to which this Bill was postponed. In the end, Bill was put in four rules : the Hindu Marriage Act, the Hindu succession Act, the Hindu minor and guardianship Act and the Hindu adoption and maintenance

Act. This was not sufficient and the government had to face opposition because it was against the religious sentiments of the Muslims. Its example is seen in the Shahbano Case. In 1985 Supreme Court gave an alimony to a divorced Muslim woman Shahbano. Muslim fundamental lists opposed it and forced the government to mend the decision of Supreme Court. Rajiv Gandhi the then prime minister of India changed this decision into common civil code.

The women took their right to vote very seriously. This tendency was found more in rural women. But the women do not take the right to property seriously. In these days, rural and urban women abandon their right to ancestral property. In the cities, right of divorce is used, but still it is considered a social stigma.

The All India Women's Conference is today a very big organisation which has its 500 branches and it has 3.25 lac members. The organisation issues its magazines and newspapers. It gives several types of training to women for their employment. This is the most important work done by it for the welfare of women. In another important direction, in the cities it has done the work of construction of hostels for working women.

This conference had played an important role in preparing a Social Code. In 1929, in the Act which was passed for increasing the age of girl marriage from 14 to 18, this conference collected the views of the public and gave a full help to Haribilas Sharda. In the fifteen decade, due to propaganda of this conference, 'Hindu Code' was amended and males and females were given equal rights.

So, through participating in the political movement, Indian women got a revolutionary change in their social standard and that too without opposition of the men.

Indian constitution gave equal rights to men and women. The Indian government took many members to improve the condition of women and set up many departments. Upto 1956, several laws were passed for giving equal rights to both men and women. In the beginning of 20th century, social rules and legal rules differed largely. As per Panikar, in Hinduism women were never seen inferior to men. Women were seen as a symbol of strength. Not the Hindu religion, but the Hindu law had diverted her from ancestral property, compelled her for child marriage and put bars on widow - remarriage. Now a change in all these three conditions has come without offending any religious sentiments. Due to new laws, a revolutionary change has occured in Hindu social order. Owing to an increase in the marriage, the problem of unmarried girls can arise, which was just impossible 2000 years ago. Similarly, women's right to ancestral property has made an impact on Hindu joint family system "It is clear from all this that right to property by the daughter, wife and widow is an unseen revolution, but this is the foundation of Hindu life philosophy." Due to this self-confidence of educated women will become stronger and she will rise above the old view of considering her husband as a God.

About 40-50 years have passed since these views of Panikar and also since the above legal change. But no insurgency has taken place on account of this revolutionary change. This change has been adopted by the society without any opposition. This proves that without shaking its foundation, the Indian society has an ability to change itself.

se it was against the
e. In 1985 Supreme
nental lists opposed
ndhi the then prime

ound more in rural
ys, rural and urban
s used, but still it is

as its 500 branches
ers. It gives several
k done by it for the
ork of construction

In 1929, in the Act
rence collected the
due to propaganda
en equal rights.

olutionary change

rnment took many
1956, several laws
0th century, social
ever seen inferior
he Hindu law had
bars on widow -
ling any religious
rder. Owing to an
impossible 2000
lindu joint family
dow is an unseen
elf-confidence of
considering her

e the above legal
This change has
g its foundation,

It is also essential to refer to veil system. Even before the advent of Muslims in India, Rajas and feudal classes secluded the women due to polygamy. In some last centuries too many instances are found about big Harems of some kings. On arrival of the Muslims, veil system took its root in middle classes also, particularily in Northern India. In the last decades of 19th century and in the starting decades of 20th century, Hindu and Muslim reformers began several movements for an end to veil-system. Due to social injustice of this practice, we find a cheristmatic example from liberation movement of women from Maharashtra to Kerala. But the people of North India were not ready to abandon this practice. Here Gandhiji made an important contribution to bring about revolutionary changes.

II. WOMEN EDUCATION

In the field of education in 1901, only 12 girls got admission in Primary schooles as compared to per 100 boys. This number reached to 39 in 1950-51 and in 1955-56 about 55 were girls and in 1989-90 for every 100 boys there were 74 girls. In class I – V, the number of girls in primary schools increased very fast which was 5.4 million in 1950-51 and in 1965-66 it was 1.8 million, in 1973-74, 24 million and in 1989-90 reached 40.96 million. But still there is a big creek in admission of boys and girls. Even now the parents are more interested in educating boys than girls. This very thing is the biggest hindrance in universalization of primary education. Following reasons prove it :

1. Poverty, specially in rural areas, till the rural income is less, the children will be compelled to work.
2. Girls who do not work outside, give assistance in domestic work.
3. Little importance is given to girl-education, and socio-cultural customs to prevent the parents from giving education to the girls.
4. Shortage of schools came to knowledge in 1978 from this fact that in 1,91,000 villages no primary shcool was available in which 11,370 villages have a number more than 500 and in those villages where schools are set up are very far flung.
5. Due to lack of women teachers, parents hesitate to send girls to schools.
6. Bad state of schools like lack of drinking water, proper blackboard etc. In a survey of 1978, it was known that 53% schools had no permanent buildings, 59% were having lack of safe water, 40% did not have the black-boards and 71% had no library.
7. Schools of only one teacher where usually the teacher remains absent or cannot give a meaningful education.
8. Due to lack of family inclusion in education system, teachers do not take liability.

This type of situation has been found in middle shcools also. Whereas in 1901 only four girls were registered in schools are compared to 100 boys. In 1950-55 this number went up to 15 and in 1965-66 it went to 26, in 1980-81 this number went up more to 36 girls. But the higgest change was

seen in college stages. In 1901, only 177 girls were studying in the colleges. In 1950-51, 40,000 girls were in the colleges and in 1965-66 this number reached to 2,70,000. In 1980-81 this reached to 23 lacs.

Although this success was remarkable, still it was far less as compared to the boys. In 1950-51, in colleges for every 100 boys only 14 were girls and in 1965-66 this reached to 26 and in 1980-81 it was upto 32 girls.

The number of girls in schools and colleges in 1980-81 was 53.1 million, in class I-V 27.1 million, in class VI-VII it was 13.4 and in upper-middle class there were 10 million girls.

In the field of professional education too, remarkable progress was made. Only 87 girls were in 1901 whose number reached to 5000 in 1950-51 and in 1965-66 it reached to 50,000 and in 1980-81 it increased upto 56,701.

Indian government in its women and child development department prepared a National Perspective Plan for women (1980-2000). It was recognised in it that for the development of human race, women education should be given top priority. National Policy of Education (NPE-1986) for the firstmost time addressed the problem of equality of women. On the issue of education for equality of women, it was stated in the policy that, "Education will be used for a change in the condition of women". To remove the deform meaning, subjects will be kept in favour of women. National Education Ssytem will play in important role for empowerment of women. It will develop a new competency ideology through books, teachers and administrators.

It will eradicate illiteracy in women. Emphasis will be made on professional and technical education of women.

As per NPE Programme of Action for implementation, support for women power means :

- Self confidence and objectivity enhancement
- Ability to take critical decision
- Development of organisational team and encouragement to decision making.
- Equal participation for social change.
- Complete efforts for bringing in economic independence.

(*i*) Time limit programme will be kept for the education of girls, first stage upto 1990 and Elementary phase upto 1995.

(*ii*) Upto 1995 for those women whose age is 15-35 years, adult education will be arranged.

(*iii*) In technical, professional and occupational education an increase in admissions of women may by made.

(*iv*) Education related activities may be arranged, so that women equality may be encouraged and proper offices may be opened.

Several steps to provide plan of National Education Policy (N.E.P.) have been taken. Active plan has clearly and strongly expressed it that every centre of education should adopt 'Active' schemes of 1995 for development of the women. With an aim to develop women teachers and trainers will be prepared as activators. Through special schemes of investigation organisation like drama, discussions, puppet shows etc. self-confidence and self-awareness in women will be encouraged. Women should be given preference for recruitment of teachers at school level.

NATIONAL LITERACY MISSION (NLM)

The target of this organisation is that upto 1995, illiteracy in the age group of women in 15-35 should be eliminated. This mission educates the women about national unity, equal rights to women, training about ecology etc. and this organisation makes special arrangement for liberation of the women, particularly the women of backward classes.

For universalization of primary and adult education, this scheme which is opening centers for women education, these should be opened in every backward area of the country. Every help should be given to voluntary organisation for opening of education centres. In the rural areas, voluntary organisations should free the young age girls from domestic works. Job oriented development should be followed so that parents in villages give education to the girls. Adult women education scheme should be given encouragement. Industrial Training Institutes (ITI), Women's Centres, Home Science colleges etc. mediums should be opened for the development of the women. Continuing Education Centers should be set up for progress in the life standards of women. About 104 Industrial Training Institutes have been opened only for women and 97 employment training centres have been opened for them. They should be moulded in new shapes in 1988-89, which should include syllabi for professional consultancy to the women and additionally also should give information about banking procedures etc.

Women education shall have four parts :

Education, research, training and expension.

The women problem shall be included in various trainings. Research in different subjects shall be promoted. Seminars will be conducted for educational requirement of the women. Educational organisation will encourage such schemes through advertisements, as adult education, awareness, legal education and training for social and economic progress of the women etc. which may be useful in employment of the women.

Target of women education upto 2000 :- Women education schemes should be given priority so that women may attian a level of educational priority. So as to enhance the level of women education, wide cultural, geographical, circumstantial, poverty, ignorance etc. conditions will have to be kept in mind. Decentralization of educational schemes will be essential due to cultural and geographical differences. Education schemes should be implemented at district and group level only under national objective. An outline of professional constituents should be drawn only as per suitability of resources

in every field. In this work, voluntary organisations and active groups of women should be included. A fixed target is essential for women education, keeping view various roles of women and their social and cultural activities. Upto 2000 targets of women education are as under :

1. Eradication of illiteracy, decreasing the drop out rate of students by universalization of primary education.
2. Grant of good standard education to women, higher education to them and growth opportunites to them equal to males.
3. Diversification of middle education and strong professional education to them so that women may find jobs and becme independent economically.
4. To use education as an eflective medium for equality of women so that (*a*) Women are not debarred from taking part in education system. (*b*) To remove gender discrimination in education system. (*c*) Objective and optimistic trends may be included in the education system after necessary intervention in them. (*d*) Education should be prepared in this way that the women may consider it their duty.
5. Short term courses may be conducted for women, so that their social, engineering and economic progress may take place.
6. The women should be enlisted in such professional degree courses like teaching, engineering, doctorship etc.
7. A new scheme should be made for classficiation in which women should be included thoroughly.

It is hoped that through the N.P.E., POA and National Literacy Mission, spread of education in women will take place.

The highest problem is that the rural people prefer training the young girls in domestic works to sending them to schools. So the social service institutions and the states and the society should make special efforts in sending the girls in the age-group 6-11 years. After Education Commission 1964-66, "For development of human resources, for imporvement of domestic matters and for mould of the children behaviour, education of women in today is not for homes alone ..... she makes her own circle of life and is owning usual responsibility for advancement of the society alongwith the males."

When we compare their condition with the women of 19th century, then we find that a big change has happened in the condition of women. This change is seen in the professional condition of middle-class women also.

WOMEN EMPLOYMENT

Rural women have been working in the agricultural fields since many centuries. The number of these women in India is about 80%. This became a special part of their life. Similarly women

have helped their husbands in rural industries too. So, as far as the question of rural women is concerned, they are already doing their work.

An important change happened when machines were introduced. As per 1991 census in a total of 285, 4 million main workers, 29.5 million society workers, the women were 23.2% of the main workforce and 85.5% of the society workforce. Therefore in a total workforce 29% share economically belonged to women. The women have 22.7% workforce participation rate. In 1981 in a whole of 222.5 million main workforce and 22.1 million society labour, women had a 20.2% share in main workforce and 84.0% share in society workforce. 1/4 part of female labour is connected with the economy of the country. Total percentage of women workers is 20.3%.

The most attractive increase is seen in the women of middle classes, who are working in the secretariate and administrative offices. In education field, 30.7% women are working as teachers in primary and middle schools. In 1986, at university level, about 25% women were active.

As per IHO, out of 100 women in the world, 27 are busy and 1/3 share is of world workers. The most important thing is that now women are given enough chances outside the field of agriculture.

In the services, recruitment of women has increased very much. In 1981 in various occupations, the number of female workers was 44.97 million, which was in 1917 just 31.02 million. On the whole about 45% increase has happened. This is the reason that many educated women are becoming service women in urban areas. In government sector and in government and local bodies combined, the number of service-women has increased largely — in 1951 3,42,000 in 1961 4,53,000 and in 1985 18,63,000.

It is a matter of great joy that many women now are entering in All India Services and in other established civil services.

On an overage 12.6% share belongs to women. It is very pleasing that since 1990-91, the women are being recruited into Indian Navy and Indian Army too as officers, whereas since many years Military Nursing Services was recruiting many women into Indian Army. This is the first occasion that women are included in army and a navy also.

WOMEN'S CONTRIBUTION IN POLITICAL SPHERES

It has already been noted that since the second decade of 20th century, women had begun to take part in political activities vigourously.

When in 1946 election for the Constitution Assembly were conducted, then many prominent women like Sarojini Naidu, Hansa Mehta, Durga Bai, Renuka Rai etc were chosen. In 1947, Sarojini Naidu was the first woman who was appointed as the governor of United Provinces, and Raj Kumari Amrit Kaur was the first woman who became Health Minister of Union Cabinet.

In 1952 general elections, many women contested for Central Parliament and State Legislature. On the whole 23 women were elected in Lok Sabha and 19 were appointed for Rajya Sabha. In 1957

election, 27 women stood for Lok Sabha and 23 for Rajya Sabha. Some 342 women stood for Rajya Sabha out of whom 195 were elected. Therefore in 1957, 245 women members were in the Indian Legistature. In 1962 elections, 36 women were in Lok Sabha (Lower House) and 18 women were in Rajya Sabha (Upper House). In 1967 elections, 31 women came in Lok-Sabha and 21 in Rajya Sabha. On 15 July 1981, 26 women were in Lok Sabha and 27 in Rajya Sabha. In 1991 general elections out of the total seats of 545 in Lok Sabha, 36 women won and among the 245 seats in Rajya Sabha, 22 women were elected. Whereas in 8th Lok Sabha, the total number of women in both Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha was 75 which was 10% of total seats. The result of 1991 elections was that as compared to 78 in 1952 in State Legislatures, the number of women in 1991 was far more. As written by Prak Mores, "In the coming 4 years in both the houses the contribution of women will not be only to social legislators but it will be seen in different sectors of defence and finance also."

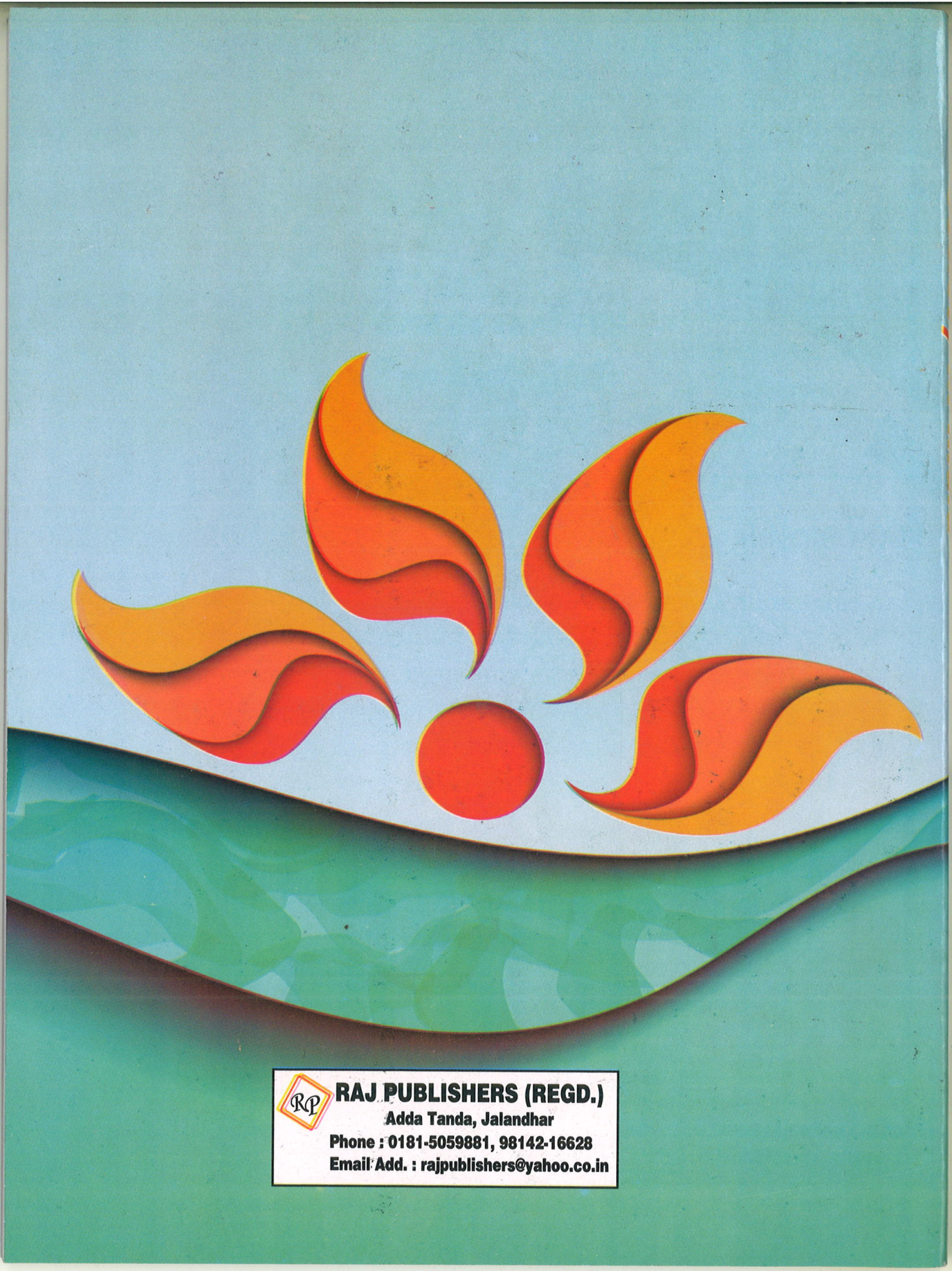
This is surprising that in the coming decades, how much increase will take place than 1991. Though it is an impressive thing that in 1996 a woman was elected the head of majority and Mrs. Gandhi was elected the Prime-Minister of India. Now the vice-chairman of Rajya Sabha is a woman and a good number of Deputy Speakers and Presiding officers in our country are women.

Thus, now in the country, the women are gaining a good position as citizens of India after removal of legal disabilities and after availablity of opportunities in the field of education. But still we should keep in mind that for many women in rural as well as in urban areas, the world of women is still considered to be within the four-walls of the home.

SOME IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

1. What changes have taken place in the social rights of women after independence ?
2. What progress has been made by the Indian women in the sphere of education after independence ? Write in detial.
3. What do you understand by National Literacy Mission ? What role has it plyaed in the spread of women education ?
4. What is the position of women in the sphere of employment ?
5. Give a detailed account of the position of women in political sphere in India.

❑ ❑ ❑ ❑



RAJ PUBLISHERS (REGD.)
Adda Tanda, Jalandhar
Phone : 0181-5059881, 98142-16628
Email Add. : rajpublishers@yahoo.co.in